

*Sharing the Steps, Traditions
and Concepts*

**THE FIFTY-SECOND ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2002
Final Report*

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

52ND ANNUAL GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE



52nd GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts

April 21-27, the 135 Conference members (delegates from the 93 areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members) met at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan for "A.A.'s Annual Business Meeting." This year's Conference was chaired by Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (nonalcoholic), chair of the board; Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager; Linda Chezem, J.D., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Tom Guest, delegate chairperson, North Florida. Warren Stafford, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference coordinator.

The Conference officially opened Sunday afternoon with a welcome from Elaine McDowell, greetings from the delegate chairperson, Tom Guest, and the keynote address, given by Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee.

At the open A.A. meeting following the Sunday evening din-

ner, Andy Arvidson (Washington State, West) chaired. The meeting was led by Ron Atkinson (Central Michigan); speakers were: Bob Allen (BC/Yukon), Shirley Ohlson (Utah), Eva Sanchez (G.S.O. staff), John Koster (general service trustee), and Susan Campbell (Grapevine director).

Every A.A. knows there are "no coincidences," so it is a pretty sure bet that when the 51st Conference Agenda Committee selected the theme for the 52nd Conference — "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts"— they were not aware that the Concepts were adopted at the 12th Conference, on April 26th, 1962. Thus, Friday of Conference week marked the 40th Anniversary of the Twelve Concepts for World Service, one of the few pieces of our literature that bears Bill W.'s byline.

Most A.A. members know that the Twelve Steps are for Recovery, and the Twelve Traditions are for Unity. But the Third

Legacy, that of Service, represented by the Twelve Concepts, has been called "A.A.'s best kept secret." Some members of the Fellowship are not aware that the Concepts exist.

The many activities during Conference week included presentations and reports, question and discussion periods; a workshop; area service highlights; and "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions. The G.S.C. Serenity Group met each morning at 7:30.

Most important were the Conference committee meetings. Every A.A. member has heard the suggestion that we must trust the process—the process of our recovery, a day at a time; the process of the group conscience as it emerges in our home groups. Likewise, the process works at the Conference level, through the committee system. Committee members discuss items on their agendas, and report their recommendations to the entire Conference body for a discussion and vote. Thus the group conscience of the Fellowship emerges in the form of Conference Advisory Actions.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two new regional trustees. Robert Pelot of Bellefeville, Quebec will succeed Marne Hill as the trustee from Eastern Canada. Phyllis Halliday, of Olympia, Washington, will follow Jim Clough as Pacific regional trustee. Ron Gauthier, of Hamilton, MA will be the next general service trustee, and the new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee is Vincent E. Keefe.

Mary Pat Yater, SW Ohio, will be the delegate chairperson for the 2003 Conference; Pete Bartlett, California Mid-Southern, will be the alternate chair.

With substantial unanimity, the Conference agreed to a two-year trial of using portable computers for the purpose of note taking during general sessions at the Conference. Six Conference members participated in the computer trial, and each shared that having the opportunity to take notes using a computer was extremely helpful. None of the participants reported being distracted or unable to fully participate in all of the activities that went on during general sessions. In addition, comments solicited randomly from a small cross-session of Conference members who did not participate in the trial all suggested that the comput-

ers were not a distraction. Overall, comments regarding the trial have been positive.

Beside the regular Conference business other activities were scattered throughout the week. Saturday, prior to "opening day," New York Intergroup held an open house at the hotel from noon to 4:00 pm. It was a very upbeat scene as old friends met and everyone got to share with "friends they hadn't met yet."

Many Conference members are accompanied to New York by significant others, children, sponsees, children-in-law etc. These guests also have a very busy schedule Conference week. They are taken under the wings of a host committee of A.A.s and Al-Anons from the New York City area. There are visits to A.A. and Al-Anon meetings, a trip to Chinatown, a Mets game and, this year, many wished to visit and pay their respects at the Ground Zero site.

Just as many A.A. groups throughout the U.S. and Canada have their favorite coffee shop for the "meeting-after-the-meeting," the Conference has its own favorite spot. After the general session closed at 9:00 or 9:30 in the evening, those who had a renewed spurt of energy headed down the block a ways to the Stardust Dinner — for ice cream, entertainment, singing, dancing and just generally "winding down."

Friday the Conference adjourned with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish.

Saturday morning Conference members came together for the final time at the closing brunch. Farewell talks were given by the rotating trustees: Jim Cough and Marne Hill. Jackie Johnston (general service trustee) and Art Knight (nonalcoholic) trustee also rotated, but were not able to attend the brunch. Following the brunch delegates boarded mini-buses for the trip to Bedford Hills, New York, to visit Stepping Stones, the home of Bill and Lois W. — a nice way to end this Conference experience.

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

Buenos dias. Bonjour. Good afternoon to all of you. It is truly a privilege and a pleasure to serve you as delegate chairperson of the 52nd General Service Conference and to welcome back all of my old friends, the Panel 51 delegates, and all of my new friends, the panel 52 delegates, whom I hope to get to know over the next week. And I mustn't forget Class A and Class B trustees and the staff of the General Service Office who have been so helpful to me in this experience that I have been sharing with you all. My thanks go out to all of you for making my task a bit easier.

Last year at this time, I sat amongst you a bit nervous and not knowing if I was prepared for the task at hand. Being only human, I was a bit anxious because I didn't want to make any mistakes. As the week progressed I discovered that the Fellowship as a whole could withstand any mistakes that I



could make. I was simply to offer my opinion and suggestions as everyone else did and the group conscience would prevail. That is the great thing about this process—the group conscience always speaks in the final moment. If we don't make perfect decisions, another Conference, committee or person can come along and change them.

The phrase that I heard early on was the best advice I had heard all week, and that was to "trust the process." I came to believe that we ultimately trust the process and our principles must indeed apply in *all* of our affairs. That our purpose here is to preserve the Fellowship for members yet to come. Our principles are truly and magnificently reflected in our theme for this year: "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts." These are the things that we must try to apply in all the decisions we make during this week.

The Steps, which my sponsor instilled in me, guide me in all my decisions in life and give me the wonderful way of life that I enjoy today.

The Traditions, given to us by our founders and early members, guide our groups to unity. Just as importantly, we may apply the principles set forth in the Traditions in our own personal affairs, to help to enhance our sobriety and to aid us in the decisions that we make this week to benefit A.A. as a whole.

The Concepts, wrought out so many years ago, help guide this Conference body in what we do this week. If we use all the principles that have been given us and we apply them in our decision making this week we cannot go wrong. We will truly be guided by a loving God who will speak through our group conscience.

I am looking forward to a week as rewarding as the one some of us experienced last year. I am anticipating getting to know you all much better and making many new lifelong friends as this week progresses and we make these decisions together to benefit A.A. as a whole.

I want to thank you all for participating in and allowing me to enjoy this wonderful and unforgettable experience. Enjoy and treasure this week, and may God bless us all.

Thomas Guest, North Florida

Keynote Address

Good afternoon. My name is Jim Clough, I am an alcoholic, and my home group is Living Sober in Newport Beach, California. I am honored and very grateful to have been asked to give the keynote address at the 52nd General Service Conference.

This is my ninth opening meeting of the Conference: two as a Panel 42 delegate, three as an appointed committee member serving on the trustees' Literature Committee, and four as trustee from the Pacific Region. The opportunity to participate with so many loving and dedicated trusted servants is one of the greatest gifts of my life.

This year's theme, "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts," encompasses 36 of A.A.'s principles. But as I review the theme, it occurs to me that it is more about sharing than about the principles.

I believe sharing is one of the most important actions in our Fellowship. Our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, and the primary method we employ is to share our own experience, strength and hope, rather than to preach, lecture or teach. So, practicing what I preach, I will share some of my experience and observations with you.

When I came to you in January 1980, I noticed the Steps and Traditions and immediately became curious about these "rules"

of A.A. I wanted to know exactly what I needed to do to achieve and maintain sobriety, and my usual procedure was to find out precisely what the rules of the game were, and then determine as best I could just how much I could get away with and still get by. But of course you knew who you were dealing with and you disarmed me completely. Instead of giving me "rules," you gave me a broad outline. Instead of giving me boundaries, you shared your experience with me. I heard the truth in your sharing and found I couldn't argue with your experience.

When I was a few months sober, my home group started a Step study meeting in which we read and then members shared their experience with each Step. I needed to hear their sharing, but it also raised a problem for me. When the meeting progressed past the Third Step, I didn't qualify to share my experience because I didn't have any! I discovered that the principle and power of sharing wasn't a one-way street. In order for me to share and participate in the meeting I would have to acquire some experience—specifically, I would have to take the next Steps! And I did.

Some time later the meeting decided to study the Traditions in addition to the Steps. It was a major decision, achieved over the objections of a few who feared that the many newcomers attending the meeting would find it hard to relate with the Traditions. But as the meetings progressed, I came to understand that the newcomers seemed to be even more attracted to the principles and effects of the Traditions than they were to the Steps. Sharing from both long-timers and newer members alike convinced me of the value of studying the Traditions.

As I remained sober my interests and reading extended to studying some of our history, and I discovered an example of sharing our principles that stunned me with its importance, significance and, frankly, improbability.

The Fellowship, we are told, began to have some success in the early forties. Drunks were getting sober and staying sober. It seemed apparent that the program was working. It appeared that many, not surprisingly, jumped to the conclusion that if we had a formula that worked for our problem, we must also have the formula that would work for any and, perhaps even *all* problems. Wouldn't it have been logical for an entrepreneur like Bill (and other early members) to recognize and capitalize on this windfall opportunity?

But, what in hindsight appears to be nothing less than a miracle, they instead made the decision to freely share our program with others. Beginning with Al-Anon we have given permission to, and/or shared our principles with, over 500 organizations. In order to better focus on the alcoholic who still suffers, we shared what we easily could have exploited.

Bill mentions in the introduction to *The A.A. Service Manual* (p. S11), "Though the Conference might be later enlarged to include the whole world, we felt the first delegates should come from the U.S. and Canada only." Again I am struck with our Fellowship's remarkable example of restraint and wisdom in not trying to control or franchise the development of A.A. in other countries. Instead we have respected the principles as each culture absorbs and develops their own appropriate and viable program.

The principles we have defined through our Steps, Traditions and Concepts are the guideposts of our Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. Our program, as embodied in those principles, is as vital and visionary today as it was when each was written. So, like our founders, who gave us ideals rather than rules, let us focus today and this week on how we can best carry the message to alcoholics in 2002. Let us learn from the vision and example of our founders how best to share the message with those in need today.

Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee

Workshop — Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into 10 groups of 12 to 14 for workshop discussions. Participants were invited to focus on how the principles embodied in "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts" are practiced in the categories outlined. Following are questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

"The chief inheritances of the first twenty years of Alcoholics Anonymous are the Legacies of Recovery, of Unity, and of Service. By the first we recover from alcoholism; by the second we stay together in unity; and by the third our society functions and serves its primary purpose of carrying the A.A. message to all who need it and want it." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, page 49)

1. Using the Steps in Our Daily Lives

a) How have you used a Step to solve a personal problem? A group problem? An area problem?

Personal Problems: Members stated they work the Steps daily and all are a help with all aspects of their personal lives, such as marriage, family and work. They put their lives in God's hands and use the H.O.W. medication daily by working with others. The Steps are practiced as outlined in the Big Book, and life could not be imagined without them. Much gratitude was expressed for Bill W. writing the Twelve Steps and for the shared desperation that got everyone into A.A. The Steps saved our lives. The Steps are used to deal with problems, as well as for helping to understand others. Each Step is a part of the process, such as becoming aware of a problem, taking inventory, talking with someone, asking for help, etc. We need to trust in the process. The Twelve Steps are a gift.

Individual Steps that members commented on include: *Step One* — used to admit our powerlessness over alcohol and unmanageability of life on a daily basis, as well as our powerlessness over people and professionals that we work with. We change through surrender. *Step Two* — useful to come back to after completing Steps Four, Five, Six, and Seven, and along with Step Three, it helped one member to quit smoking. *Step Three* — is useful for solving personal problems such as going through a divorce, family issues, serving employees and/or co-workers, and informal relationships. Step Three helps to let things go and remove self-will. It is vital to sponsorship and remembering who is in charge. Faith in Step Three is sustaining and useful when faced with situations over which we have no control or are looking for guidance (e.g. the next right thing).

Steps Four and Five help to examine our selves by reviewing resentments, stop fault finding, taking a daily inventory, and to clear the wreckage of the past. *Step Six* — helps to practice these principles in all our affairs. It is vital to relationships and is applied to other aspects of life. The importance of doing Step Six is getting out of oneself. *Step Seven* — is used to solve personal problems and is vital to relationships. Using both Steps Six and Seven we ask God to relieve our character defects, such as anger, daily. We must work *Step Nine* before Step Ten. With *Step Ten* we practice a daily individual inventory by admitting our faults and defects to avoid repeating these actions. We focus on *our* inventory not *yours*. If used daily it helps to live more comfortably. Challenges force us to work our program harder. *Step Eleven* helps us to receive answers from our Higher Power, but most of the time we don't get answers except to step back, be quiet and know that all will turn out well. It is used every morning and when one gets off track during the day. *Step Twelve* is practiced by helping others and, by doing so, we get out of ourselves. Members show the same courtesy to others as they show

a newcomer and they practice these principles in all their affairs through living by example — love, honesty, unselfishness and purity.

Group Problems: A group inventory (Steps Four, Ten and Twelve) can help us with problems such as difficult people. Steps Six and Eleven are used to decide issues. Steps Three and Ten are often cited in groups. Step meetings can be offered for newcomers. When the Steps are practiced in our group we learn how to apply them in our lives and when we apply them in our lives, we are better able to come to informed group conscience inventories. Group business meetings are fun because individual members are working the Steps and groups use them to keep focused. Using the Steps in the group helps keep principles over personalities. The Steps are spiritual principles to apply in our groups.

Area Problems: Step Two helps to deal with area officers. Steps Three and Ten are often cited in areas. Step Nine is useful to make amends to other members. Step Ten is practiced at the area level in general and is a wonderful tool for clearing the wreckage of the past, learning to release anger, and examining oneself. The inventory process is used with difficult members or difficult situations to resolve issues and/or avoid problems. The Steps, Traditions and Concepts teach us how to cooperate with inter-groups and participate in the area assemblies. The Steps teach us to keep principles over personalities and to "let go" and let the committee system work. The Steps are spiritual principles to apply in the area.

b) Do we/I practice these principles in all our/my affairs and, if so, how? Or do we only focus on a few of the Steps?

Many members report that they try to practice the principles in all their affairs, and it was a consensus that all the Steps were used. Examples that were given include going back to work despite fears, one day at a time relationships with people in general, family, and work. The Steps are a design for living. Other comments on individual Steps include: Step One is the basic and most important Step. When Steps One, Two, and Three are used in group's inventories, there is a singleness of purpose, and spiritual experience. We use the Steps, including Step Ten, to continue working on character defects. With Step Six we practice these principles in all our affairs daily. Steps Six and Seven are practiced on a regular basis. The Big Book tells us to "pause when agitated" and this helps bring the Eleventh and Twelfth Steps to us.

2. Using the Traditions in our Daily Lives

a) How have you used a Tradition to solve a personal problem? A group problem? An area problem?

Personal Problems: The Traditions are the history of A.A. and we try to remember the "we" in the Traditions. Gratitude was shared for those who taught members about "common welfare" and A.A. membership. For some members the Traditions and Principles were being learned before they knew what they were doing. The Principles have influenced family life in a very positive way. The Traditions are used to rein in the ego and to practice in our daily lives.

Specifically, Tradition Two helps to be a "trusted servant" and reminds us to listen to others, and to see things in ways other than our way. Tradition Three is exactly why one member is here, because they were accepted. Tradition Four is the most complex and it helps in marriage, family, and work, learning that everyone has the right to be wrong and that a spouse's recovery must be allowed its own autonomy. The second part of Tradition Four is to be responsible to those we serve. Families show gratitude when we learn to use Tradition Seven. Tradition Twelve

helped one member to practice principles over a very loud personality and “let it go.” Also, the Tradition Checklist has helped to do an inventory on a marriage. The “common good” cited as a Tradition has helped in dealing with family issues by seeking God’s will through the group conscience. The Traditions are a practical guide for living.

Group Problems: Alcoholics Anonymous is made of many cultures, and without the Traditions, communities would have many different A.A. groups. Members report that they work better when they use all the Traditions. Each Tradition has a spiritual principle. It is helpful to have regular Traditions meetings; they are helpful to newcomers. The Traditions create Unity, group conscienceness, and a singleness of purpose by acknowledging the still-suffering alcoholic. The Traditions are available because of our mistakes and we use our experiences to build knowledge of the Traditions. The Traditions were used as a pre-Conference theme. It was suggested that groups use the Tradition Checklist to examine how each group applies the Traditions. The Traditions are important for the survival of the group.

Specifically, Tradition One has helped with disruptive members. Tradition Two and the group conscience are used to maintain group harmony. Group conscience solves problems at all levels and is a part of acceptance. The long form of Tradition Three explains who attends closed meetings and should be remembered in our groups. When group problems arise we ask “what is my responsibility?” and we deflate our ego. Tradition Five and “singleness of purpose” is the heartbeat of A.A. Tradition Seven reminds us that we are self-supporting and need contributions to help other groups, the district, the area, and G.S.O. Tradition Seven helped one member get a job when they got sober. It also helps groups to be accountable. Tradition Nine explains that committees are responsible to those they serve. Tradition Ten helps the group by “having no opinion on outside issues.” Tradition Twelve helps groups to ‘keep personality out of principles.’ Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of our groups.

Area Problems: There is a responsibility to demonstrate active respect for the Traditions, while experiencing opinions on matters in another group, district or area. Tradition Three helps in an Area to be tolerant of those with problems other than alcohol. Tradition Twelve helped a member when a trusted servant would not follow area procedures and was vocal about it. In Canada, area meetings are now more accepted in English, French and native population languages, in assemblies and round-ups.

b) How vital is Unity? What sacrifices have you made for the sake of Unity in your groups, district and area?

Unity is our most cherished possession and Tradition Three is an example of Unity. One of the ways Unity is practiced includes: sharing Web sites and having a “Unity Day” once a year. Unity does not mean uniformity and we can listen to and accept differences today. Group, district and area inventories help identify problems that create disunity. One member reported that without Unity and a home group they would not be able to sustain sobriety. Sacrifice is about willingness to contribute or may mean keeping quiet. It also means giving up something to be part of the whole. However, sacrifices can be viewed as responsibilities, such as giving another member a ride or sitting through a district meeting on a beautiful day.

3. Using the Concepts in Our Daily Lives

a) How have you used a Concept to solve a personal problem? A group problem? An area problem?

Personal Problems: The Concepts may be applied to our daily life by having vision and making compromises. They are used to

solve work problems, children, and to practice taking responsibility. A bride and groom incorporated all 36 Principles into their relationship and marriage vows. We need to trust in the process.

The Concepts protect our future. Concept III “Right of Decision” is used as our ultimate authority. Concept IV, the “Right of Participation,” is a responsibility that we practice by listening to others. Concept V, “Right to Appeal,” is important and helped one member appeal a decision. Concept IX, “Leadership in A.A.,” helped another member with their inventory.

Group Problems: The Concepts should be encouraged at meetings and can be a good experience because they are spiritual and help us in the “Right of Participation” to have faith and trust in a Higher Power, ourselves and other people. Concept I explains that the ultimate authority is a Higher Power, sharing through the group conscience; however, individuals are free to make decisions — such as the brand of coffee. Concept III teaches us about leadership. Concept V helps individual group members to be tolerant of vindictive and financially dishonest members. Disruptive members may appeal a decision and be reinstated in a group. Concept V explains that ‘minority opinion’ is important and a blessing because it allows the informed group conscience to surface. Unity is more important than individual opinion and it can be used when we chair meetings to allow personal grievances. We facilitate group inventories as a group member. We listen to newcomers. The Concepts suggest authority and responsibility and the importance of doing a task.

District or Area Problems: The Concepts can be used in discussions on district problems. Areas apply the Concepts by inviting Al-Anon members to participate. We learned a lot about decision, participation, authority and responsibility when we applied the Traditions. Groups, districts and areas have the right to be wrong. In Concept X we learned about giving equal authority and responsibility, and the “Right of Participation.” Concept XII cannot be changed as a legal charter and bylaws for an area (e.g. not for profit status). The intertwining of Steps, Traditions and Concepts are a common experience. In many areas younger members are now interested in the Concepts as tools.

b) What principles in the Concepts can we incorporate into our daily lives?

Studying the Concepts brings them alive and they become tools for better living. They require practice but not perfection. They also help us to keep an open mind and to express ourselves. The Concepts suggest that we are not to take punitive action toward another. In addition, we may practice responsibility and participation in our marriages and at work because all decisions are not just ours to make, but we can share responsibilities today. Allowing others to participate in our lives makes life smoother.

Specifically, Concept IV “Principle of Participation” is a spiritual principle and tells us to pay attention to and listen to others. Concept IX talks about good service leadership and how it can be very effective and Concept X explains that we are all leaders.

Fourteen and a half years ago Kathy Cholewinski (California, Northern Interior) called her sister and said, “I have a drinking problem.” Her sister, a nurse, who had attended an A.A. meeting as part of her training, took Kathy to an open A.A. meeting, and she has been sober ever since. As part of Kathy’s Ninth Step her sister accompanied her to New York. Kathy is grateful for the C.P.C. committee in the area where her sister attended nursing school.

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2002 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

1. The theme for the 2003 General Service Conference be: "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship."
2. The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2003 General Service Conference:
 - a) Sponsorship:
 - 1) Responsibilities of Sponsorship.
 - 2) Is Sponsorship Fading Away?
 - 3) Working with Medical Practitioners, Other Professionals and Friends.
 - b) Principles:
 - 1) What are the Principles?
 - 2) Living the Principles, Accepting Our Differences.
3. The following be the workshop topic for the 2003 General Service Conference: "Sponsorship – Remembering to Practice Our Principles."

ARCHIVES¹

It was recommended that:

4. The video "Markings on the Journey" be approved by the General Service Conference.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

No recommendations.

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

5. The pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" (P-52) be revised to accurately reflect changes in Grapevine operations and to clarify the text.
6. The Conference Committee on the Grapevine annually review a list of proposed related items at least one year in advance of possible production, so that the Conference might provide guidance, recognizing that the committee may request more than one year to review some proposed items.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

7. In keeping with the 1997 Conference Action which requested the development of a publication of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, the publication of an Anthology of the last published version of the 56 stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book be approved with the title "Experience, Strength and Hope."
8. Recognizing the historical nature of the book "Experience, Strength and Hope" and recognizing the fact that editorial changes have been made to various personal stories in later printings of the Big Book, the versions to be printed in "Experience, Strength and Hope" will be the last published version of each story, and those versions remain as is.
9. The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Big Book Dropped Stories Anthology Project with the title "Experience, Strength and Hope":
 - Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.
 - The G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material such as:

New Material

Cover and jacket design
Jacket copy
Jacket materials
Preface/Foreword

Changes

Contents page
Factual material that appears in footnotes
Introductions to personal stories.

All new text material in "Experience, Strength and Hope" is to be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee prior to publication.

10. The second sentence in the third question in the "A.A. Group Inventory" section, page 35 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, be changed to add the phrase "including those with special needs," so the question reads "Are we seeing a good cross section of our community, including those with special needs?"
11. The word "accessible" be added to question ten in the "A.A. Group Inventory" section, page 36 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, so the question reads "Are we doing all we can to provide an attractive and accessible meeting place?"
12. The text in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill Wilson, remain as is, recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writings be retained as originally published.
13. The second sentence in the second paragraph on page 8 in the pamphlet "This Is A.A." be changed from "There are even a few self-proclaimed atheists and agnostics among us," to "There are also atheists and agnostics among us."
14. The first sentence, first paragraph on page 36 in the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" be changed from "Yes, A.A. is a spiritual program, providing no material aid, but it is not a religious program in any sectarian sense," to "Yes, A.A. is a spiritual program, not a religious program."

¹ Secondary committee.

- 15 The sentence "Some areas, however, rotate half their committee members each year," appearing in 2001-2002 *The A.A. Service Manual* be added to the "When is the D.C.M. elected?" section of the "Your D.C.M." flyer.
- 16 Updated text, reflecting changes in the G.S.O. Group Services assignment, information about the A.A. G.S.O. Web site, and minor editorial changes, be added to the "Your A.A. General Service Office" pamphlet.
- 17 An updated draft copy of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet be developed to include current experience of A.A. members in the armed services to be brought back to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee for review.
- 18 Although the committee acknowledged the importance of electronic meetings to some A.A. members, the sentence "Fundamentally, though, the difference between an electronic meeting and the home group around the corner is only one of format," in the last paragraph of the Foreword to the Fourth Edition, be deleted in future printings of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 19 The Fifty-fifth General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 2005, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.
- 20 Wanda Halverson, Panel 51 alternate delegate, Area 82, Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador be admitted to the Conference because Walter Henwood, Panel 51 delegate for Area 82, is unable to attend.
- 21 Jonathan (Buck) Rose, Panel 51 alternate delegate, Area 13, District of Columbia, be admitted to the Conference because Dorothy (Dottie) Patch, Panel 51 delegate for Area 13, is unable to attend.
- 22 The "Application for Additional Delegate Area," as amplified and revised by the committee, be approved and made available through the General Service Office.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 23 The "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2001 Membership Survey.
- 24 The television public service announcement developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved to better reach the still-suffering alcoholic.
- 25 A four-year replacement schedule for television public service announcements (P.S.A.s) be implemented to replace one television P.S.A. each year over the next four years, with an estimated production budget for each P.S.A. of \$30,000, not including inflationary increases.

Note: After the initial four years, this cycle would continue, with the oldest P.S.A. being replaced each year, and the budget reviewed annually. Proposed new P.S.A.s require Conference approval before distribution.

- 26 In addition to the work of local committees, the newly produced television public service announcement (P.S.A.) be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2003 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.

- 27 "A.A.'s Movement-Wide Public Information Policy," approved by the 1956 General Service Conference stating:

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to him, and to those who may be interested in his problem, our own experience as individuals and as a fellowship in learning to live without alcohol."

"We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside of A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

Be amended to read:

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help still-suffering alcoholics. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to still-suffering alcoholics, and to those who may be interested in their problem, our own experience as individuals and as a Fellowship in learning to live without alcohol."

"We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside of A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 28 The Publications Department add a map of U.S. areas, and a map of Canada areas to *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- 29 In keeping with the purpose of the A.A. Directories to provide A.A. members with contact information, the "List of General Service Conference Area Web Sites" be added to the Canadian, Eastern and Western United States A.A. Directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 30 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2002 (see page 42 for approved slate).
- 31 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2002 (see page 42 for slate of directors approved).
- 32 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2002 (see page 42 for slate of directors approved).

Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session was given by Art Knight, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

As a friend of Alcoholics Anonymous, I'm here today in gratitude, both for the wonderful gift A.A. has given our family in the restored life of a precious loved one, and for the personal gift that association with this Fellowship has given me. As a nonalcoholic trustee, I continue to see how the power of this program has changed my life in many ways, and I thank you for the opportunity you've given me these past seven years to be "in service," and (I hope) "of service," to this Fellowship.

You have in your Conference Manual, the complete report of our Independent Auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company. Kevin Sunkel, our audit partner, is available at the Conference, and Don Meurer, G.S.O. controller and Bob Slotterback, who also continues to assist the Grapevine in financial matters, are all in attendance here today to help answer any questions. I would be remiss if I didn't formally acknowledge the outstanding service that Kevin, Don and Bob provide to this Fellowship. While they are nonalcoholics, they are clearly alive with the same love of this Fellowship that you have.

You've heard a bit about the financial health of the Fellowship from both Beth Rabren and Tony Tashner in their respective board reports. If we thought of our "financial health" as analogous to our physical health, then Beth and Tony reported as specialists—let's say like a cardiologist and a neurologist. However, I like to view the financial health of the Fellowship in a more holistic manner, perhaps like the family practitioner. So let's put on our stethoscopes and listen to the financial heartbeat of the Fellowship.

What I hear is a strong, steady heartbeat, the financial strength to power the recovery work this Fellowship is called upon to do. Yes, this year I can again report the good news that your Fellowship is financially sound.

The Good News: Your Fellowship is in excellent financial health, with both voluntary contributions and book sales well above expectations; the Reserve Fund, today, stands at \$10.5 million dollars and represents an equivalent 11 months of operating reserves; we are optimistic that the financial health of the Fellowship in 2002 is positive, enabling the Fellowship to continue to carry the message around the world.

For those of you old enough to remember, I think we can now say goodbye to kindly Doctor Marcus Welby and turn our attention to the muscle and bone of the Fellowship—the numbers.

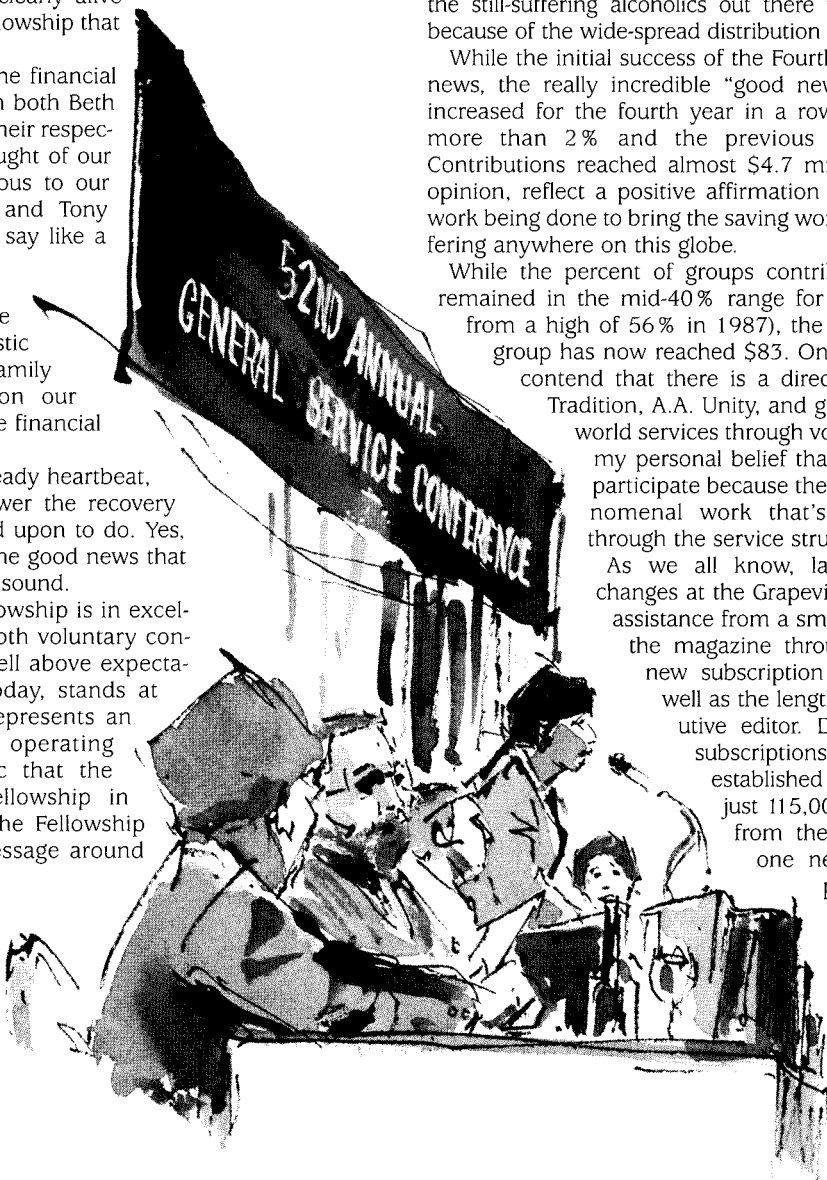
First a consolidated and simplified overview of the Fellowship's finances for 2001—both the General Service Office and The Grapevine and, separately, the La Viña Project, which, as a result of a Conference Action last year, is now a project funded by the General Service Board. Total revenues from all sources were almost twelve million dollars—actually \$11,974,000 compared to a budget of \$11,161,000. That's a substantial \$813,000 better than expected, essentially due to the phenomenal early response to the introduction of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book (which had not been budgeted) and—most importantly—a continued increase in voluntary contributions more on that later.

As we've reported previously, Big Book sales had been in a gentle, but steady, decline since peaking in 1989. Because we were not sure when—or at what price—the Fourth Edition would be released, no sales were anticipated. As you all know, the new Big Book got off to a roaring start as close to 500,000 new editions were sold, accounting for a significant part of the revenue increase. Most importantly, the majority of the increase was due to higher sales to A.A. groups and central offices, rather than to institutional buyers. While we know that many central offices were ordering to replenish inventories, it appears, through the first few months of the New Year, that the pace of Big Book sales is not dramatically dropping, as one might expect. That's especially good news for all the still-suffering alcoholics out there who might find new life because of the wide-spread distribution of this new edition.

While the initial success of the Fourth Edition is, indeed, good news, the really incredible "good news" is that contributions increased for the fourth year in a row, topping the budget by more than 2% and the previous year by close to 4%. Contributions reached almost \$4.7 million dollars, and, in my opinion, reflect a positive affirmation by the Fellowship of the work being done to bring the saving word of A.A. to those still suffering anywhere on this globe.

While the percent of groups contributing to the G.S.O. has remained in the mid-40% range for seven years now (down from a high of 56% in 1987), the average contribution per group has now reached \$83. On a personal note, I would contend that there is a direct link between our First Tradition, A.A. Unity, and group participation in A.A. world services through voluntary contributions. It's my personal belief that many groups just don't participate because they are unaware of the phenomenal work that's done on their behalf through the service structure.

As we all know, last year saw significant changes at the Grapevine. That board, with able assistance from a small dedicated staff, guided the magazine through the conversion to a new subscription fulfillment company, as well as the lengthy search for a new executive editor. During this difficult year, subscriptions didn't quite hit the mark established in the budget, falling to just 115,000, essentially unchanged from the prior year. Additionally, one new book that had been proposed and budgeted did not get produced. These two factors resulted in a shortfall to budget of almost \$100,000 (\$96,300 to be specific).



Grapevine circulation has been stuck in an uncomfortable range between 115,000 and 120,000 subscriptions for the last five years. Those of you who have met or heard Des Towey at a meeting or Forum would clearly understand what I mean when I say here's a guy with unbounded energy, enthusiasm and love for his new assignment as executive editor. Tempting to say: "Well, let Des do it; let him be responsible for increasing circulation." But let's not forget, the only people that can really affect Grapevine circulation are the people in this room and in meeting rooms all around this Fellowship. For that I am responsible.

Now that we've looked at the revenue side and understand that the better than expected results from G.S.O. more than offset the shortfall from the Grapevine, let's take a look at the expense side. Total expenses of \$11,088,000 were some \$720,000 above the budget, and have different profit or loss implications for the three entities. The bulk of the expense increase, \$662,000, is at the General Service Office. Not surprisingly, the biggest chunk of that increase related to production costs for the new Fourth Edition. Since no sales of the new Big Book were budgeted, neither were certain costs related to those sales, or—very importantly—the costs of producing and shipping a complimentary new Big Book to every registered group. Another major, unbudgeted expense resulted from an early retirement program approved and implemented around midyear. Fortunately for the Fellowship's financial health, the revenue gains were greater than the expense gains, resulting in a positive \$382,000 in income, some \$223,000 more than budget.

On the other hand, at the Grapevine, operating expenses were essentially right on budget, while the nonrecurring one-time charges related to the conversion and restructuring project were slightly greater than originally planned. Remember, those expenses (which were \$355,000) go away this year, and we should start to see the benefit of that entire project. So, in the case of the Grapevine, with revenue down and expenses up, the loss got bigger by \$113,000.

Finally, let's look at results from the La Viña Project. As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference to provide a powerful printed recovery message for our Spanish-speaking members. Last year, the Conference approved the General Service Board's recommendation that La Viña continue to be published—with funding provided by the board. Since its inception, circulation appears to hover in the 8,000-9,000 range, producing very modest revenues (this year just \$8,200 of gross profit). Last year the loss at LaViña increased to \$119,000, almost double the budgeted amount. Most of this change was the result of a more accurate allocation of costs from the Grapevine, as well as the addition of a full-time La Viña editor. So, over the life of the project to date, the Fellowship has invested about \$565,000, with the funds coming from the General Service Board.

Putting all this together: Positive results from the General Service Office help to offset larger than anticipated losses at both the Grapevine and La Viña, leaving the Fellowship's finances—while negative—some \$75,000 better than envisioned by the budget. Yes, your Fellowship is in good financial health.

I want to expand on my earlier comments about group services. As previously mentioned, group contributions averaged \$83.00 per registered group. Last year, the cost of all the services G.S.O. provided to help carry the message, averaged \$118.00 per group. That translates into about \$6.6 million dollars of expenses directly attributed to giving a helping hand to fellow A.A.s so that the hand of A.A. will always be there. Personally speaking, I believe that's what the Seventh Tradition is all about. The General Service Office is nothing but a conduit, receiving the blessings that flow from this Fellowship in voluntary contributions and

transforming those blessings into support for the work each A.A. member is called to do by the Twelfth Step. Money and spirituality mixing in an incredibly powerful way.

Now, briefly turning to the budget for 2002. As you know, generally speaking, G.S.O. gets funding to support Fellowship services from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. When we put numbers to that equation, here's what we get. For 2002 contributions will hopefully provide close to \$4.8 million dollars, and the net income from literature is anticipated to provide about \$4.7 million to defray the costs of G.S.O. literature production and services provided to the Fellowship. Keep two very important assumptions in mind: first, that the pricing level for the new Big Book was purposefully set at \$5.00, which will, in turn, lower the profit derived from literature sales. That makes the second point extremely important: namely, contributions are anticipated to increase a modest 2% to \$4.8 million. These assumptions result in projected income for this year of \$9,537,000, slightly over one million dollars less than last year, based entirely on expected more normal book sales at lower prices.

Total expenses, however, are expected to rise to \$10,287,000, an increase of just \$61,000 over last year's level. This leads to an expected loss from G.S.O. operations of \$750,000. As I noted earlier, this entire change essentially is the result of the \$5.00 Big Book pricing decision. Had A.A.W.S. elected to keep the price at \$6.00, results would have been closer to breakeven. In their collective judgment, however, the A.A.W.S. Board, the trustees' Finance Committee and the General Service Board all, unanimously, agreed that the lower Big Book price was an essential ingredient to both getting the most Big Books in the hands of the most people who need it, and that the Fellowship would provide for services through voluntary contributions. I, personally, have no doubt that will be the case.

Turning to the Grapevine, we can view its finances in a similar way. Like G.S.O., it receives its income from sales of its principal publication, the Grapevine magazine, as well as sales of other special items, like *The Language of the Heart*, other specialty literature, tapes and calendars. However, by its very Charter, the Grapevine receives no contributions, and therefore, if it cannot breakeven, it must look to the Reserve Fund to make up any deficit. I'm pleased to report that this year, the Grapevine budget projects essentially a breakeven from operations.

Revenues will increase to \$1,440,000, primarily due to increased sales from other publishing income, while operating expenses are expected to decrease a modest \$14,000, leading to essentially a breakeven. Hopefully, we have seen the last of seven consecutive years of losses from the Grapevine, and will now return to a period of self-sufficiency. I said this last year, and believe it important to repeat again this year. In my personal opinion, if we are unable to reach and sustain at least a breakeven over the next handful of years, future Grapevine Boards, trustees' Finance Committees and the Conference as a whole, should seriously consider a reorganization of the Grapevine to preserve its editorial independence, while integrating as many operating aspects with G.S.O. as possible to insure financial integrity.

An A.A. Friendship Rekindled

Marilyn McKeehan (Eastern Mass.) invited her alternate delegate, Jim P., to the Conference dinner; Sally McAuley's (Rhode Island) guest was Jack B. of the R.I. Central Office. At the Monday morning A.A. meeting Jim and Jack realized they had known each other 20 years before, when they used to share as sober alcoholics.

Finally, let's look at the La Viña budget. This year—based on a modest increase in subscriptions to 9,000—and essentially flat expenses, the loss at LaViña is expected to be about \$115,000.

So there you have it. A 2002 budget that anticipates revenues of slightly less than \$11.0 million (\$10,988,000), expenses of about \$11.9 million (\$11,853,000), and an overall loss a bit less than \$1.0 million (\$865,000). In my opinion, this aggregate budget for the Fellowship is aggressively optimistic. It truly relies on the collective spirit of the Fellowship to support G.S.O., the Grapevine and La Viña through both subscriptions and book purchases and, most importantly, through voluntary contributions. It also highlights the critical importance of a Prudent Reserve.

What a great segue to my final point—the Reserve Fund. Following last year's transfer of \$1.5 million to the Fund because of the better than expected results from the International Convention, the Fund rose from 9.9 months to 11.6 months of equivalent operating expenses. After deliberate actions were taken in 1995 to reduce the Fund, you can see that it held quite steady in the nine-to ten-month range for several years, from 1996 to 2000. Let's not forget the purpose of the Reserve Fund. It was not, and is not, intended to fund operating losses from the service entities indefinitely. It is to provide the financial resources necessary to continue essential services to the Fellowship in the event of an unexpected reduction in revenues, it's the shock absorber that allows a continuing stream of services, regardless of current economic circumstances. However, based on last year's results, we were coming close to the cap established by the 27th Conference, and you'll recall that the trustees' Finance Committee asked the Conference Finance Committee for guidance in determining the best way to handle any future excess funding. While the Conference approved an action to allow future trustees' Finance Committees the flexibility to bring the Reserve Fund down without drastic action, I'm pleased to report that the Fund stands, today, at just 11.0 months of equivalent expenses, and—based on the 2002 budget—should be at about 10.5 months and trending down.

As a businessman, I never thought I would come to the day when I would say, isn't it great to lose money! But for this cause—for this Fellowship—for the still-suffering alcoholic who may be helped by that hand reaching out with an affordable Big Book, or that Grapevine or La Viña article that speaks just to him or her—for that I am—and we are—all responsible!

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., Treasurer, General Service Board

A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

Monday afternoon's presentation/discussion session was chaired by Vaughn Horton, Western Pennsylvania delegate.

A.A. now has a presence in approximately 150 countries, and there is some form of structure in about 50, while our Big Book has been translated into more than 40 different languages.

We hold a World Service Meeting every second year, alternating between New York City and another country, and in the years when there is no World Service Meeting we now have three Zonal

Meetings. These meetings provide a forum for the delegates to share the experience, strength, and hope of the countries they represent, and at the same time can also represent an expression of the Group Conscience throughout the regions and the world.

The theme of our Conference this year is "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts," and it is amazing how the sharing, or lack of sharing, of these principles has affected the growth of A.A. in different countries. In February I visited Japan, Hong Kong, and Thailand, and in each case I was flooded with questions. In Japan, for example, they told me that A.A. had been stagnant for a long time and wondered why. They were also curious as to why some countries experience explosive growth of A.A. and some grow very slowly. It was my opinion that the rate of growth was, in most cases, directly related to the amount of sharing and understanding there had been, of the Steps, Traditions and Concepts.

One of the problems we discussed was the Tradition on anonymity, which they first took to mean secret, and members would assume a false identity. Twelfth Step work would have been severely limited.

On the other hand, I attended a week-long convention in Lithuania last year and felt that there had indeed been an "explosion" of A.A. In 1991 they only had one group; in 1992 they had two, in 1995 they had 15 and in 2001 they had 89. I received an e-mail at Christmas and they signed it from the 96 groups of Lithuania. The Steps, Traditions and the Concepts were the main topics for discussion.

In recent years there has been a great deal of discussion at the World Service Meeting, as well as the Zonal Meetings, regarding countries sponsoring other countries. There has been quite a bit of this activity in recent years and it really shows up in the development of countries receiving such sponsorship. It is much like sponsoring newcomers, they can learn from others instead of having to reinvent the wheel.

Although we have a presence in many countries, there are countries where there is no A.A., and others in all stages of development, and I can't help but feel a little bit more grateful knowing how large and how strong our own structure is. I believe that if, when we are sharing our experience, strength, and hope with each other, we can include some sharing on the Steps, Traditions and Concepts, we will inevitably become even stronger. If this is done when sponsoring other countries, these countries will grow more rapidly and become stronger.

One of the most impressionable meetings I have ever attended was the Meeting of the Americas in 1999, when it was held in El Salvador. Much of what was discussed was of a business-like nature, and the only part of it that the general Fellowship was allowed to attend was the opening and the closing meetings, but in spite of this there were close to 1,700 members who showed up for the opening. The enthusiasm and fellowship was second to none. Under those circumstances, I can't even imagine a turnout like that where I live.

Because of my present position I have been fortunate enough to have been able to visit several countries around the world, and regardless of the continent, the country, the language, race, or color, I have always felt as much at home with A.A. members there as I do at home. What we really do have is a "Family Without Borders." The love and understanding, and the communication through the language of the heart, is there from the first moment, and the laughter, the tears, the joy and gratitude of being sober, has made me feel a "part of" as opposed to "apart from" where ever I have gone.

Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada

A Poignant A.A. Moment

When Jo-Anne Lowenberger (Manitoba) gave her Area Service Highlights, she wore her dad's racing uniform (resplendent with the red and white colors and maple leaf of the Canadian flag). Jo-Anne's father, a race car driver, had passed away three weeks before; he had been sober 15 years.

Sharing our Three Legacies Around the World

I rotated on to the International desk at G.S.O. on September 10, 2001. On September 11th New York City and the world were forever changed by a hideously violent attack. As the person on the International Desk, I received countless messages from A.A.s around the world expressing support and concern for the office and A.A. members in the United States. These messages ranged from a handwritten letter (in English I might add) of support and love from the French General Service Board, which held its quarterly meeting the following weekend, to a beautiful card in Russian from an A.A. group in Belarus, who expressed their deep sorrow and solicitude for the welfare of their A.A. brothers and sisters in New York. All the messages were deeply appreciated by all of us.

It was also the beginning of an extraordinary six months in my life and sobriety. I have traveled to many places where the A.A. message of recovery has firmly implanted itself. I am as convinced as ever that our Twelve Steps of Recovery can be the solution to the drinking problems of men and women in all cultures around the world. The opening of Chinese-speaking A.A. meetings in the People's Republic of China and the continued growth of A.A. in French-speaking Africa are two wonderful examples of the universality of our "simple kit of spiritual tools." The stories of the transformation of hopeless alcoholics into useful members of society and their efforts to carry our message even further into the darkness of the lives of those afflicted by alcoholism should be an inspiration for all.

On the world stage, the Legacy of Unity and the heritage of our Twelve Traditions are not as immediately evident as that of Recovery. Many of the emerging countries have yet to fully grasp the value of the Twelve Traditions. It must be remembered that the Traditions were forged on the "anvil of experience," which is a nice euphemism for the painful errors that we committed. In some countries, they are in the process of doing some of their own forging. Nonaffiliation and self-support are two of the most daunting issues. Also there are some countries where die-hard founders and the desire for conformity to a set meeting pattern or group conscience have made group autonomy a very tenuous principle. In some countries, the concept of anonymity, which Bill W. has called our most treasured blessing, has been interpreted from one end of the spectrum to the other. This is not too dissimilar from the experience in our own Conference structure. In certain countries, A.A. members have adopted nicknames or pseudonyms within A.A. This form of secrecy has resulted in a lack of success in the Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Community arenas. Other countries have become very comfortable with the practice of videotaping and taking photographs at Conferences and Conventions, which may risk members' anonymity at some point in the future. Wherever this forging of experience is occurring we need be careful to not rush in with our solution. As we know from our own experience, the solutions must come from their group conscience and their understanding of the Traditions. We can merely share our experience with challenges of a similar nature that we have had.

Our Third Legacy of Service and the Twelve Concepts which outline its principles are probably the least well known and least understood of our groups of Twelves. In fact, many A.A.s feel that they are a Legacy that may best be left undiscovered. Our wonderful system of delegated authority and the principles outlined in the Concepts still lie in the future for many countries to explore.

My esteem and respect for this last of Bill W's Legacies to us has deepened greatly since I began to interact with other A.A. structures around the world. While I have always had a terrific sense of gratitude for the Right of Decision, Participation, and Appeal and the General Warranties of Concept Twelve, I had never been able

to imagine how truly valuable all the principles in each of the Twelve Concepts were until I witnessed what occurs when there is not a delicate balance of responsibility and authority.

In some of the emerging structures there is sometimes a rush to establish a national office and it is usually the responsibility of a few trusted servants guided by the conscience of Conference or National Assembly. This is usually workable until the functions of the office take on a more defined and professional structure. The presence of employees makes the chances of misunderstanding increase substantially. Either the board and the employees are hamstrung by an interfering Conference or they function in blissful disregard for the wishes of the Fellowship.

Our Concepts have been developed in relation to the laws and regulations of the State of New York and are extremely workable in the context of having an incorporated board to manage the business affairs of the Fellowship in the U.S./Canada. Our Conference has never been incorporated, because as the Concepts point out, it is a Spiritual Body. Since laws differ vastly in the other counties, the implementation of the Concepts has not always been easy or possible. In some instances a simple misinterpretation of the Concepts has resulted in the entire Fellowship and all its groups or its Conference being registered as a legal entity. This has created a serious liability in some instances, where those who are officers or employees have been responsible for the actions and finances of all the groups. In addition to being a legal nightmare, it has created situations where group autonomy is nonexistent. In some cases, the General Service Office is required to sign leases for groups and to offer a blanket insurance policy, which is in direct conflict with Traditions Two and Four.

The result of these deviations from the principles of our Concepts is sometimes disunity, bitterness and suspicion and diverts A.A. members from the idea of trust and respect, which lie at the heart of our Service Structure. We in the U.S./Canada are not immune to this type of occurrence. It will always occur when we drift too far from trusting each other and respecting the role each of us plays in the wonderful process of finding the expression of a loving Higher Power in our group conscience.

In each and every case where I have encountered challenges to the growth and health of A.A. in other countries, I have left assured that the A.A. community in those lands will use our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service to build their own solutions. As a representative of the Fellowship in the U.S./Canada, I must remember that the only thing that we have to share is our own experience with our own challenges. As the most senior repository of the shared experience we may have the most experience to share, but I am amazed at the amount of A.A. wisdom that we have received from relatively new A.A. communities. It is sometimes shared experience from a country that has recently experienced similar issues, which is most helpful to a country with growing pains.

I have witnessed this in the Zonal meetings, which I have had the pleasure to attend and am sure that the 17th World Service Meeting will afford all of us who will attend from our Conference structure the chance to learn from the wisdom of the 30 or so countries that will join together. Our common experiences may all have different sounds and flavors, but our common solution in A.A. around the world remains our Three Legacies. I am sure that as we continue to cleave to these Legacies our blessings and Fellowship will grow. If we do not, we will dishonor the heritage of those men and women who came before us and perhaps doom the child being born with alcoholism to a future without our solution. To avoid this we need to recommit to Recovery, Unity and Service. It can begin here and now with you and me.

Bill Archer, G.S.O. staff

THE INTERNET — A PART OF OR APART FROM

Rick Downey, Western Canada regional trustee, chaired the Monday evening presentation/discussion session.

The Area Web Site

When I received my “loving invitation” from Warren to share on The Area Web site, I laughed out loud. Since I’m still trying to figure out how my cell phone works, this will not be a “high tech” presentation. What I can share is Southern Minnesota’s experience, strength and hope regarding the challenges and opportunities facing our General Service Structure when hosting an area web site.

In Concept XI (p. 51), Bill W. wrote, “These publicity outlets—local, national, and international—should be opened wider and wider, always foregoing, however, high pressure promotion tactics. It is to, and through, all these resources that we must try to carry A.A.’s message to those who suffer alcoholism and its consequences.” Since our Fellowship’s inception in 1935, the lifelines carrying A.A.’s message have evolved while its heartbeat remains unchanged. In 1938, our communication tools included word-of-mouth, radio and the print media. Since that time, technology has expanded our horizons to include T.V. public service announcements, filmstrips, audiotapes, faxes, videotapes, and compact discs.

Perhaps most importantly, the possibilities for communication locally and around the globe have exploded with the widespread use of personal computers. In *The A.A. Service Manual* (p. 51), Bill W. describes A.A. service as “anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer. . . . The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service.” In light of recent surveys estimating 102 million Internet users in the U.S. and Canada alone, our area Web sites provide a valuable Twelfth Step outlet with boundless potential to reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

Area 36’s Web site committee is comprised of district web coordinators and a committee chair. The Web site committee addresses Traditions and policy-related issues, and provides recommendations to the area committee or assembly. The area’s webmaster serves as a programming facilitator, as building a functional and attractive Web site requires some technical proficiency. Each service entity must grapple with the question of whether to employ a web developer or use available A.A. volunteers.

Area 36’s group conscience expressed multiple uses for our Web site: a Twelfth Step tool for the still-suffering alcoholic, a bridge of cooperation with professionals, and a communications link within the Fellowship. In an effort to organize the site in keeping with our Twelfth Step, A.A.-related business is viewed by password. The password, service, is published in all area and local A.A. newsletters to provide Fellowship-wide accessibility.

When managing a Web site, a district or area can adhere to our Sixth Tradition of nonaffiliation by ensuring there are no corporate banners or advertising running across its site. Prudence may be the watchword when a Web site posts active “hot” links to other sites, as the user may infer affiliation. Area 36 provides hot links only to district sites, intergroups, the Grapevine and G.S.O. Hot links are reviewed periodically, and may be discontinued if Tradition-related concerns are identified.

While cyber space may feel anonymous, it should be remembered that the Internet is a public medium. Along with press, radio, and films, personal anonymity must be protected at this level. Many sites choose to omit personally identifying photos, last names, addresses and phone numbers. Area 36 has web-

based e-mail addresses for all officers, committee chairs and D.C.M.s that transfer automatically to the trusted servant’s personal e-mail account. This protects the member’s anonymity, but allows anyone wishing to contact them to do so.

The Twelfth Step forefront of area Web sites has been online meeting information. In many cases, the Web site can provide information and a source of contact for a wet drunk searching the Internet for help. The locations and times of meetings within an area can be posted, as well as links and telephone numbers providing help locally.

The potential of area Web sites is as wide as cyber space. For example, a Web site can serve as an organizational bridge within an area. Budgets, maps, meeting minutes, upcoming events, directions to functions and reimbursement forms can be made readily available. Recent newsletters and reports can be posted for all to read and print at their leisure. These uses afford great savings in time, printing and postage, which can be reallocated to other Twelfth Step activities.

The area Web site can also carry the message of Archives, as well as answering questions about General Service. The Web site can facilitate sharing within the area by providing a forum for sober humor, serenity photographs, and online messages. In keeping with our Tenth Tradition, many areas do not host chat rooms on their sites.

Sick and tired of spending hours updating the Trusted Servant Guidelines, only to find that your Area secretary’s dog has eaten the disk? Area Web sites can serve as a back-up repository for sensitive documents such as financial records and past area actions, thus alleviating a common source of A.A. misery.

Finally, most professionals have Internet access and frequently utilize the web to research organizations. The Area website serves as an inexpensive and effective platform to inform professionals about what A.A. is and what it is not, and how Alcoholics Anonymous might be helpful.

In *The A.A. Service Manual* (p. 52), Bill W. wrote, “Concerning any given service, we therefore pose but one question: ‘Is this service really needed?’ If it is, then maintain it we must, or fail in our mission to those who need and seek A.A.” Clearly, the still-suffering alcoholic can be found searching the worldwide web. Area Web sites provide an effective tool to ensure that the hand of A.A. is there when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help.

Christine Carvell, Southern Minnesota

Online A.A.

I am grateful to be able to present this topic today on “The Internet—A Part of or Apart From.” Anyone who knows me knows how much I love my computer and they also know that I am very active in service on the cyberspace level. Therefore, this was the perfect topic for me. I will begin by giving you a few definitions.

Alcoholics Anonymous — “A fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength, and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism.” (A.A. Preamble)

Internet — “an electronic communications network that connects computer networks and organizational computer facilities around the world.” (*Merriam-Webster’s Dictionary*)

Meeting — “an act or process of coming together: as **a**: an assembly for a common purpose; **b**: a permanent organizational unit of the Society of Friends.” (*Merriam-Webster’s Dictionary*)

So what are online A.A. meetings?

Internet A.A. meetings — Are groups of men and women assembling for a common purpose by means of an electronic medium that crosses all geographical boundaries, thus allowing those who care to spread the wonders of recovery all around the world.

A Part of or Apart From? Many of us exclaim—gallantly and proudly—we are a part of!

Who are A.A. online meetings geared toward?

Those that are homebound are a target population along with those who, for whatever reason, can't get to regular meetings. I personally found them helpful when I was working a job-and-a-half and going to school at the same time. I could still catch a midnight meeting online and feel really connected to the Fellowship and I was able to sustain my sobriety. A.A. online meetings are not meant to replace face-to-face meetings or home groups, but are meant to enrich recovery and to offer support to those who want to recover from alcoholism. We encourage members to attend face-to-face meetings if they can, to get a sponsor, join a home group, read the Big Book and share their experience, strength and hope.

There are many types of online meetings. There are discussion groups, Big Book and Step meetings, specialty meetings, and e-mail meetings. E-mail groups are those that are not real-time and there is usually a topic sent out once a week and during that week all members have the opportunity to share on the topic.

The marvelous thing about each of these meetings is that they absolutely abide by the Third Tradition. How do we know that another is an alcoholic? We don't; you are if you say you are. Extensive talk of drugs is not tolerated. Anonymity couldn't be easier as all members use screen names rather than their real names. Real names are revealed only when the member chooses to do so.

Who facilitates the meetings?

A.A. meetings online have officers, just as face-to-face meetings do. There are secretaries, chairpersons, treasurers, and always someone "shaking hands" and welcoming members at the door.

Who do the groups look to for help?

The Online Intergroup of Alcoholic Anonymous (OIAA), answers any questions or concerns that groups may have, and representatives are asked also to attend group anniversaries and other special functions. Each registered group has a G.S.R. who attends the OIAA meetings and brings information back to and from their online home group. Many groups' treasurers are required to pass the basket monthly, assuring that a prudent reserve is in place; the overages go to G.S.O. and the OIAA.

The CyberConference is now being formed. It will be a facsimile of the North American General Service Conference for online A.A. delegates, trustees and staff. More will be revealed. We have group conscience meetings just as face-to-face meetings do, and we even argue and disagree as in our earth home groups. Yet, the group conscience prevails and we turn off our modems with love, smiling from the wrist down.

A Part of or Apart From? You answer that question.

Tina Hobson, Northeast Ohio

The Big Book On G.S.O.'s Web Site

The question of placing the Big Book on G.S.O.'s Web site has been raised recently in connection with the publication of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the addition of new formats, and the growing use of the Internet. In preparing this presentation, it seemed important to consider where we have come from and where we are now in order to consider where we may be going in our efforts to carry the message of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, "... in the hope that many more may be led toward recovery by reading its explanation of the A.A. program and its varied examples of personal experiences which demonstrate that the A.A. program works." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Ed., back flap of bookjacket)

The growth in readership of our basic text is reflected in our literature sales since the Big Book was originally written in 1939:

- 300,000 hardcover copies of the First Edition were sold during the first 16 years, from 1939 to 1955.
- 1,150,000 hardcover copies of the Second Edition, published in 1955, were distributed during the next 21 years.
- 19,550,000 copies of the Third Edition, published in 1976, were distributed during the next 25 years, including the introduction of new text formats, i.e., soft-cover, large print, pocket edition, and, more recently, CD-ROM.
- 1,225,000 copies of the Fourth Edition, approved by the General Service Conference in 2001, have been published in hardcover, soft-cover, and large print formats with other formats, i.e., cassette tapes and CD-ROM planned to be available in June.

So where are we today? We have more copies of the Big Book in circulation than ever before and more formats to reach more members, and we currently offer the hardcover copy at \$5.00 US. Clearly, we are trying to meet our responsibility to make the hand of A.A. available when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help.

What about the G.S.O. Web site, www.aa.org, which came into existence in December 1995? The use of this site, which is presented in English, Spanish and French, has grown steadily as evidenced by the 1,437,590 "visits" that occurred last year. A.A.W.S., which has the responsibility to make changes to the Web site, has approved additions that include Fellowship services—such as issues of Box 4-5-9, Regional Forum information and registration, and group registration forms. The Web site also provides links, with a disclaimer statement, to other Web sites with central offices/intergroups in the U.S. and Canada and with international general service offices. Future additions may include access to archival information. The increased use of the Internet is also reflected by the development of Web sites by at least 41 areas.

Following the early years of A.A. in Canada and the U.S., we have also seen the growth of A.A. throughout the world. In addition to the Spanish Big Book and the French Big Book, we now have 45 other translations, as well as two translations in progress—the Cambodian Big Book and the Urdu (Pakistan) Big Book. Similarly, 53 international G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers now exist, with the latest ones including Hungary, the Czech Republic, Turkey and Korea. Later this year, the 17th World Service Meeting will be held in Spain, further reflecting the expanded efforts to carry the A.A. message throughout the world.

Now, to consider where we are going in our efforts to carry the message of recovery:

- What about the idea of placing the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, in English, French and Spanish, on the "world wide web" via the G.S.O. Web site?
- Does this new approach adhere to the principles embodied in

the Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts?

- Have we "come of age" in our efforts to reach the still-suffering alcoholic?
- To what lengths shall we go to make the Big Book available to our fellow alcoholics? Is this the next "format" in the expansion from written text to cassette tapes to videos to CD-ROM's?
- What benefit exists if the Big Book is available on the monitor screen via a "click of the mouse"?
- Would the Big Book on the Web site be utilized or would it collect "web dust"?
- What technology is available to make sure that the integrity of the Big Book is assured so that the approved text is not changed?
- What key issues need to be considered, e.g., accessibility, copyrights, financial impact?
- What possible impact would this action have on central offices/intergroups in the U.S. and Canada? On the service structures of international G.S.O.s, central offices/intergroups, and international literature distribution centers?
- Will the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous be better served?
- What process will be used in making this decision?

A.A.W.S., which has the authority to decide on new formats for literature, including the Big Book, has been involved over the past few years in a steady process to gather shared experience and group conscience. As part of this effort, a request for input was sent in 2000 to the central offices and intergroups in the U.S./Canada to obtain a "gathering" of sharing on the implications and impact that placing the Big Book on the Internet would have on the work of these service offices. Responses from 37 of the 400 central offices/intergroups indicated 28 positive responses and nine mixed or negative responses. In another forum, at the 16th World Service Meeting in October 2000, the world delegates had a discussion of literature, licenses, and the future possibility of putting the Big Book on the G.S.O Web site with no major objections. In October 2001, a letter similar to the one sent to central offices/intergroups was sent to the 46 international service offices in existence at that time; there were 11 responses, 10

were positive responses and one expressed concerns about the impact on the still-suffering alcoholic and about the Big Book being free of charge. Earlier this year, in order to gather the shared experience of the Fellowship, A.A.W.S. shared its discussions and minutes with the trustees' Committee on

the Conference, which provided for a presentation and discussion at this General Service Conference. At the next A.A.W.S. meeting in June, this issue is scheduled for further discussion based on sharing from this Conference.

In closing, this process of sharing will allow us to make an informed decision based on the guiding principles of our Traditions and Concepts. Our effort is focused on how we can pass on our message of recovery for future generations of alcoholics. As Dr. Bob said in his story in the Big Book, "...What did the man do or say that was different from what others had done or said? ... He gave me information about the subject of alcoholism which was undoubtedly helpful. ... *he talked my language.*" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Ed., p. 180) In discussing whether to place the Big Book on the G.S.O Web site, we are responsible to consider what is best for the Fellowship as a whole and how many more alcoholics may be led toward recovery.

Ron Gauthier, A.A.W.S. director

A.A. ARCHIVES

Tuesday afternoon there were two presentations on Archives, moderated by Arnold Ross, Grapevine director.

Area Archives — Is There a Price Tag on Our Future?

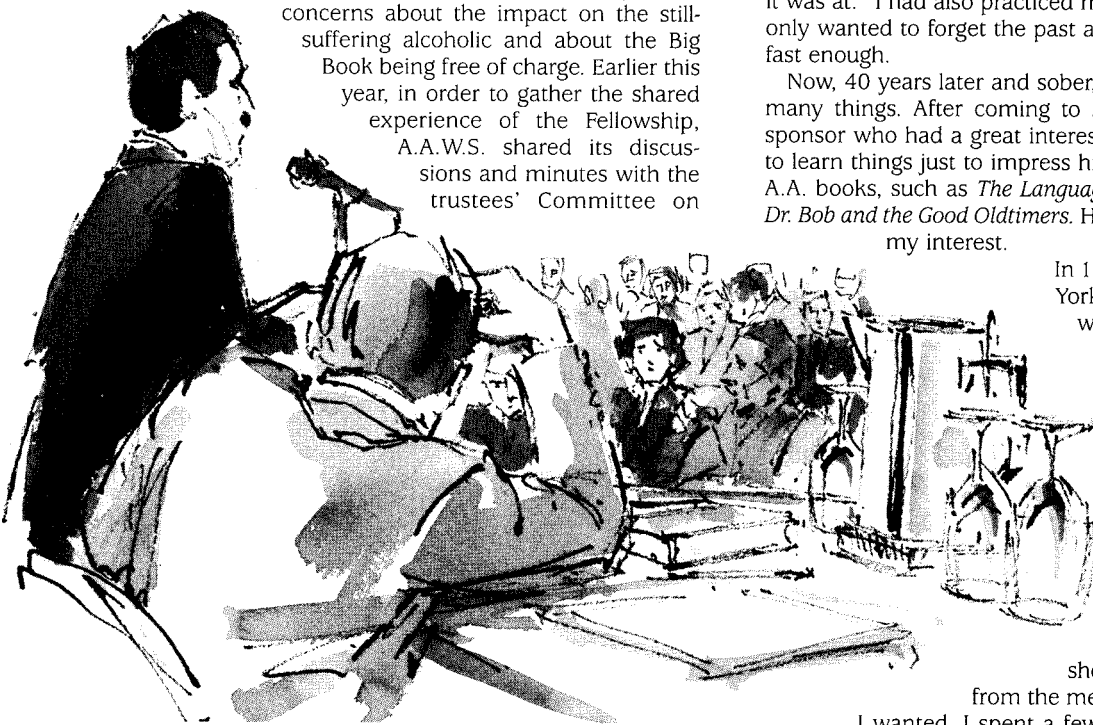
When I received the letter inviting me to speak I had two thoughts. First, why did they ask me to speak on area archives? Second, how can I impress them? Then I remembered that I have been taught to share my experience, strength and hope. That is what I will attempt to do.

When I was in school, history was boring and only for those who were "brains" and could memorize all those dates. That was probably an accurate assessment for someone who, even then, was suffering from a disease of perception. That attitude persisted until I was well into adulthood. I was on my way into the future. I had no desire to look at the past. The 60's were "where it was at." I had also practiced my alcoholism to the extent that I only wanted to forget the past and I couldn't shut the door on it fast enough.

Now, 40 years later and sober, I have changed my mind about many things. After coming to A.A. and being introduced to a sponsor who had a great interest in the history of A.A., I started to learn things just to impress him. He talked about some of the A.A. books, such as *The Language of the Heart*, *"Pass It On"* and *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*. His interest in A.A. history kindled my interest.

In 1993 I was visiting my son in New York City and called G.S.O. to see what time I could visit. They were having their Christmas party that day and were closing at noon, but if I could get there right away I could have a tour and attend the 11:00 a.m. Friday A.A. meeting. One of the stops on the tour was Archives. I wanted to get to the meeting and the woman at Archives said she wasn't all that concerned

about getting to the party so she would wait for me to get back from the meeting and I could stay as long as I wanted. I spent a few hours there. Things I had only



read about up until then were there in picture and print. Copies of correspondence and articles from the early days, before the Conference, even before the Traditions. It was quite an experience. If you are ever in the area stop in at our G.S.O. and tour the Archives.

After I was back in my home group I found that we had an archives of our own. Old phone lists from 20 years ago. Flyers for group events and listings of the secretaries, the G.S.R.s and the committee, for that rotation and back to the founding of the group in 1975. Thankfully some people had taken time to keep track of, or in some cases resurrect, these things.

After a while I became active in my area. The central office manager had an archive display at one of the area conferences and it included a chip of wood from the porch stairs at Dr. Bob and Anne's house. Later, another area archive committee chair would display some documentation from the area, but primarily it was a showcase of his personal A.A. literature collection. It was interesting, but not very much pertained to the area.

I am pleased to report that we now have an area archives that pertains to our area. We have a budget for the committee and the chair does not have mandatory rotation but serves at the pleasure of the new chairperson each rotation. We have histories of many of the groups in our area. District secretaries are requested to send duplicate copies of their monthly minutes and, of course, area minutes and assembly actions are on deposit with the committee.

Our archives chair has interviewed and taped our past delegates and some of our oldtimers. She has made them aware of leaving whatever A.A. material they have to the archives. Some have already donated things, including a First Edition, second printing of *As Bill Sees It*, signed by Bill, from our Panel 17 delegate. Those oldtimers won't be around forever; what a loss if we don't have that information available for future generations. We are in the process of finding a volunteer to transcribe these tapes, and burn them on to CDs, so the information can be more available.

Last year I took pictures at the Conference, as most of us did. Those pictures, the Banquet Program, a copy of the newly printed Archives Workbook signed by each of the committee members present when we accepted it, and even autographs I received from Nell Wing and Bob Smith, Jr. These items will be donated, along with whatever comes from this Conference. Our archives is on display at each area conference and available by request at other times.

Speaking of the Archives Workbook, acceptance of the workbook was somewhat overshadowed by our approval of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, but I would invite any of you who have not looked at that workbook to do so. I am not holding Area 75 archives up as any example. We are learning, and when I see areas with far more complete archives, some with Internet exposure, I don't envy them. I only hope we can continue to grow in our own collection. Eventually we would like to maintain space where most of the collection could be displayed more often. We are also seeing the need for a repository for some of the records.

There obviously is a cost to all of this, a cost of both time and money. However, I can't see how an area archive is not an option. We owe it to the newcomer who isn't even here yet, the Panel 107 delegate who will wonder what the heck that Panel 51 delegate was thinking about when he voted

against the Archives budget and let all that information get away.

Our Archives Workbook closes with a quote from Carl Sandburg. So will I. "Whenever a society or civilization perishes there is always one condition present; they forgot where they came from."

Leo Mutchler, Southern Wisconsin

Preserving Our Traditions for the Future

I'm here to present you with what might seem to be a far-fetched and bold suggestion at first, namely that there is a close connection between the Twelve Traditions and the A.A. Archives. The purpose of archives reaches beyond the simple activity of collecting documents and I believe that preserving the Twelve Traditions is very closely integrated with our intentions of preserving the Fellowship's historic records.

Bill W. once stated, "The Twelve Traditions are to group survival and harmony what A.A.'s Twelve Steps are to each member's sobriety and peace of mind." As the Steps are to help the individual take a personal inventory, and then help to rebuild his relationship both with himself and with others, similarly, the Traditions help us to take a group inventory and build a better relationship both among the groups and with society at large. Bill also pointed out: "Implicit throughout the Traditions is the confession that our fellowship has its sins. We confess that we have character defects as a society and these defects threaten us continually." One of the key insights that our Fellowship has brought forward was the suggestion that recovery can be achieved through spiritual means, and the ups and downs in our first ten years of existence made Bill realize that the unity of the Fellowship is only possible through disciplines that are drawn on spiritual principles.

As Bill thought it to be of primary importance, he stated right up front in Tradition One: it is the personal recovery that depends on our unity, thus getting too far from the Traditions will pose immediate perils.

Bill frequently emphasized that the history of Alcoholics Anonymous is not a success story. Rather it is a story of "colossal human failures" converted by the divine alchemy of the living grace of God. Our Twelve Traditions rest on such failures at the group level. If you take a look at the Twelve and Twelve, it is really a collection of anecdotes, humorous and tragic episodes. As we proceed to compile an anthology of the dropped stories from the various earlier editions of the Big Book, we might overlook that we already have a very special anthology in our hands, with a



selection of stories each symbolizing a historic landmark where we could have gone wrong. We erred many ways as a Fellowship throughout our history, and it is the ultimate desire to stay sober that steered many of us back to the fold of the shared experience.

Bill repeatedly emphasized that the Traditions are not codified laws, but merely suggestions. Underneath all the stories, with a touch of light humor, there is the dark abyss where fallen groups and fallen individuals disappeared, never to make it back to the Fellowship.

Reading the Traditions is very much like visiting the Archives and browsing through the past experience reflected in the historic records. I believe that both the Twelve Traditions and the Archives symbolize the same treasure chest of stories to the newcomers: this is how we were, this is what happened, and this is how we are now.

The Traditions are our inventory at the Fellowship level: they talk about oldtimers whose ego results in a strong control of a group; they talk about grandiose visions with hospitals and treatment centers that were to be built under the A.A. banner; they talk about the difficulties in sorting out our singleness of purpose as the only requirement for membership; they talk about fear—dictating—as we put 61 rules and regulations together to filter out the “real” alcoholic, only to conclude the debate in Rule #62, the most reassuring one of all: “Don’t take yourself too seriously!” The Traditions tell about our dalliances with outside enterprises, like we needed outside validation of the single biggest achievement we can bring to society—sobriety.

The Traditions warn us about vanity and fame in misguided intentions of breaking our own and each others anonymity; they caution us against getting too organized for our own good, or getting opinionated on outside issues; they point out the many ways we can hurt this precious unity that rests on a single concept—trust. We trust in many things, most importantly in our Higher Power, we trust in the group conscious; we trust in the program; we argue, we fight, we debate, we overanalyze issues in seemingly endless committee meetings, and to top that off, we call for extensions of the committee meetings. In the end, as a Fellowship, we trust one another that when the chips are down, we set aside all of our differences and recognize that we are all here to stay sober and help others to achieve sobriety.

The Traditions make us face our past instead of regretting it or shutting the door on it, and what would the archives be without the honest intentions of protecting all historic documents, including records of controversies and historic evidence for our pains in growth, as we were slowly coming of age. Paraphrasing the Seventh Step Prayer, Archives should have all of us, the good and the bad.

It was again Bill, who encouraged one of his chief critics, Clarence S. in 1955, to share his recollections in confidence with the archives for the historic records, assuring him that not a single word will be revealed without his consent. Past mistakes are the teachers of a mature Fellowship of 67 years. Carrying on with that work, we save the records of today, the debates of

this Conference and, hopefully, many more to come, so we can share our strength and hope with future generations of newcomers as stories of the past have been saved and shared with us.

Archives are vital to us in another way as well: it is not merely capturing the

evidence, protecting it, and saving it for others yet to come. Archives also allow us to share a unique sense of historic perspective on current issues, no matter how burning they are, no matter how muddled they are with personalities getting in the way.

When we draw a close analogy between the Traditions and the Archives we recognize that col-

lecting archives is more than simply gathering documents. It’s collecting evidence of all the lessons we learned as we have grown in the Fellowship. Historically, it is well known, that when Bill introduced the Traditions almost everybody was against them. Bundles of complaining letters arrived at the office daily about Bill hammering the Traditions on the groups no matter where he was traveling. Eventually we accepted them in 1950. Today, 52 years later, we are awestruck by the power of his insight and the many ways we could have fallen apart without having these Traditions. If we believe what Bill felt so strongly about, that the Traditions, and the stories embedded in them will provide powerful lessons to the Fellowship on how to survive, than we also have to believe, that the Archives, with the multitude of such stories, are paramount to our Fellowship. And I full heartedly share that opinion.

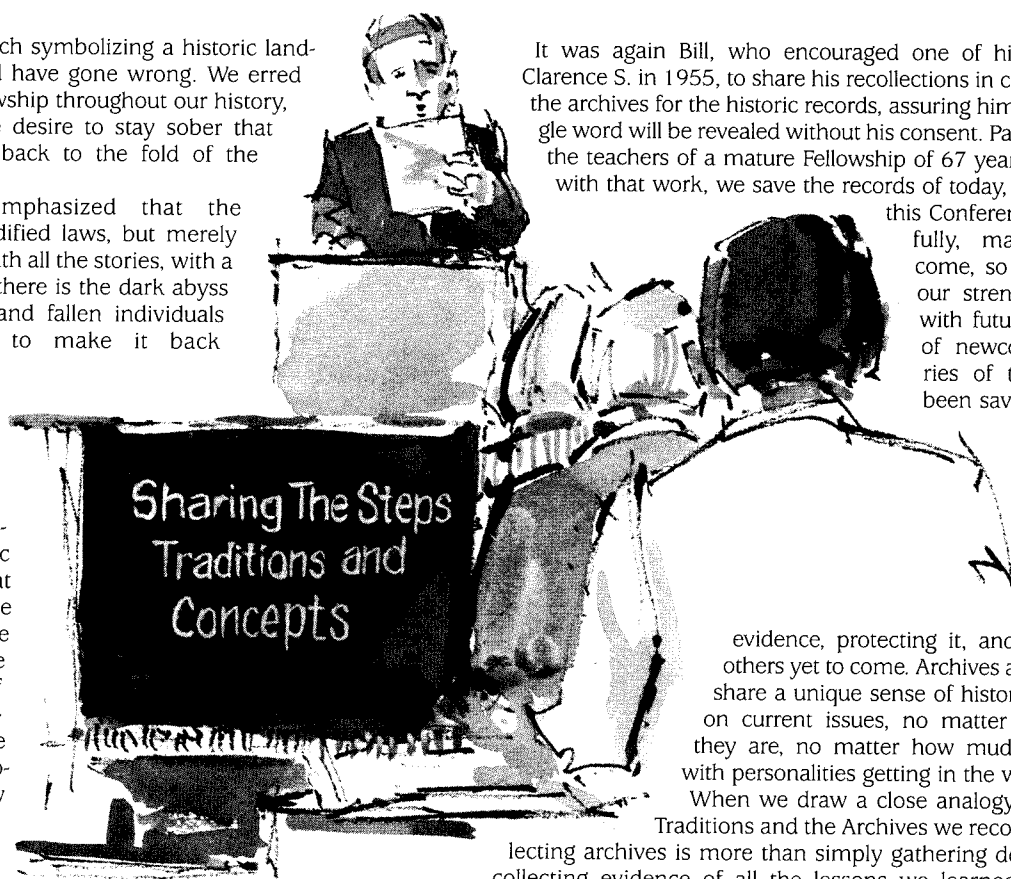
Judit Santon, G.S.O. archivist

UNITY

Thursday morning Marnie Hill, Eastern Canada regional trustee, led the two Unity presentations.

The Spirit of Rotation — Letting Go!

At the 1955 Convention in St. Louis, Bill W., on behalf of himself, Dr. Bob, and all the other A.A. oldtimers, passed on to the entire Fellowship the responsibility for the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service. Imagine how difficult that must have been. Bill co-founded this Fellowship, he formalized the Twelve Steps, Traditions and Concepts, wrote most of our literature, set up our service structure, and helped make A.A. available worldwide. He was the driving force behind this movement, and now he was letting go of the reins and allowing the Conference to act in his stead. In many different places in our book *Alcoholics Anonymous*



Comes of Age Bill describes the emotions and challenges of stepping down as a leader of Alcoholics Anonymous. In many respects he said it was very much like a parent allowing children to grow up and be responsible for themselves. While reminiscing about that moment, he said "Clearly my job henceforth was to let go and let God. Alcoholics Anonymous was at last safe—even from me." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 48)

When Bill said A.A. was safe even from him he knew the pitfalls of having a person in a position of power in Alcoholics Anonymous. He knew the problems it can cause in a group, district or area. He knew how easy it can become for any one of us to be deluded into thinking we are an expert, that we have some measure of importance, that we don't have to abide by the group conscience because we know better. He understood that rotating leadership is best.

But the spirit of rotation means so much more than just giving up the title of a service position. Rotation means truly letting go of the control, the behavior, and the actions. It means we don't constantly offer "constructive criticism" to our new G.S.R. after we have just rotated out of the position. It means allowing the new D.C.M. to make mistakes without criticism from the previous D.C.M., even though the previous D.C.M. now knows how to do the job better. It means allowing the current panels of delegates to do their job without undue influence from past delegates. It means allowing the entire service structure to operate the way it was intended, with God leading the way by expressing Himself in our group conscience.

One of the best examples of letting go was by my previous sponsor. He was a G.S.R., D.C.M., and area corrections chair. He stood for delegate but was not elected. As he debated leaving his name up for alternate delegate he realized the only reason he wanted to be elected delegate was to look important. He talked to a friend about this and his friend suggested that maybe his place now was to go home and start sponsoring people. He took that advice and now sponsors as many guys as anyone else in my town. He remains active in his home group and gets involved in local A.A. events, but he truly rotated out and let go without regret.

For Alcoholics Anonymous, the benefits of rotation are very real and very practical. The benefits to the individual are beyond our imagination. You see, when one door closes in a person's life, another one opens. The Big Book says "The most satisfactory years of your existence lie ahead." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 152) And even though that line is directed toward the newcomer, I believe it still applies today no matter how much time a person has in this program. Our best years still lie ahead because we know that whatever God has in store for us will be better than anything we could have planned for ourselves. But if we stubbornly cling to the comfort of our present conditions, then we have chained ourselves down with self-will and fear and pride, and we can't blame God for not giving us new opportunities for growth. We can't move forward if we are still hanging on to where we

are today. We don't know what God has planned for us, but we'll never find out if we're not willing to let Him guide us further down the path. By rotating out of a service position and truly letting go of the job, we make ourselves open to an ongoing spiritual awakening. We are, in effect, saying to our Higher Power that we finished the job He laid out for us two or three or four years ago, so what job does He want us to do next. As it says in the Big Book (p. 164), "See to it that your relationship with Him is right, and great events will come to pass for you and countless others."

Bill set the example for all of us when he turned over control of Alcoholics Anonymous to the entire Fellowship. In his words, he let go and let God. The challenge for all of us is to follow his example. Let go and Let God. We can then be certain that the Fellowship is in good hands.

Loren Buettner, Montana

Does Our Committee System Work?

When I received my invitation to make a presentation on our Committee System, I had just requested a presentation/discussion about our Area Standing Committees for our next Area Committee meeting. I thought, "I'm in control of this situation!" Then, after a long agenda, the presentations were delayed, and this draft was due before all that wonderfully arranged scenario could take place.

Our topic is Unity and my topic under Unity is: "Does Our Committee System Work?" Yes, I believe it does. Why? It works when we share and use the Steps, Traditions and Concepts in our relations among ourselves and with the world around us, and it works because we trust in the process.

Our First Tradition, on which I've been told all the other Traditions depend, speaks of our common welfare coming first. Each member is a small part of the great whole. Tradition Two speaks of our trusted servants.

And Tradition Nine says "A.A., as such, ought never be organized; but we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve."

Our *Service Manual* begins the chapter on Committees with this sentence: "Without committees, it is doubtful that any Conference would be able to function effectively." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S55)

All of us have had experience with committees in our lives outside of A.A. We join committees because we have to, because we have an agenda, because we want to get to know the "right" people, because we want to advance in our jobs and careers, because we are bored, because someone else thinks we should join. Sometimes in A.A. we are on committees for wrong reasons, but our adherence to the Steps, Traditions and Concepts hopefully causes us to change our behavior.

We were all assigned to our Conference Committees by that wonderful A.A. institution, "The Hat." Some of us were even selected delegate



from the Hat. The accountants were not automatically put on Finance, the writers on Literature, or the carriers of our program into prisons on Corrections. But nothing is left to chance in this Hat process. This is the way we are chosen by a loving God—from a pool of qualified members. Our committees represent a cross-section of A.A., just as the Conference as a whole represents a “reliable cross-section of A.A.,” as Bill said in the 1961 *Conference Report*.

My Conference committee worked best when we followed the sharing session procedure in our deliberations. Each committee has 7-9 members, a workable number. Each committee studies all the background and comes to conclusions, which are presented to the full Conference for approval or disapproval. Here we can all express our concerns, questions, or support, and finally approve or disapprove the committee recommendations. A greater number of topics can be studied in depth by committees than could ever be done by the Conference as a whole.

There have been changes. Recently, Archives was made a Secondary Committee, and the trustees' C.P.C. and Treatment Committees began to meet together. In the '60s, we had outgoing Conference committee members serving in an ex-officio capacity for another full year, and delegates were not informed of their selection for a committee, but were asked if they would be willing to serve on that committee. If a committee were deleted or added, would we need more or fewer delegates to keep the same number of committee members on each committee?

Recently, more delegates have been requesting the full background on all committees. In the past, was it easier to trust the committee system because the delegates simply didn't have the information? Has more information caused delegates to try to be involved in committees other than their assigned one? Do they form opinions on other committees' topics? Early in my panel, I received a request to present something to another committee. It took only a short time for me to realize that this was not letting the committee system work.

One of my first A.A. committees was an intergroup picnic games committee - water balloon fights and three-legged sack races were good choices. An appointed committee of eight to create guidelines for a central office followed, and took considerably more effort. Area ad hoc committees followed, and I was on my way.

Then in General Service I learned that the delegates serve A.A. as a whole. And I believe that our Conference committees serve A.A. as a whole. A past delegate from my area, who recently died, told me that many would have differing opinions, and I was to trust that they too had only the best for A.A. in their hearts.

Does our Committee System work? Yes, it does, when we allow it to work. Our entire A.A. program rests squarely upon the principle of mutual trust. “We trust God, we trust A.A., and we trust each other.” (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p.16)

Suzanne Moore, California, Northern Coast.

RELIGION/SPIRITUALITY IN A.A.

Charles Barta, delegate from Iowa, moderated the Thursday evening presentation/discussion section.

A.A. is Not A Religion

John Keats once asked the question, “Do you not see how necessary a world of pains and troubles is to school an intelligence and make it a soul?” How many of us have been to this school of hard knocks. How many of us are now living graced lives, lives that

were once lost and without hope. Today, when I look around this room and the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous, the image I see is not the dark shadow of hopelessness but a bright light of hope.

The question that follows is, How did this come to be? How did a people so blind to their own selfishness suddenly find the ability to see themselves honestly for what and who they were and what they could become? How has it happened that men and women who could not walk through this world without the crutch of alcohol find themselves standing firmly on their own strong legs? What gave them the ability to hear the words of a stranger, when the voices of their loved ones fell on deaf ears? From what source have these same people found the ability to speak so openly and honestly about what has happened in their lives?

The language we use in Alcoholics Anonymous varies according to each of our life experiences, including our religious affiliation and occupation. Perhaps this varied language is part of why many outside the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous believe it to be a religious organization. They hear us talk of finding a “power greater than ourselves” which will solve our problem. They hear us pray the Serenity Prayer and watch many groups close with the Lord's Prayer. We speak of God conscience, spiritual experience and spiritual awakening; being reborn, walking hand in hand with the spirit of the universe, the fourth dimension of existence and the fellowship of the spirit. (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, pp. 13, 567, 63, 75, 25, 164) To one who had no experience with A.A. it would either make you believe we are some sort of religious organization or that you needed to bring your Ouija Board with you to a meeting.

Whatever the ceremonies of the groups themselves, or whatever the vernacular of the individual A.A. members may be, our Twelve Traditions set us apart from all religious organizations. The complete freedom of our membership to believe or not to believe in anything, including a divine power or deity, marks a spiritual freedom not often found in the organized religions of the world. We have no plan of salvation, no hierarchy or system of governing our membership, we can't even say when someone is a member and when they are not; as soon as they say they have a desire to stop drinking they are in, period. We don't affiliate with any particular religion, but we sure like to meet in their basements. There are no cathedrals in A.A., only the cathedral of the human spirit. Our home groups usually reside in the low-rent economy, with many of our landlords telling us they don't want our money and we give it to them anyway. And speaking of money, as active albies we were often spendthrifts, but as recovered alcoholics we are tight with the cash. Just try for more than a buck in the basket and you'd think you had just asked for the mortgage. Yet even that's ok; we always seem to have enough and in the end it really doesn't take much to do what we do.

What we do is stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety. Here lies the greatest confusion and contention with our detractors. It's in the results, we really are not supposed to be sober and certainly not living full and joyful lives. The jail didn't do it. The wife couldn't make it happen. The judge gave it a gavel slam. The psychiatrists took their best shot. The boss hung us out to dry. The preacher told us to get out and we ourselves had finally given up after every imaginable remedy. It was all supposed to work and it all failed. Each member of A.A. “describes in his own language and from his own point of view... what has actually happened in their lives.” (ibid, p.29) The evidence is simple—the mute speak, the lame walk, the deaf hear, and the blind see. Outside observation aside, we are not a religious organization because we say we are not.

Jon Shirley, Alabama/NW Florida

Are We Overreacting to Outside Influences?

Are We Overreacting to Outside Influences? My first answer was, somewhat like I decide many cases, maybe yes, maybe no. It occurs to me, that there are really two questions in this question. We should decide first, whether an influence is an *outside* influence, and second, whether voicing a concern or taking an action is reacting. My first thought is anything that is not directly related to the alcoholic's recovery or carrying the message is an outside issue for A.A.

Yet, each group must conduct some level of business, however small. The bit of business may be just deciding where and when to meet, or who buys the coffee. But the decision-making process is conducted in a business session separate from the A.A. meeting. What business items or points of philosophy become an outside considerations influences? I guess the first part of my list is easy. Politics, religion, personalities and gossip are obvious. And so the list grows. But the influences that are prickly are ones that may appear to affect how A.A. works or what A.A. does. They may be perceived as a threat that will set A.A. back. The influence of court orders on how defendants are to attend meetings, or the press trying to tell the general public how A.A. works, provoke considerable consternation. My litmus test would be whether the influence was going to prevent someone from getting or staying sober. If an influence does not stop the group from functioning or A.A. from carrying the A.A. message, then it is outside the group's purview. Having said that, I do not want to in any way suggest we should not cooperate with the friends of A.A. in seeking to present an accurate understanding of the A.A. Fellowship. Many times, Bill W. wrote and explained how the work of the friends of A.A. had helped the members to carry the message. I do not attempt to speak for A.A., ever. But when given the opportunity to share with my professional community the value of cooperating with A.A., I am grateful to tell the story. Sharing about A.A., not preaching, not promoting, I hope to be supportive to my A.A. friends who carry the message that might save a life. Cooperation is not an outside influence.

In this question, I also see some confusion about reaction. What do we do? Nothing? Get hostile? A.A. is not a reactionary group! Just as beauty is in the eye of the beholder, so action becomes reaction through the mind of the individual actor. Our actions become reactions only through our attitude. When we hear of a court decision involving A.A., do we immediately take a "tude" that is bellicose and negative? If so, that is a reaction to outside influences. Demanding that something be done, without standing or being a party, is a reaction to an outside influence. We may be letting outside issues jerk our chain. While it is perfectly ok to think a court may have made a decision that is dumb, poorly written, or even flat out in error, we do not need to start flailing about for an immediate remedy. In fact, that is when we probably need to take a deep breath. But that does not mean we should ignore what is happening in the world around A.A. I suggest that we seek opportunity in adverse decisions and events. We can use the discussions outside the Fellowship to let people know what A.A. is, and what it does and does not do. Some of this outside influence stuff could be a way that our Higher Power is giving us opportunities. We could choose to see the roses instead of the thorns. So someone who is not in the Fellowship does not understand A.A. Can we see roses of opportunity with just a few thorns of misunderstanding that need to be pruned?

The A.A. sky is not falling. Around the world, A.A. has never looked brighter. A.A. does not need to be a Chicken Little about the current misunderstandings. Indeed, by reacting with good will, patience, and smiles on all of our faces, we will attract far more people to the Fellowship. That attraction, that A.A. has

something the still-suffering alcoholic wants, will do more to carry the message than any doctor's prescription or court's order ever could. We have to keep our balance and seek to help friends of A.A., the professionals; we have to find balanced and effective ways to expose their patients and clients to Alcoholic Anonymous.

Two years ago, I was at an A.A. state conference when a gentleman stood up and announced he was going to throw the skunk into the middle of the room. Then, with some vehemence, he informed the group that he did not want "no judges ordering defendants to his A.A. meeting." Now, I hear other members of A.A. who say the courts cannot define A.A. as a religious program or stop defendants from going to A.A. meetings. I cannot say we do not care what the courts do as members of the community. And that may be the answer. The community cares, but A.A. as a whole has no reaction to the outside influence of someone else's opinion.

Is our reaction a control issue rather than focusing on the purpose of A.A. and carrying the message? I am reminded of when my strong-minded husband and I first traveled together. He would try to tell me where to turn and give me directions. I would direct him. Finally, one day we looked at each other and said, "Who is in charge here?" We both thought we were capable of taking charge. But two heads are not always better than one. Sometimes, two heads is just chaos. So we worked it out. Our personal signal to each other is to ask, "Do you have the charge card?" or "May I have it?" When it comes to outside influences, A.A. has the charge card in matters affecting the purpose of A.A. and carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. All A.A. has to do, to "keep the charge," is to seek the guidance in Tradition Ten: "Alcoholics Anonymous has no opinion on outside issues; hence the A.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy."

Each Tradition contributes to the whole. Tradition Ten does not stand alone. The first words in the Tradition Five essay are, "Shoemaker, stick to thy last! better do one thing supremely well than many badly." And so A.A. has one thing to do supremely well. "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." If the proposed actions are viewed through the prism of Tradition Five, then the question of what a group should do revolves around some simple questions. Does our action help carry the message? Does our action attract rather than promote?

Linda Chezem, J.D., Class A trustee

The Spiritual Life Is Not a Theory — We Have to Live It

The sentence on page 83 of the Big Book, "The spiritual life is not a theory. We have to live it," should probably be followed by another familiar sentence, "What an order! I can't go through with it." Yet, we know that we can and must find the way to live a spiritual life if we are to remain sober.

As with most experiences in A.A., nothing is ever wasted. The past year I have served on a literature subcommittee tasked with reading all our Recovery pamphlets to see if they adequately distinguish between religion and spirituality, and if they reflect A.A.'s spiritual basis. This was a major undertaking which led me to the conclusion that, taken as a group, our pamphlets do paint a picture of a fellowship soundly rooted in spiritual principles.

This probably has never been more important for us to know than it is now. A.A. does not look the same as it did at its inception. And we have some new issues to consider. I would like to look at three of them.

As you know, A.A. membership continues to grow everywhere, but it is more dramatic outside North America and Canada. This growth has been aided by literature translations and trips abroad by our trustees and General Service Office staff who encourage local service structures. Sharing our experience with those in other countries makes it clear that we need to embrace diversity, not because it is politically correct, but because it is spiritually correct. Sometimes we are more comfortable with those who look and talk like us. It requires less effort; it is an "easier, softer way," which is always tempting for some of us. As A.A. grows internationally, we need to be sure that our words have weight. We translate our literature, but our actions need no translation. The ready smile, the welcoming hugs are all universal and guarantee that the hand of A.A. will always be there. That hand can reach across a room or across a continent.

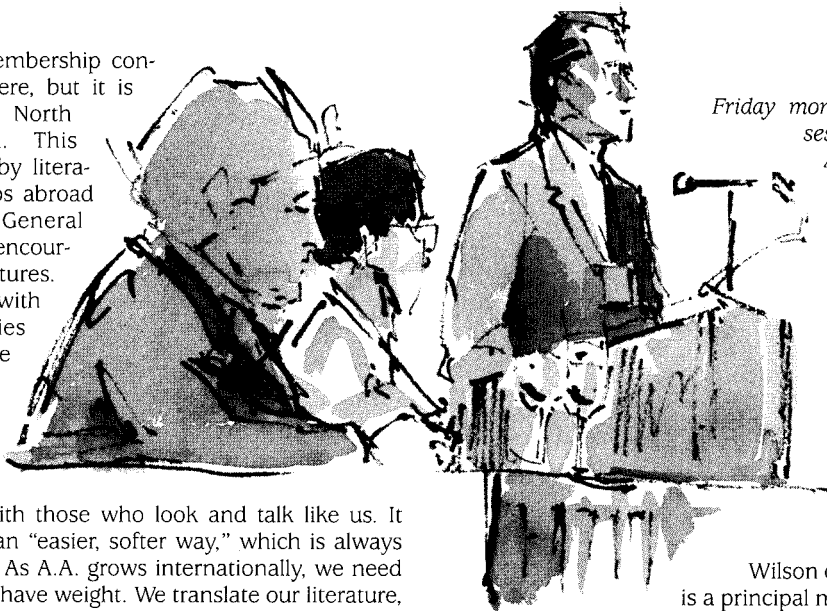
Another challenge for us today is the increasing number of newcomers who feel they are spiritual, but not religious. Whether called atheist or agnostic, they are entitled to the richness of A.A.'s spiritual life. The Big Book talks about the "arch" through which we pass. It is our solemn duty to make sure that this arch is always as wide as possible. Left to itself, the arch may shrink inward unless we stand, shoulder to shoulder, to keep it open.

The third issue is the fact that some outside agencies, courts, and treatment professionals view A.A. as a religious organization. We should not engage in controversy over this; however, we do need to be sure that our own writings about A.A. are clear and concise and do not lead to misinformation on the part of those looking at us from the outside.

So, both the world around us and the world within A.A., present us with opportunities to practice a spiritual life. How do we get "into action?" We can avoid rigidity, both in our meetings and in our writings. We can ask why some groups seem to feel the need for more and more written "rules." We can honor the rights of those who do not want to participate in The Lord's Prayer. It takes courage to stand mute when those around you are reciting a prayer. We can continually review our recovery literature and our service pieces with a fresh eye, and an emphasis on diversity and accessibility. In 1999, the Conference revised the statement on diversity which appears on our employment applications. This was the direct result of discussions among the Board of Trustees about our being perceived as noninclusive. We hope that when members look at the G.S.O. staff and the General Service Board, they see a microcosm of the Fellowship. We have been taught to "keep it simple;" let us also remember to "keep it loving."

When I was a delegate in 1984, I heard a presentation by Ralph R. who talked about gratitude for the opportunity he had been given to share in the Conference. I feel as he did—I am overwhelmed every second of every minute of every hour of every morning, of every afternoon and every evening of the Conference. And, as I rotate, I pray that I will continue to hear its sound and feel its rhythm and move with it every day of my life. That, to me, will be living the spiritual life.

Jan Polek, A.A.W.S. director



INVENTORY

Friday morning's presentation/discussion session was moderated by Class A. trustee Leonard Blumenthal. The subject was Inventory.

A.A. Literature — Is It Being Utilized or Collecting Dust?

Is our A.A. literature being fully utilized, or is it simply gathering dust? This is a pretty hard question to answer, but I'm going to give it a good shot. I'm going to start with a quote from Bill

Wilson on this subject: "Our literature is a principal means by which A.A. recovery, unity and service are facilitated. Tons of books are shipped each year. The influence of this material is incalculable. To keep our literature fully abreast of our progress is an urgent and vital work. This matter of getting the A.A. 'feel' into all our writings is absolutely vital. What we say so well by word of mouth, we must also communicate in print."

These words are very important to each of us. I decided to begin by seeing how much literature we have, and I checked the internet. We have the Big Book (four editions now, issued in 1939, 1955, 1976 and 2001). We also have six other books, the Grapevine, three other booklets, 48 pamphlets and 5 flyers and fact sheets. These are in English, French, Spanish and many other languages. We have films, videos and tapes. So how well do we use them? In my local area, and others I've visited, all the meetings start with the reading of the Steps, Traditions and/or How It Works. We have meetings—based on the Big Book, the Twelve and Twelve, *Living Sober*, *Came To Believe*, *Daily Reflections*, *As Bill Sees It* and *The Language of the Heart*—where these books are read and studied. Our area and district meetings begin with the Steps, the Traditions and/or the Concepts.

I attend meetings that use excerpts from A.A. books and pamphlets in their opening format, as well as meetings that begin with a member sharing on a Step, Tradition and/or a book or pamphlet excerpt. My home group gives out pamphlet packages to newcomers. I go to A.A. meetings that have their A.A. pamphlets spread out all over the meeting tables, and members are encouraged to pick them up and read them. I attend meetings that read the Preamble, Steps and Traditions from the Grapevine each week; and other meetings that read these from the Big Book each week. Even as far north as Moosonee and Moose Factory, the A.A. literature is being used and displayed at their meetings.

Our area had workshop assemblies in the past few months on some basic A.A. topics. Also, we gave out literature, such as "The A.A. Group," "The Traditions Checklist" etc., as well as excerpts from specific Guidelines and *The A.A. Service Manual*. I would be remiss if I didn't specifically mention our area's French sector—we have eight districts, seven English and one French in our area. These meetings also use the Steps, Traditions, the Big Book and other A.A. literature. I've attended a couple of district meetings, and they study the Steps, Traditions and/or the Concepts at these meetings. We also had a Finnish group in our area and they, too, used all kinds of A.A. literature. This group has recently closed up for lack of active members.

Our literature is not only used by our A.A. membership. It gets sent out from our New York office by our C.P.C. and Public Information services every day—to all kinds of organizations, institutions, schools and other interested individuals and groups all around the world. Our A.A. literature is displayed in doctors' offices, hospitals, lawyers' offices, dentists' offices and many other public places. This is one of the ways our message gets carried to the still-suffering alcoholic, as suggested by Bill Wilson in the quote I used at the onset of this talk.

In my area in particular we have a kind of "pass it on" system, with some of our Grapevines and hard-cover books, whereby we send them on to our less fortunate brothers and sisters in our Northern Communities after we've finished reading them. We do this also with tapes. Our Conference Literature Committee is constantly coming up with ways to improve our existing literature, and with ideas for new literature. The Fourth Edition of our Big Book was shipped out to every registered A.A. group and to all intergroup offices, as a way to encourage everyone to "get into" the Big Book. I've heard it said, that if you want to hide anything from an alcoholic, put it in the Big Book. Well, I honestly believe this is not true as a result of the research done for this presentation. Most groups seem to go through cycles, whereby their membership is really up sometimes, and then it goes really down. And some groups believe they'll have to close their doors for lack of participation; but then, miraculously, their membership starts to pick up again. I believe something similar to this has been happening with our A.A. literature, and that usage is once again on the upswing, thanks to countless concerned A.A. members who've lovingly reminded us each week of the importance of our literature. And, sitting here in the midst of all this beautiful and interesting A.A. literature I've been talking about, I don't think there's any way you can convince me that it's not being utilized!

Thank you for the privilege and honor of being asked to take part in this 52nd General Service Conference; and thanks to each and every one of you for my sobriety!

Helaine Bertrand, Northeast Ontario

Seventh Tradition and Spirituality — Do They Really Mix?

In preparing this presentation, I've thought a lot about what I thought you thought these presentations should be. In my ruminations I imagined a powerful, thoroughly researched and documented appeal to your collective intellect, combining words and figures with details and anecdotes in a manner so compelling that my words would arouse passion and fervor sufficient to sweep the entire Fellowship. As a result, contributions would flow into all the service entities in amounts hitherto unknown. For the first time, A.A. would truly be fully self-supporting by its group's contributions and literature sales and distribution could finally be a nonprofit operation.

When I first shared my inspiration with others, the first person to laugh out loud was my sponsor. He is the same person who said that if I ever wanted people to laugh, I should tell them what I'm thinking. I probably need to think about this some more. Besides, there may be an alcoholic or two who would not rely upon my research and presentation of those facts and figures. In fact, the only thing I can share with you, upon which you can absolutely rely, is what I say to you about myself. That's the problem. It's not my nature to let you know about me, the real me who was, and can be today, "a victim of the delusion that he could wrest satisfaction and happiness out of this world if he only manages well."

I later learned the delusion was far greater than I was ever will-

ing to consider. The terror of nearly dying filled me with a more readily recognizable fear than the fear I was allowed to discover later while working these Twelve Steps. Fear sobered me for a while. But I soon came to know alcohol was only a symptom. The illness killing me was alcoholism. This illness drove me to the gates of insanity and death again, *after I stopped drinking*, while acting like I thought you wanted me to act as a member of A.A. Alcohol nearly killed me, but sobriety was intolerable. Almost eight months after leaving the hospital, fears, which I didn't think I had, allowed me to deceive myself once again. With a new sobriety date another terror was realized, far greater than the fear of dying—the fear of living with the pain of sobriety. If I could have been sure that driving into that pine tree would kill me, and not leave any doubt that it was accidental (insurance pays double and I didn't want anyone thinking I committed suicide), I don't believe I would be here today. But I couldn't be sure. One day at a time, I postponed the pine tree and tried to think my way through A.A. My sponsor and my home group were instruments of the peace of *God, as we understand Him*, in my life, because they helped me to keep coming back. A sign in our meeting place reads, "Don't quit before the miracle happens."

My thinking didn't improve much, but I was taking those suggested actions with less contempt, less questioning, and without requiring understanding. It didn't have to make sense because my unaided thinking only led me to crashing into a large pine tree. Meanwhile, in my mind, I'm thinking, "Yeah, I'll mop this ancient linoleum floor, wash ashtrays, rearrange the chairs, lock up after the meeting, stamp pamphlets with our group information and restock the racks at the hospital and main post chapel. I wonder who reads this stuff. I guess you'll read anything in a hospital waiting area. Go to an area assembly? What's that? A bunch of drunks having fun? I don't think so. You don't understand the gravity of my situation. I've got some serious problems in my life and that stuff has nothing to do with my problems. That's right?! What do you mean, That's right? Why won't you give me a straight answer? What's so damned funny? Okay, I'll go with you."

Gradually and slowly something was happening, unknown and unnoticed by me because this deal wasn't doing for me what it apparently did for you. My case really was different. I kept coming back, but only because I had nowhere else to go. I couldn't sleep, so I read about our history until I could sleep. Sixteen years ago, I thought the history could have been better written. Much of it didn't make sense and they must have left out a lot of it. From my perception it appeared to be an unending succession of failures. To myself I thought, "If they could have gotten their act together back then, much more could have been done by now. After all, for six months Bill's zealous work with drunks produced no results other than his own sobriety; his business mission to Akron was a bust, and there he was in the Mayflower Hotel with nothing but a handful of dimes and a church directory. Dr. Bob got drunk after spending lot's of time with Bill. They never did get those A.A. hospitals and there still aren't any professional message carriers in this outfit.

"What about that Rockefeller dinner party? Boy did they ever blow it on that one. No one wanted to buy shares in a publishing company with no book. How did they ever think they could sell that idea? Sure enough, no one wanted the book when it was finally printed and they had to give them away! Poor Dr. Bob, he probably could have made some serious bucks if he hadn't spent so much time Twelfth Stepping 5,000 drunks."

It was all a mystery to me, and I was miserable. All my life there was never enough of anything to suit me and my standards of demanding a little more of everything and everyone than could ever be provided. Now I was all wrapped up in A.A. and its seem-



I've been allowed to be a part of something so far beyond my comprehension that I know what a miracle is. All A.A. is, and will be, has been given to me, a member of a home group of erstwhile erratic alcoholics. I became self-supporting because of all that was given to me. It's why I'm alive today. They showed me that giving is how they received the blessings of a new and better life, unrecognizable as the one they brought to A.A. This paradox of giving to receive puzzles me to this day. It works so well I wonder why I don't do more.

Mark Kramar, Louisiana

ingly unending line of failures. But I kept coming back and doing as my sponsor suggested.

When I came to believe I can't exactly say. My new pair of glasses viewed dimly at first. I could not prove that making financial amends I thought I could not afford, contributed to my financial security, but I knew those actions preceded my release from financial fears. I could not prove that giving caused me to be able to give more—but giving always preceded my being able to give more. I can't provide empirical proof that repeated Step work with my sponsor, and later with others who called me sponsor, had anything to do with the elimination of my problems, but I know those "serious problems" were resolved while I spent more of my time working with others—some who were almost too smart for this program and many who just didn't want it.

I have been restored to a problem-filled life with a living solution for all my problems. Now, our history is a continuous miracle of successive failures and corrected mistakes, which kept from us what we wanted in order that we could and would get what we needed. Look at the road of happy destiny we have trudged with a broke stockbroker, on a busted business deal with a handful of dimes, standing in the Mayflower Hotel in Akron in April of 1935, to a dinner hosted by the Rockefellers at the Union Club in New York on February 8, 1940, with a bunch of recently recovered drunks elbow to elbow with many of the wealthiest and most influential people of that day. Their wealth could have blessed us to death. The failure of that fundraiser helped transform us into the continued success of a fellowship far too diverse and a program far too simple to be accepted throughout the world.

A few years ago I listened to three friends of mine comment upon this miracle of ours: "A.A. is the most successful self-help program the world has ever known," said the first recovered drunk. "It's a God help program", said the second. And the third, with authority, declared, "If you read our Big Book, it's a help others program."

Since my life depends upon helping others, accepting anything for that purpose from anyone other than a recovering alcoholic could deprive an alcoholic trying to recover of the same opportunity I was given. Perhaps it's another reason we don't ask for anything from anyone who is not an alcoholic. This Seventh Tradition may well be our spiritual safety valve. If we can't get it from our own contributions, maybe we don't really need it. Perhaps that is why: "Final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship."

FAREWELL TALK

For over 27 years, Susan Ulseth has served as a G.S.O. staff member. Susan will be retiring at the end of the year, so, this being her final Conference, she shared some memories Friday afternoon, prior to the closing of the Conference.

Dear Friends,

The first Conference that I attended was in 1975, and it was a thrill for me to meet all those longtimers; I was sober six years at that time. To listen to words of wisdom from all those Conference members and to experience the A.A. committee system in action showed me that the full voice of A.A. was heard. Now here we are in 2002, with the same excitement and the final outcome because the committee system has done its work. The Fellowship has continued to function beautifully and the Conference truly is a democratic process. The General Service Conference has proven to me, and to A.A.s in the U.S. and Canada, time and time again that no person runs Alcoholics Anonymous and that a loving God as He may express Himself through our group conscious is heard; that our leaders are but trusted servants and they do not govern.

This 52nd General Service Conference will be my 25th and my swansong. I missed two Conferences while serving 27 years on the G.S.O. staff, one to have a baby and the second due to the death of my beloved husband and soulmate, Erik, and that wasn't a full Conference, just half. It has been a tremendous ride, a glorious experience, and so I thank you for having me along as a secretary on most Conference and trustees' committees.

Alcoholics Anonymous is a wonderful spiritual fellowship that works through its Twelve Step program of recovery, which saves lives and saved mine in 1969. The Twelve Traditions have continued to unite our 100,000 groups worldwide and will continue to do so for years to come if our egos do not get in the way. Our trustees, both Class As and Class Bs, the general manager and previous general managers, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and the wonderful employees at G.S.O. and the Grapevine, current and past delegates, and intergroup and central office workers, have all been a part in this process, as well as the local trusted servants in the areas and the A.A. groups and members.

Serving on the G.S.O. staff and rotating into all the staff assignments, except the International Convention, has enhanced my love for Alcoholics Anonymous and its loosely knit structure. It seems to be the right time for me to retire after having the privi-

lege of working with six general managers, loving all of them, and working with over 40 G.S.O. staff members. Staff members were all females when I was hired, and now there is an even mix of men and women, and always the right people have been hired at the right time.

Being a staff member can really force you to use the Steps more often than you ever imagined. I thank you for the opportunity to have to practice the program more diligently and to serve with such a wonderful group of people. If something I said or did

was not appropriate over these years I am asking you now to forgive me, as I have already forgiven you and forgiven our imperfections and done countless mini Fourth Steps with my sponsor to try to get rid of my glaring resentments. Change occurs when we open ourselves up to a faith that freedom takes us to. Inner strength and happiness comes from a purpose and from a higher spirit. That inner strength has been a blessing to me, to feel your spirit and the A.A. spirit and to work with all the trusted servants in A.A. so we can help the alcoholic who still suffers. My freedom has come when I open myself to a spiritual way of life which helps me to deal with whatever life experiences come my way. You are all a gift in my life and I appreciate your wisdom and your experience. It would be impossible to name all the great influences in my A.A. life, so I won't attempt the impossible.

My family especially needs to be thanked—the family that stood by me through my alcoholism and then through my day at a time recovery from the illness, and through all of this A.A. General Service stuff. My family might have thought at times that I devoted more time to A.A. sponsees than to them, but truly, my beloved sponsees have helped me see myself in God's light and to get out of myself. And to my beloved sponsor and my A.A. group, you are my lifeline, my strength and my hope. Thank you for being there. Were it not for the woman who brought the message to me I would not be sober today and trying to do the same for the next person.

All things need to be turned over, accepted or changed, and done over again. The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous needs to experience this process, too. If we open our hearts and let the alcoholic in, without rigid rules and regulations, without pushing newcomers to have to believe in God, A.A. will be around for a long time.

You will now hear a couple of my pet peeves, one of them the accumulation of material objects, trinkets, tokens, cards, t-shirts and other drunk junk, instead of giving a newcomer a Grapevine or your phone number. Members putting A.A. literature and books and other A.A. material on their Web sites, with no credit given to where the material comes from. Also all of those rituals in A.A. bug me, when people shout out "What's your name?" "Whose Father?" "What's the point?" Or at the end of the meeting the endless chanting after the Serenity Prayer. Hopefully, A.A. will not bend toward a religious and intolerant posture that would start to exclude, by word or attitude, nonbelievers. We need caution with all the back-to-basics stuff we hear. Let's remember the spirit of A.A. and not set down laws or more policies.



I hope the boards do not develop study guides on how to study the A.A. program, and that we will always know that our own personal experience is just as good as the next person's sharing on the Steps and on how the program helps us become emotionally balanced. As Bill said, "God help us to love their best and never fear their worst." Having lived through the attempt to censure the General Service Board, to talk forever and ever about cash incentives, copyrights and legal matters, and to experience the times when the staff tried to run the show, or the trustees tried to run the show,

or the delegates tried to run the show. Why haven't the directors caused an uprising? It all balances out in the end—we come together in unity and love and in the A.A. spirit. Yet, the debates have been heated over the years. I remember the time when the gay/lesbian pamphlet was on the Conference floor for four years and the Blue Card took eight hours to discuss and finalize. And word-smithing drives me bananas.

Living one day at a time has allowed me to not plan the outcome of retirement from G.S.O. I will be in New York and in my home group, the 79th Street Workshop. I plan to answer phones at Intergroup and continue sharing with new pigeons as well as the old ones. I will also continue going to the Hope Group (a meeting in an apartment for a shut-in), and perhaps filling in now and then at G.S.O. while you trusted servants are at the next Conference. And then I may take classes and do some non-A.A. activities—like the theater, museums and travel. Thank you for this opportunity to serve the Fellowship and experience the miracles and the magic of A.A. love and service. I love you all and take all of you in my heart forever.

Susan Ulseth



Reports from the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: The year 2001 was challenging and often sorrowful, tempered by our knowledge that throughout the difficult times, the A.A. message of hope continued to be carried. Like many in the world, our prayers and sympathies went out to the families and friends of those who perished or were injured on September 11th. We're aware that some of the dead were A.A. members whose strength, hope and experience will no longer be shared, but whose examples live on. G.S.O. was able to play a small role in helping to make A.A. available twenty-four hours a day to firemen, police officers and other emergency workers in A.A. near "ground zero," close to where the World Trade Center stood. The establishment of these meetings was a powerful example of cooperation between G.S.O., the area and the local intergroup, as well as with the Red Cross. Our spirits were sustained during this time by the love and warmth of the many messages of concern and support that were received from around the world.

Nearer to home, our beloved director of the Publications Department, Vinnie McCarthy, died suddenly in early December. Vinnie had been part of the G.S.O. family since June 1977 — the youngest staff member to be hired at the time. When then general manager John Bragg established the Publications Department as a separate unit within G.S.O. on September 1, 1985, Vinnie was appointed its director. Lee Halligan, former director of Human Resources at G.S.O. and one of Vinnie's closest friends, described Vinnie best when she wrote, "Bright, collegial, creative and forthright, Vinnie was greatly admired within the A.A. Fellowship, among staff and professional colleagues, and within her department for her quiet leadership." It is an understatement to say that Vinnie will be missed.

During the same period as Vinnie's passing, several G.S.O. employees lost dear ones, ending the year on a very subdued note.

Despite the emotional roller coaster engendered by circumstances, the work of A.A. continued, and there were some very solid accomplishments, including a major landmark — the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, was published in November. There was almost universal praise for the 24 new stories and the selection of the 17 stories carried forward from the Third Edition. There also appears to be substantial agreement that the new stories continue to emphasize what it was like, what happened, and what it is like now. Our message of recovery continues to be shared in this Fourth Edition of our basic text.

The General Service Board extended appreciation to the Publications Department, including Order Entry, Inventory Control and Shipping and Mailing, whose dedication and professionalism, together with the strong support of our warehouses, responded heroically to the deluge of requests for orders and deliveries of the early printings of the Fourth Edition. Gratitude is and appreciation are also directed to many other employees at G.S.O. whose various efforts in developing, implementing and processing this important work kept the Fourth Edition Big Book flowing smoothly into the hands of the Fellowship.

The pamphlet, "Can A.A. Help Me Too? Black/African Americans Share Their Stories," became available to the

Fellowship in July. The response to this pamphlet so far has also been overwhelmingly positive. "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late" replaced the pamphlet, "Time to Start Living." Hopefully, this pamphlet will encourage A.A. members to extend the hand of A.A. to older alcoholics in their communities.

We approved new translations of A.A. literature, such as translation of the Big Book into Urdu (one of the languages spoken in Pakistan), and into Simplified Chinese. Completed projects include the Big Book translated into Indonesian and Slovene, as well as translations of a number of Conference-approved pamphlets into Croatian, Hebrew, Mongolian, Shan, Simplified Chinese and Turkish. Thus far, the Big Book has been translated into 47 languages.

In order to assist others in carrying the A.A. message, G.S.O.'s general manager, some trustees and several staff members traveled overseas in 2001 to Australia, Cuba, Finland, Latvia, Lithuania, Portugal, Germany, France, Turkey, Austria, Japan, Slovakia, Ukraine, Columbia, Peru and India.

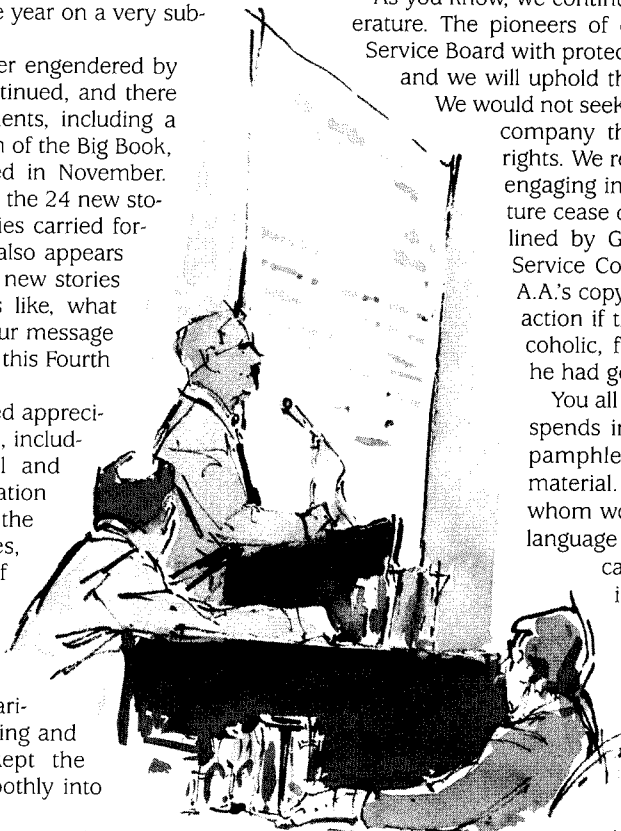
One of these trips was a visit by Greg Muth, Eva Sanchez and Dr. George Vaillant to the People's Republic of China. As a result of a visit by four Chinese doctors to the 2000 International Convention in Minneapolis, and some earlier efforts by members of the San Francisco Intergroup, an A.A. group was formed in a hospital in Beijing. During this visit, Greg and Eva had the opportunity to visit the first treatment center. At the invitation of one of the Chinese physicians, George Vaillant was invited to meet with the medical staff of hospitals in the cities of Beijing and Changchun. He shared, from a professional perspective, his experience with the efficacy of A.A. for his patients who suffer from alcoholism. After George's presentation in the Changchun hospital, Greg and Eva also had the opportunity to hold the first A.A. meeting in that city.

As you know, we continue to uphold copyrights on our A.A. literature. The pioneers of our Fellowship entrusted the General Service Board with protecting the integrity of our A.A. literature, and we will uphold the trust that was placed in our hands.

We would not seek to personally punish any individual or company that infringes on A.A. literature copyrights. We request that any individual or company engaging in copyright infringement of A.A. literature cease doing so. I share the commitment outlined by Gary Glynn, during the 2001 General Service Conference, to our obligation to protect A.A.'s copyrights, "We would be taking the same action if the individual were alcoholic or non-alcoholic, for profit or not-for-profit, or whether he had good or bad motives."

You all know how much time the Conference spends in discussion over making changes to pamphlets, books, and other copyrighted material. Again, we have to ask ourselves: to whom would we complain if we didn't like the language of a piece of A.A. literature? Now we can go to the Conference. However, if an individual or a company publishes the piece, where and to whom do we appeal? Whose group conscience, if any, is at work?

Currently there is nothing new to report regarding the ongoing infringement case in Germany. As you recall, we prevailed with our case in the lower courts. That decision was appealed by the defendant and is now under consideration by the



German Appellate Court. We continue to keep this matter in our prayers and will keep members informed as circumstances unfold.

It is, I believe, important to keep in mind that the protection of A.A.'s copyrights and trademarks is not just the legal obligation of the board, as directed by the Conference. This protection is a spiritual responsibility shared by all members of A.A. For instance, if you become aware of individuals or groups copying chapters of the Twelve and Twelve for distribution within a group, or if you run across a Web site with copyrighted A.A. literature posted, you might consider lovingly making those individuals or groups aware that they should first seek permission of A.A. World Services. It is our experience that gently providing this information is usually all that is required to achieve a positive resolution. In their enthusiasm to carry the message, some simply aren't aware of the facts or the importance of upholding our copyrights.

Since the 51st Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Rochester, New York; Sioux Falls, South Dakota; Albuquerque, New Mexico and Toledo, Ohio. All were well attended by enthusiastic members interested in service. A first ever, Special "Hispanic" Forum," was held in Austin, Texas. Many members from our A.A. Spanish-speaking community attended, and it was not only their first Forum, but their first A.A. General Service event, as well. A Special "Inner City" Forum, held in Chicago in March, was an outstanding success. We hope we achieved our goal, which is really the goal of every Forum we hold: to let members know that the board, the General Service Office and the General Service structure are accessible, and that the doors of service are wide open for their participation.

Financially, G.S.O. did very well, essentially due to initial sales of the Fourth Edition Big Book. Overall sales were greater than in 2000, as were operating expenses, due primarily to the Early Retirement Window and the cost of distributing a complimentary copy of the Fourth Edition Big Book to each registered group as an expression of gratitude to the Fellowship. Once again, we were blessed with a 3.9% increase in contributions over last year.

The 2002 budget projects a decrease in net sales based on an anticipated return to a more normal level of unit sales following the initial spike from the Fourth Edition. The 2002 budget also projects an increase of 2% in contributions. The great news is that we now have seen a four-year trend of increasing contributions. Not only does this mean more money to help the suffering alcoholic with such things as new translations and services, but also mirrors an increased awareness on the part of the Fellowship of the need to participate—that money and spirituality do really mix.

This last year the Grapevine hired a new executive editor, Desmond Towey, who has, as the saying goes, hit the pavement running. Des possesses an infectious enthusiasm and a passionate desire to revitalize the Grapevine and increase subscriptions. We know, of course, Des cannot do this alone. The Grapevine needs the Fellowship to take responsibility for the health and well being of its meeting in print. For several years now, during the Conference, delegates were encouraged to return to their areas and secure ten new subscriptions, which would represent 930 new subscriptions. What an incredible boost that would be for the Grapevine!

The Grapevine had one-time charges associated with outsourcing and reorganization of \$355,230, which brought its total loss for the year to \$451,531, approximately \$115,000 greater than anticipated. The 2002 Grapevine budget anticipates total costs and expenses to be \$1,439,900, essentially bringing expected profit to a break-even level for the year.

La Viña had a higher level of subscriptions than budgeted, but is still operating at a net loss from operations of \$119,385. The

2002 budget for La Viña projects a somewhat smaller loss from operations of \$114,777. Here again, we are offered a challenging opportunity to encourage members of the Spanish-speaking community to support this publication, which has a vital role in carrying A.A.'s message of hope.

Some bittersweet news — G.S.O. staff member Susan Ulseth has announced plans to retire sometime this year. For 27 years Susan has shared her strength, hope and experience with the Fellowship with a loving generosity of spirit that all of us will miss. This 52nd General Service Conference will be Susan's last. We wish her good fortune in the next chapter of her journey.

This past year, serving as the chair of the General Service Board has been personally enriching for me. I have met so many wonderful A.A. members, particularly during the Forums. My depth of gratitude for Alcoholics Anonymous deepens as I share in the compassionate and useful service work A.A. members provide to the still-suffering alcoholic. As you know, the board and the G.S.O. are facilitators of the work that is done one-on-one, on the front lines, with one drunk talking to another drunk. I cannot do what most of you can do — directly carry the message of hope to another. But I tell you, with all humility, how privileged and proud I feel to have been blessed with the gift of serving this society — this Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., chair

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations; review financial reports; price new or revised publications; review publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; and the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, information services director, human resources director, archivist, board secretary, and a Grapevine staff member. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

New Groups — During 2001, a net total of 1,096 new groups were registered with G.S.O.

Group Services — This is a newly revived assignment that was discontinued several years ago when responsibilities were reassigned to other G.S.O. staff assignments. The responsibility of Group Services is to provide communication services to the

Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, primarily through service material. This assignment includes Special Needs and serving as liaison to Intergroup/Central Offices and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. It also encompasses Spanish correspondence and providing services to the Spanish-speaking community in the U.S. and Canada.

Intergroup Seminar — The 16th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S. Seminar was held in Edmonton, Alberta, Canada, September 7-9, 2001.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — G.S.O.'s Web site was visited 1,437,590 times during 2001, approximately 250,000 more than during 2000, and representing approximately 4,000 visits per day. Under "Fellowship Services" on the Web site, Box 4-5-9 and a subscription form for Box 4-5-9 were added. Links have been activated to e-mail addresses and Web sites of Central/Intergroup Offices in the U.S. and Canada. A newly designed Web site will be introduced later in of 2002.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the last Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff have participated in the following Forums: The Northeast Regional Forum in Rochester, New York, June 8-10; the West Central Region Forum in Sioux Falls, South Dakota, August 24-26; the Southwest Regional Forum in Albuquerque, New Mexico, September 28-30; and the East Central Regional Forum in Toledo, Ohio, October 12-14. A Special "Hispanic" Forum was held in Austin, Texas, December 8-9, with over 270 Spanish-speaking A.A.s in attendance. A Special "Inner City" Forum was held in Chicago, March 23-24, 2002. Recent Forums have employed enhanced visual presentations utilizing PowerPoint, the "Early Bird" newsletter, full-Forum Workshops, and the evening ice cream social — all have been greeted with enthusiasm.

Visitors to G.S.O. — G.S.O. welcomed 1,624 visitors during 2001.

Visits by G.S.O. Staff to Overseas Service Structures — General Service Office staff enjoyed visits with trusted servants and A.A. members in service structures in other countries:

Europe: In July, Eva Sanchez and Vinnie McCarthy visited with members in the service structures in Vienna; Budapest; and the three Turkish cities of Ankara, Istanbul and Izmir. In September, Eva attended the 4th Annual A.A. Convention in Revan, Slovakia and visited the Slovakian G.S.O. in Bratislava. Eva also visited the Central Service Office in Kiev, Ukraine, during this trip. Greg Muth and Bill Archer attended the 11th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, in October with 40 delegates from more than 20 countries participating.

Latin America: Bill also attended the Second General Service Conference in Havana, Cuba, in December.

Asia/Oceania: Eva and Greg traveled to India to visit with their General Service Board, and attended the 27th General Service Conference and the anniversary of A.A. in Bangalore, May 11-20. During August, Greg and Eva traveled to Japan and China. In Japan, they visited the Japan Service Office in Tokyo and the A.A. Central Office in Osaka. In China, they were joined by Class A trustee Dr. George Vaillant and visited with key medical professionals at leading hospitals in Beijing and Changchun. They also met with Chinese A.A. groups. Greg and Bill attended the 4th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Seoul, Korea, in October. Then, in November, Bill attended the 10th International Korean Convention in Kyonju. During January 2002, Greg visited the G.S.O. in Wellington, New Zealand, and the New Zealand National Convention in Christchurch.

International Visitors to G.S.O. in New York — The following members of other service structures were warmly welcomed to the G.S.O. and attended A.A.W.S. Board meetings: Lawrie Fernandes, chairman of the board/India, and Pushan Vaidya, trustee of the board/India were guests for the July 2001 General

Service Board weekend. Victor Barcenas, Class A trustee/chairman of the Mexican General Service Board, along with Class B trustees Daniel Olmos and Francisco Valdez, were guests during the October 2001 General Service Board weekend.

Financial Results for 2001 — A brief summary of the financial results for 2001 reflected the following: gross sales of \$11,419,000 were approximately \$1,911,000 (20%) greater than budgeted, and \$1,832,000 (19%) greater than during the year 2000. Non-A.A. sales accounted for 19.1% of total sales income in 2001, compared with 19.6% in 2000. Sales of the Fourth Edition Big Book in November and December 2001 were approximately \$2,197,000 and were comprised of 366,000 hardcover, 126,000 softcover, and 20,000 large-print books. Contributions received for the year of \$4,688,000 were approximately \$94,000 (2%) over budget and \$177,600 (3.9%) over 2000. Total revenue (gross profit from literature, contributions and interest) for 2001 was \$10,630,000, \$907,000 (9.3%) greater than budgeted and \$828,000 (8.4%) greater than in 2000. Sales accounted for approximately \$799,000 and contributions accounted for about \$94,000. Total operating expenses, for the 12-month period ending December 31, 2001, were \$10,226,601, approximately \$662,000 more than budgeted and \$1,437,000 higher than in 2000. In summary, net income for the year was \$403,761.

2002 Budget — Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended G.S.O.'s 2002 budget to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. The budget projects \$9,528,000 in gross sales, \$4,764,000 in gross profit, \$4,794,000 in contributions, and \$9,536,900 in total revenue. Total expenses are projected at \$10,267,000 with a \$727,000 net loss budgeted for the year 2002. The board approved the transfer of \$200,000 to the General Service Board's Reserve Fund.

Publishing — G.S.O.'s longtime Publications director, Vincina ("Vinnie") McCarthy passed away suddenly on December 7, 2001. A large number of G.S.O. employees attended services for Vinnie in Babylon, Long Island, New York. A Resolution, passed by the board, was presented to Vinnie's family, recognizing her many contributions to G.S.O., the A.A.W.S. Board and the Fellowship, here and around the world.

Fourth Edition Big Book — On November 9, 2001, a complimentary copy of the first printing of the Fourth Edition Big Book was shipped to each group in the U.S. and Canada in appreciation of their members' voices and their support of the group conscience that made the Fourth Edition possible. The Publications Department, including Order Entry, Inventory Control, and Shipping, together with the strong support of our warehouses, worked diligently to process and ship more than 4,000 orders in a single month. A press release announcing publication of the Fourth Edition Big Book was sent to more than 8,000 media outlets. The board approved pricing of the Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, at \$5.00.

Unit Distribution of Books — Our 2001 budget was based on distributing 1,498,671 books; however, due to the publication of the Fourth Edition Big Book, we actually distributed 1,937,017 books in 2001 — an increase of 438,346 units, or 29.25% over budget. In 2001, we processed approximately 34,000 paid literature orders (not including approximately 12,000 no-charge orders), about 7,000 (25%) more than in 2000.

Pricing of Audio and Electronic Formats of English Fourth Edition Big Book — A price structure for audio and electronic formats of the English language Fourth Edition Big Book was approved as follows: Cassettes: \$60.00; CDs: \$85.00; CD-ROMs: \$60.00; Floppy Disks: \$20.00. (20% discount applies.)

Pricing of Pamphlets — The board approved a price of 40¢ for the pamphlet "Can A.A. Help Me, Too?, Black/African Americans Share Their Stories." The board also approved a 40¢ price for "A.A.



for the Older Alcoholic," which replaced "Time to Start Living."

Special Format Approved — The board approved the printing of a large-print, soft-cover version of *Daily Reflections*. Pricing will be determined after this item has been produced.

Translation of Fourth Edition Big Book Stories into French and Spanish — The board approved translating and publishing the personal stories in the Fourth Edition Big Book into French and Spanish, with the cost of these translations estimated at \$25,000 for each language.

Translations Approved — Translation of the Big Book into Simplified Chinese (as read in the People's Republic of China) at a projected cost of \$28,000; translation of the Big Book into Cambodian at a projected cost of \$28,000. These two translations will result in an increase of approximately \$40,000 in Literature Assistance expense.

Completed — The following Spanish-language items were completed and priced according to our policy, i.e., English equivalent: "A.A.'s Legacy of Service"; Archives Guidelines; Carrying the Message to the Deaf Alcoholic; and the revised *Living Sober*. Also, the following items in other languages were completed — English equivalent (unless provided on a complimentary basis): Burmese: "A Newcomer Asks" and "This is A.A."; Simplified Chinese: Big Book, "44 Questions," "Information on A.A." (complimentary); Croatian: "Young People and A.A." and "Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A."; Finnish, Czech and Greek: "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" (complimentary); Hebrew: "Is A.A. for You?" and "A Newcomer Asks"; Mongolian: "Information on A.A." (complimentary); Turkish: "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed" and "Understanding Anonymity."

Translations Completed by Other Countries — India: Bengali Big Book; Taiwan: Chinese *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. Pricing was approved on the Croatian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, \$5.00; Mongolian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, \$5.00.

Copyright Infringement — After A.A.W.S. prevailed in the lower courts, the defendant appealed the decision. The German Appellate Court is still considering the case. We continue to pray for a quick conclusion to the matter.

Domain Name Dispute Resolution Policy — Continuing efforts to communicate with owners of Domain Names similar to our registered marks have resulted in most agreeing to transfer those names to A.A.W.S. During January 2002, however, we received word from WIPO (World Intellectual Property Organization) that our request for transfer of the Domain Name, <AlcoholicAnonymous.org>, had been declined. Several options are before the A.A.W.S. Board and there will be further discussion during the months ahead.

New Board Officers and Directors — The board elected a slate of officers to serve through the April 2002 Conference. The board welcomed new trustee director R.J.M. (Ric) Downey, who replaced rotating trustee director Jim Clough in May 2001. Through its Nominating Committee, the board selected Ronald J. Gauthier to serve as a general service trustee, replacing Jacqueline Johnston, who will rotate following the April 2002 Conference. Paul Cleary and Don Miller were selected to replace Ronald J. Gauthier and Jan Polek as A.A.W.S. Board directors following the

April 2002 Conference. Doug Richardson replaced Joanie Moncrief at the September 10, 2001 staff rotation as staff coordinator and A.A.W.S. director. All recommendations were forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

World Trade Center Tragedy — The office closed early on September 11, 2001, the day of the tragedy and, after consultation with the Grapevine, remained closed the following day. There was a tremendous outpouring of love and support from everyone all across the United States, Canada and around the world.

Work Force — At year-end 2001, G.S.O. had 79 full-time positions plus seven part-time positions. Julio Espallat joined the G.S.O. staff on July 2, 2001, following the July 1 retirement of Danny Mooney.

Office Computer Upgrades — G.S.O. has been in final contract negotiations with its "back office" software vendor, Computer Solutions International, Inc., clarifying costs, schedules, duties and responsibilities, along with implementation sequencing. The preliminary schedule projects an October 2002 completion date, with total costs—included in the 2002 budget—to be close to \$200,000.

Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes Inc. — The directors of Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes (S.M.A.A.), an affiliate corporation of A.A.W.S., Inc., held meetings on a quarterly basis since the last Conference. At the February 1, 2002 meeting, the directors received reports on the operations and finances of the corporation during 2001. For the 12-month period ended December 31, 2001, a loss of \$21,000 (U.S.) was recorded. The directors reviewed and accepted the S.M.A.A. budget for 2002, allowing for a budgeted loss of \$23,000 (U.S.), which was forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. All S.M.A.A. financial results are combined with A.A.W.S. totals.

Beth Rabren, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The first Archives Workbook was produced in 2001, the result of a lengthy evolution of archives literature in A.A. In recent years, a number of area committees have developed their own archives structures and formed archives committees, consequently it was evident that there was growing need to publish a collection of shared experience in archives service. Besides consulting the Archives Handbook, that was formerly available from G.S.O. Archives, numerous area workbooks were also consulted. Excerpts from area sharings were included in the new workbook. The content will be regularly updated upon expressed need and with new, relevant information.

An archives service piece was developed over the course of 2001. The service piece is directed, in its tone and language, to those members who are not familiar with archives, explaining the many ways a member may get involved in archives service.

The trustees' Archives Committee reviewed the effort to-date that had gone into possible updating of the "Markings on the Journey" video, which had aged and become less useful in many

ways, including the technical presentation and audio quality. A new producer was selected to develop a revised and updated video. A rough draft video was reviewed by the committee at the February 2002 meeting.

Gregory Tobin, Chairperson

Archivist's Report: This has been a year of transformations in many ways. While we continued to receive large volumes of correspondence, the nature of correspondence has been slowly shifting to e-mail communication replacing regular mail correspondence. We continued the transfer of our voluminous audio collection to CD-ROMs, and we are very pleased that the audio preservation continues to proceed in a highly satisfactory fashion, both in its pace and quality.

In May, a new scanning software was installed replacing the old program. The previously scanned documents were successfully transferred to the new system. Our database is gradually building up and now contains our full library collection. In the meantime, we continue to process our historic photos and early group correspondence. Early group records were transferred from Files to Archives, as our goal remains to preserve the original records besides capturing their image electronically. Group records are being transferred in archival quality folders and boxes, and that is no small undertaking, in light of the large volume of records that have been compiled at the General Service Office.

We have produced a second traveling exhibit to accommodate the increased interest in the exhibit as well as to assure that we have a backup exhibit if the original is delayed or damaged with shipping.

We hope that many of you will come and enjoy the renewed appearance of our exhibit area at the General Service Office. The photos were reframed with new captions added to create a more attractive and more informative research and reading area for our visitors.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 2001 General Service Conference. During that period, we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2001 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 52nd General Service Conference, "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts."

We reviewed a summary of the 2001 Conference Evaluations Questionnaire. Several suggestions were made, including a suggestion to schedule the joint meetings of the 2002 General Service Conference in two different time slots so that trustees and directors may attend more joint meetings. In addition, based on comments regarding the workshops, the committee sug-

gested that there be different topics discussed in each of the 10 workshop sections or that a focus question for discussion be provided for each section.

The committee agreed to send a request to consider the establishment of a trustees' Committee on Special Needs/Accessibilities to the General Service Board for further discussion. Later during an executive session at its October 2001 meeting, the Board considered the request to establish a trustees' Committee on Special Needs/Accessibilities, and it was agreed that this work would be best served by the Group Services assignment at the General Service Office.

The committee reviewed a subcommittee's report on the use of laptops at the General Service Conference, as well as the spiritual, practical, and financial implications of using an electronic voting system during the Conference, and suggested that the subcommittee continue to meet in order to gather additional information. Later, at its January meeting, the committee agreed that a two-year trial period, using 24 (user supplied) laptops/PCs, during General Sessions at the Conference should start with the 2002 General Service Conference. In addition, the committee agreed that 24 seating spaces, complete with power outlets, would be made available during the Conference. The Conference coordinator will notify all Conference members regarding the two-year trial experiment. (Conference members wishing to participate in the trial will be asked to submit a request for space in writing; 24 participants will then be drawn from the hat.)

In response to a request, the committee agreed to forward a report regarding the spiritual, practical and financial implications of using electronic voting systems during a General Service Conference to the 2002 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

We reviewed and accepted the committee's 2002 budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. In addition, the committee reviewed the preliminary main agenda for the 52nd General Service Conference, and approved workshop questions, which were distributed in the Communications Kit that was mailed to all Conference members January 2, 2002.

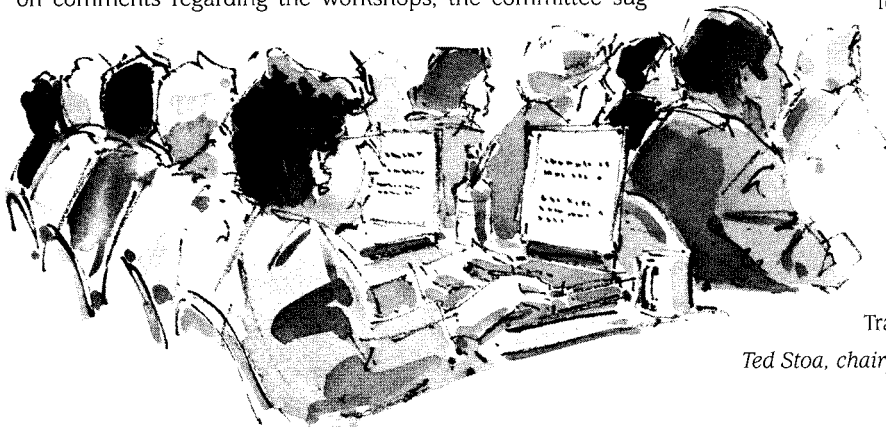
The committee discussed the possibility of future requests by Conference members wishing to make PowerPoint presentations and requested that the staff member on the Conference assignment draft guidelines for PowerPoint presentations at the Conference. At its January meeting, the committee agreed on guidelines for the use of electronic imaging equipment during Conference presentations and suggested that more generic phrasing replace references to MS PowerPoint. Guidelines will be sent out on request.

In January, we finalized and approved the main Conference Agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the 2001 Conference. We

forwarded over 30 suggested Conference agenda topics to trustees' and Conference committees, and to A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards and discussed four of these topics in great detail. Finally, it was with great pleasure that we welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to the January meeting.

Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a wonderful Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given us through "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts" of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Ted Stoa, chairperson



Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

Created in 1951, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference became in July 1955 "the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Doctor Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service manual*, pp. S89-S90)

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referral to a Conference committee. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an in house team of G.S.O. employees working behind the scenes to help to make the Conference week a memorable experience.

Warren Stafford

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The trustee's Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2001 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities has met three times. The committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure was revised February, 2002.

The committee's work embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board. Highlights of trustees' committee meetings have been sent to area, district and other C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities chairs, in addition to current sharing that could benefit local committees.

Cooperation With the Professional Community — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come into contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

Forty-two national exhibits were coordinated by G.S.O. for 2001. In addition, 54 local exhibit invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees. Exhibit evaluations were very positive and encouraged G.S.O. to continue exhibiting at these events. The committee reviewed the preliminary 2002 Exhibit list, and made suggestions for future events to be added to the list.

Several Class A trustees will attend the World Forum Montreal

2002, September 22-27, 2002, where the A.A. exhibit will be staffed. Class A trustees have submitted their presentations on subjects that relate to Alcoholics Anonymous as a resource for professionals.

About A.A.: The Winter issue of *About A.A.*, our newsletter to professionals, featured "A.A. as a Resource for Professionals," with articles on our "Cooperation with Court Programs," an interview with Class A trustee Allen Ault, a Ground Zero report, and information on A.A. for the newcomer (Fourth Edition Big Book, and new pamphlets "Can A.A. Help Me, Too? Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic").

The C.P.C. staff member attended a National Summit sponsored by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services and SAMHSA (Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration). She accompanied the general manager and the P.I. staff member to a day of sharing at the Greater Alcoholism Council of New York where NCADD (National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence) was the host. Also attending were representatives of Al-Anon Family Groups, New York Greater Intergroup Association, and the N.Y. Al-Anon office. December 11, 2001, the C.P.C. and Public Information staff members traveled to Washington D.C. to meet with Drug Court Professionals and discuss ways A.A. can cooperate with court programs. Narcotics Anonymous representatives were also present at the meeting.

Preliminary work is underway to host an Open House on June 11 for staff of agencies in the Interchurch Center to visit G.S.O. and the Grapevine Office so that these friends will be aware of A.A. as a resource for their agencies.

Two subcommittees were appointed, one to explore our "singleness of purpose" statement, and one regarding A.A.'s nonaffiliation with religion in C.P.C. pamphlets. The subcommittee on "singleness of purpose" reported that they did not feel that singleness of purpose would be better described by moving paragraphs in the existing C.P.C. pamphlets under consideration. The trustees' Committee approved the report and offered the following suggestions: 1) Continue to publish articles in *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9* on A.A.'s singleness of purpose, emphasizing Tradition Three, "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking;" 2) Share with C.P.C. committees the need to communicate to professionals the value of A.A.'s singleness of purpose; 3) Review the C.P.C. Workbook and Kit to assure there is sufficient information in each on our singleness of purpose; and, 4) Consider a service piece on "Singleness of Purpose is A.A.'s Strength," similar to the Summer 2001 issue of *About A.A.*

The subcommittee established to consider possible language for C.P.C. pamphlets to clarify A.A.'s nonaffiliation with religion concluded that the C.P.C. pamphlets were fine as written and made no suggestions for new copy to be added. We forwarded these suggestions to the Conference C.P.C. Committee: 1) Consider different modes of communicating what is meant by "spirituality" in A.A. during workshops and sharing sessions and, in communications with professionals, utilize C.P.C. pamphlets as well as *About A.A.*; 2) Look for ways to improve cooperation with staff in treatment centers who may have misgivings about A.A. as a resource for their clients; and, 3) Find ways to introduce dis-

When Buck Rose (District of Columbia) was waiting on the taxi line at Penn. Station, the gentleman behind him asked if he were in town for business or pleasure. Buck said, "I'm in town for a week-long A.A. conference." The man replied in disbelief, "You're gonna drink for a week?"

cussions of "spirituality in A.A." at Regional and Special Forums.

Treatment Facilities — The committee's work with A.A. in Treatment Facilities includes considering the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities

Workbook and Kit. The committee also assists local committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging the Gap by providing guidance on request, and by exchanging information through articles in *Box 4-5-9*.

Our committee revised the annual informational letter to professionals associated with treatment centers and/or involved in counseling clients who may be alcoholics. Last October, the letter was sent to over 18,700 such professionals in the U.S. and Canada. Some professionals responded by requesting additional information and/or contact with a local T.F. committee.

We began a search for an appointed committee member to replace a committee member who rotates in April 2002. After interviews, the committee hopes to forward the name of one applicant to the trustees' Nominating Committee for approval.

Marne Hill, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The C.P.C. assignment is responsible for providing information about A.A. to professionals who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work. These professionals include clergy, physicians, nurses, attorneys, correctional facilities personnel, social workers, counselors, educators, and those working in the field of alcoholism. The C.P.C. coordinator and her most helpful assistant maintain communication with C.P.C. committee chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons are sent a welcome letter and receive the C.P.C. Kit containing the C.P.C. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines, Conference and trustees' Committee History and Actions, C.P.C. pamphlets, a Catalog of Conference-Approved Literature, *Box 4-5-9*, and a current issue of *About A.A.* Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience and providing C.P.C. material. Currently, there are about 500 area, district and central office/intergroup C.P.C. committees. We receive committee meeting minutes from committees and encourage all to share their experience for possible inclusion in *Box 4-5-9*.

In 2001 the C.P.C. staff member responded to over 2,000 inquiries from professionals; 1,303 of these were requests for information which followed visits to our A.A. Web site. Today, many professionals can share that not only does A.A. respond in a friendly manner and provide literature, but many have been put in touch with C.P.C. committee members in their communities who are available to serve as A.A. resources.

Forty-two exhibits were coordinated for national professional meetings for 2001 and staffed by local C.P.C. committees. Fifty-four invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees for local professional events. In addition, G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continued to be an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals and often result in requests for additional A.A.



information, as well as requests to receive issues of our publication *About A.A.* Currently more than 14,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

One national meeting asked for A.A. meetings during a weekend conference, which our local C.P.C. area chairperson set up.

Meetings with students from Cornell University Medical Center, coordinated by the staff member on C.P.C., continue to be set up throughout the year at G.S.O. The aim is to make these future physicians aware that A.A. can be a valuable resource when working with the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, shown the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous," given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend several "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. has traveled to Washington, D.C. to attend the C.S.A.T. (Center for Substance Abuse Treatment) planning meetings, as an A.A. resource, for Recovery Month, which will be September 2002, where the theme is "Join the Voices of Recovery: A Call to Action." She has also attended NIAAA (National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism) meetings as a liaison.

Susan Ulseth

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 87 Area Treatment Facilities committee chairpersons, plus nearly 300 district and "other" T.F. chairpersons, as well as 20 area Bridging the Gap and 16 area Hospitals and Institutions committee chairpersons. Each is involved in one or more facets of A.A. in a treatment setting. Some local committees are combined with Correctional Facilities, Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, or Public Information to serve more than one function.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference C.P.C. committee, (C.P.C.), Conference Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities committees. Periodically, we share similar information with area, district and other T.F. chairs for the benefit of the committees they chair.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter enclosing the Treatment Facilities Kit or Workbook, as well as A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date list of all area T.F. committee chairs so that they can communicate and pass on contact information for newcomers exiting treatment. Correspondence from local committees is always welcomed with a prompt response. A number of committees share activities with other local committees and with G.S.O. so that all may benefit by new ideas and ways of reaching the alcoholic in treatment. Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to approach clients within the regulations established by the facility. We are especially grateful for writ-

ten shared experience that may be useful for a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. Each of these receives a reply from the staff member, and many are referred to local committees for additional sharing. Requests from professionals responding to the annual Treatment Facilities mailing receive careful attention and follow up. Each is sent literature, and those asking for local contact are referred appropriately. The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Joanie Moncrief

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2001 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times.

We followed through on the Conference Committee's suggestion that information be added to the service piece that accompanies the video "Carrying the Message Behind the Walls," to help alleviate fears regarding security in a correctional facility; and to show that previous incarceration is not required to share practical, sober A.A. experience in a correctional facility. The service piece that accompanies the video was also added to the Correctional Facilities Kit and placed in the service files at the General Service Office.

The committee requested that the secretary gather shared experience from young people who carry the A.A. message into correctional facilities and from A.A. members who were incarcerated as young people and achieved sobriety at an early age. This sharing will be included in a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*. The committee also asked that the secretary highlight any sharing received from young people who are incarcerated in the newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*.

The alternate year mailing to Correctional professionals was sent in August. A total of 7,820 letters were mailed to wardens, superintendents and other correctional professionals. To date we have responded to over 120 requests for additional information and/or for contacts with the local C.F. committees.

Linda Chezem, Class A trustee and a member of this committee and Jim Estelle, trustee emeritus, participated in the National Institute of Corrections Interactive Video Conference, entitled "Critical Knowledge of Twelve Step Programs," that took place on August 29, 2001. During the video conference the A.A. Fellowship and Traditions were clearly presented.

It was also suggested that cooperation between Correctional Facilities and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees continue in order to reach correctional professionals.

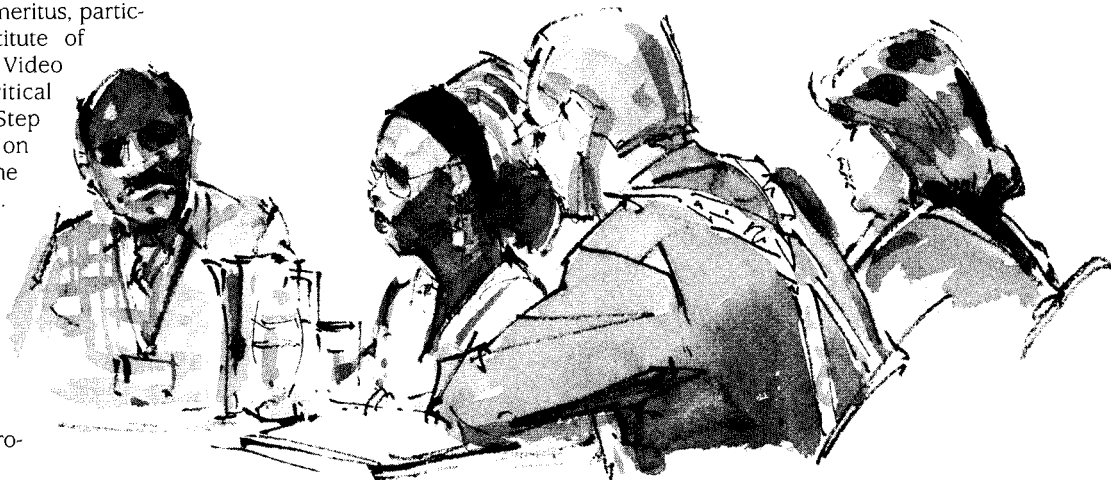
The committee will continue to discuss ways to

encourage members to carry the message into Juvenile Detention Centers, as well as participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service.

Jim Clough, chairperson

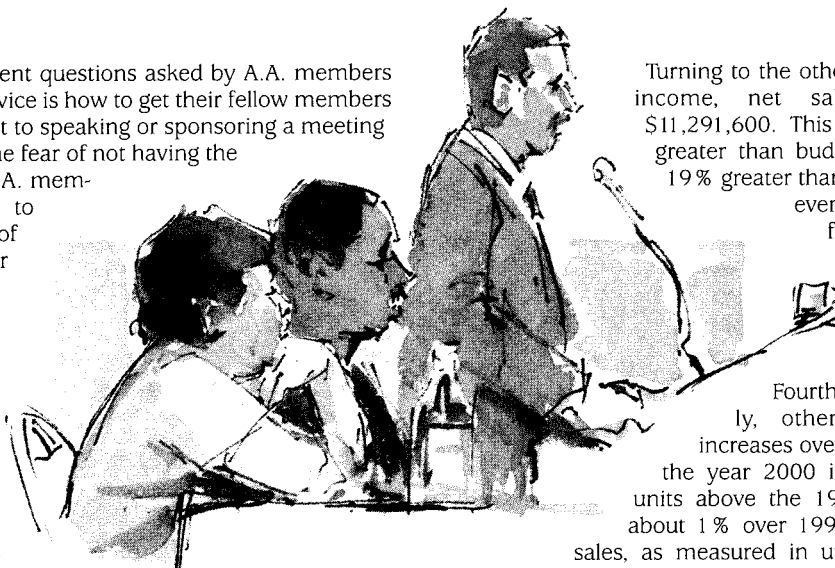
Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Over 500 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from experienced A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. We have available a service piece about our CCS (F-26) which we include in new group packages; it may also be ordered for group literature stands. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet, whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of F-26 service pieces, there have been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the "inside." Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis. The rewards can be great, as shared by an outside correspondent: "I guess I just want you to know how highly I think of the Corrections Correspondence Program. I am only one voice, but I talk about it whenever I can. Please feel free to use me as a resource or reference for this program. My involvement with corrections work has given life a whole new meaning. Thank you for your efforts."



One of the more persistent questions asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls," a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Julio Espallat



Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$11,291,600. This was \$1,882,000, or 20% greater than budgeted, and \$1,830,200, or 19% greater than the previous year. I'm sure everyone knows that the reason for this is the release of the Fourth Edition Big Book. Unfortunately it is hard to estimate what the number of books sold would have been without the

Fourth Edition. However, generally, other titles showed modest increases over the prior year. This follows the year 2000 increase of 3%, or 40,700 units above the 1999 level, which was itself about 1% over 1998 levels. That means book sales, as measured in units, finally stabilized after

declining over the last ten years.

In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were significantly ahead of budget, as were sales. As a result of Fourth Edition sales, gross profit of \$5,900,000 was \$796,500 more than budgeted and \$679,500 more than realized in 2000.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$10,608,700, some \$907,000, or 9.3%, greater than originally budgeted, and \$836,200, or 8.5%, greater than 2000.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2001 were \$10,226,700. This is \$661,900 more than budget, and \$1,437,425, or 16% higher than the previous year. Therefore, compared to the budget, the increase in revenues was offset by the increased expenses, resulting in an operating profit of \$382,000 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budget and approximately \$600,000 less than the previous year. However, these results are somewhat misleading. As noted previously, substantial revenue was realized by sales of the Fourth Edition — not in the original budget. Additionally, a decision was reached to mail a copy of the new edition at no charge to each registered group. These expenses were not included in our original budget. Finally, an early retirement program was approved and implemented during the year, and, again, these expenses were not budgeted. So, while the final results were significantly better than our original budget roadmap, the route to our final destination was somewhat circuitous!

In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 2000 it was just about 9.9 months, in my opinion, about where it should be in normal times. At the end of 2001 the balance was about 11 months.

At \$10,337,400 (the adjusted balance used for the calculation) the Reserve Fund amounts to \$184 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$83 for the 56,210 groups registered, while expenses (excluding costs associated with the Early Retirement Window) to support services to those groups averaged \$118 per group.

Turning to 2002, the G.S.O. budget assumes relatively flat unit sales of books and booklets after taking into account the expected "bulge" effect of initial sales of the Fourth Edition. In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget also

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2001 and reported that the G.S.O. expected income from operations of \$137,000, was essentially the same level as we had budgeted in the previous two years. Fortunately, we were pleasantly surprised by more good news than bad news in both the prior two years, and were able to exceed our budget projections. This followed substantial, but planned, losses in 1995, 1996 and 1997 that helped to lower the Reserve Fund balance. Today I can report, as I have the last two years, that actual results for 2001 were considerably better than the proposed budget. Having previously accomplished the mandate of lowering the Reserve Fund balance, we added approximately \$500,000 from 1999 results, and a substantial addition in 2001 based on the good results of 2000. The Reserve Fund balance at 12/31/2001 represented approximately 11.6 months of operating expenses. Today, after the 2002 transfer, the balance stands at just about 11.0 months.

General Service Office — As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2001 were higher than both those received in 2000, and the amount we had hoped to receive for 2001. This represents the fourth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and reflects a positive trend. Contributions of \$4,688,800 were \$177,600, or 3.9% higher than 2000 and \$93,800, or slightly more than 2.0% higher than our budget as well. The \$4,688,800 in contributions were received from 25,361 groups. That, for comparison, represents 45.1% of the 56,210 groups registered with G.S.O., and is exactly one percentage point higher than the previous year. While contributions were up, more importantly, both the number and percent of groups contributing increased, if even slightly. Last year I suggested that perhaps we have reached a bottom in the percentage of groups who choose to support G.S.O.'s work. Let's hope that this is the beginning of a new positive trend.

During a discussion on electronic voting, Tom Guest (North Florida) responded, "Being from the state of Florida, we have expertise in vote counting."

includes a 2% increase in contributions. The budget envisions a less than 1% increase in operating expenses. This follows a larger than usual increase in operating expenses from 2000 to 2001. Based on these primary assumptions — level literature unit sales; a 2.0% increase in contributions; a .6% increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 2002 is for an excess of expense over revenue of \$750,450.

As I have mentioned in previous reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Now, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, as we noted last year, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12-month level. We were grateful when last year the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap Plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We expect that to happen this year.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2001 we spent \$6,685,690 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$542,400, or 9% more than the \$6,143,300 spent in 2000. This compares with \$5,876,500 spent in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998 and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 70% of this and 30% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 73% and 27% last year.) This year, no funds were needed from the Reserve Fund for G.S.O. services.

Services spending amounted to \$118 per listed A.A. group, up \$13 from last year, while contributions were about \$83 per group, up \$3.00. The 2001 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 35.7% (which includes the Group Services assignment); Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 13.1%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 11.9%; Trustees' and Directors' activities, 7%; Regional Forums, 5.5%; Archives, 8.7%; C.P.C., 5.5%; Spanish Services, 3.6%; Public Information, 3.7%; Correctional Facilities, 3.5%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.7%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with last year, as was circulation. Average circulation during 2001 was 115,000, compared with 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 in 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,028,600, which was \$78,800 less than last year and \$57,000 less than budget as well. Revenue of Other Items was \$86,800, less than budgeted, and \$79,000 less than last year as well. Gross profit on Other Items, was approximately \$45,000 less than 2000. The major reason for the under-budget condition was that a book anticipated at budget time was not produced. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,357,400, approximately \$132,000 less than last year and \$94,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,453,700. This is \$50,000 less than last year and just about on budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a loss of \$96,300 before one-time charges, some \$96,000 more than budgeted, and \$80,000 more than 2000.

One-time expenses associated with the outsourcing and reorganization of \$355,000 resulted in a loss of \$451,531 for 2001. In 2000, I noted that both management and the Grapevine Board worked diligently to get the Grapevine back to a self-supporting position. With approval of the General Service Board, the trustees' Finance Committee had encouraged the Grapevine Board to pursue the outsourcing and reorganization, which was completed during 2001. As a result of these efforts, I think the Grapevine should return to modest profitability in future years.

The Grapevine's 2002 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2002¹

	Groups	Members
United States	51,245	1,160,651
Canada	4,965	97,124
Sub-Total	56,210	1,257,775
Correctional facilities ²	2,531	66,036
Internationalists		105
Lone members		315
Total	58,741	1,324,231
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	41,390	891,062
Grand Total	100,131	2,215,293

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 51 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

\$1,000 increase in magazine subscription income to \$1,754,800, compared with 2001, with a decrease in magazine gross profit of \$18,800, resulting in a gross profit of \$1,009,800. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to decrease \$105,000, while interest income should be slightly less. This break-even projection for 2002 compares with a \$96,300 actual loss last year, and, when accomplished (note that I said when, not if), will put a halt to seven consecutive years of operating losses for the Grapevine.

La Viña — As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2001 average circulation of close to 8,600, (up slightly from 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, but and not significantly higher than 8,400 in 1997). Personally speaking, La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see continued growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past five and one-half years. During 2001, subscription income was \$70,250 and direct costs of publishing were \$62,000, resulting in a \$8,200 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$127,600. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project for the year was \$119,400.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2002, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to remain substantially unchanged at \$114,800 and circulation is projected to increase slightly to around 9,000 copies. The

Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$564,300 has been invested in La Viña, and, as you know, the General Service Board recommended last year that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

In summary, the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition, the outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 52nd General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic of the July 2001 session was "Let's Share About Our Committees: Is each fulfilling its purpose? Do we need to combine one or more committees, or consider a new committee?" The October topic was "Participation — Sharing G.S.O. Services with the Fellowship: — Ways to encourage groups to use our services; scope of services — too much? too little?" In February 2002, the session focused on "The A.A. Grapevine: A Tool of Unity and Recovery."

July 2001 — Grapevine director Susan Campbell suggested that the work of some committees has changed as the world around us has changed. She also suggested that "as the world changes with the Internet, A.A. is becoming known in parts of the world where it could not have reached just a few years ago. The Internet has created a need for new committees in some areas and changed the role of some current committees." Susan felt that each of the current trustees' committees was vital, but the committees needed to be careful to avoid creating work simply to justify their existence. Pacific regional trustee Jim Clough shared that most board committees have specific procedures tied to the Fellowship through the Conference Committees and to G.S.O. through the corresponding staff member and the desk they occupy for a two-year rotation. This system itself seems to fulfill the underlying purpose with each committee receiving communications from the Fellowship, discussing, and possibly passing those requests along to the appropriate Conference committee. In many cases, the Conference passes an Advisory Action concerning those requests and may send it back to the trustees' Committee for further action and/or development. In the changes made in 1998, Jim probably would have combined the meetings for C.P.C. with P.I., and/or Corrections with Treatment. He believes that combining the committee meetings has worked well. Enough time has passed since the implementation of the 1998 changes to take a good, new look at how things are working.

A.A.W.S. director Jan Polek shared that much of her life outside A.A. had been spent in the political arena. She has attended hundreds of committee meetings. She noted that business and political organizations view committees as a way to "get things done" without involving the whole group, and, as a result, committees can gain enormous power as can the committee chair, the one who wields the power. The role of the committee chair in A.A. is vastly different. The chair often has the least voice in a committee discussion. His or her primary role is to see that the agenda is met and that there is full and democratic discussion. A greater

difference between committees inside and outside A.A. as it relates to committee chairs and their power is that the success of the committee system within A.A. relies solely on "trust." Jan concluded,

"The system works today because we trust the committee members. That doesn't mean we must approve every recommendation of every committee; nor does it mean that we must be unanimous or suffer in silence. It

does ask us to trust that the committee has provided us with all the pertinent information so that we can reach an informed group conscience. And, most important, it asks us to attribute to the committee members the same lofty level of pure motives that we have for ourselves. That purity of motives is rare in politics, but it is in the very air we breathe in Alcoholics Anonymous!"

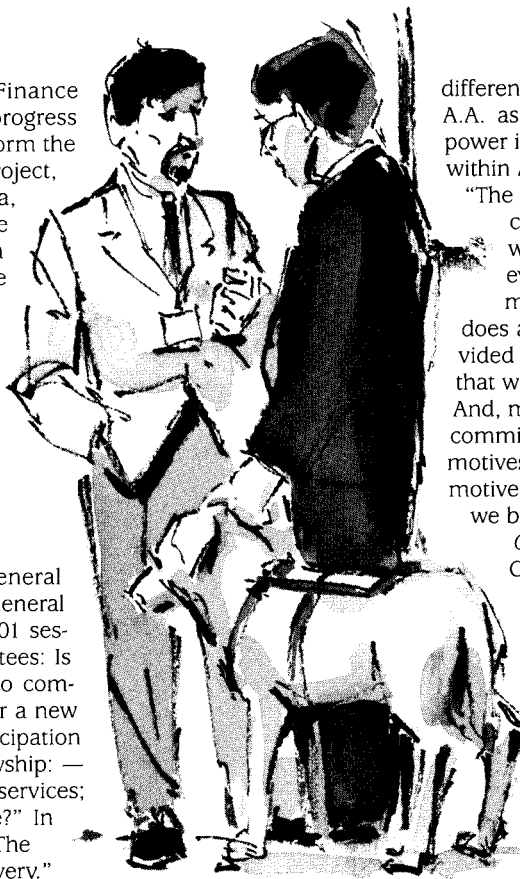
October 2001 — Trustee-at-large/U.S. Charles Bartell, shared that the General Service Office was critical to the Third Legacy efforts of Alcoholics Anonymous as a central clearing-house for communication within the Fellowship. He rhetorically asked, "Do we need to increase or decrease the scope of service?" His reply, "I think not — past experiences have served the Fellowship well." A.A. groups will let us know when additional services are required. Charlie mentioned that Regional Forums are the "real jewels" of service effort. He also

encouraged members to make direct contact with G.S.O.

A.A. World Services director Jane Sheppard shared that she and members of her home group "... have always been 'hooked' into the service structure." However, she expressed concern for those groups that either don't have a G.S.R. or one that is not active. Services "may remain hidden" from these groups. How to communicate the services that are available is important, and that this might be done through Regional Forums, delegates and the simple act of calling G.S.O. directly. She also emphasized the importance of keeping group records up-to-date.

Over his years of service, Class A trustee Art Knight spoke of often hearing about "unregistered groups," groups listed but somehow not found, and groups that are known to exist, but not registered. "In other words, groups not participating," he said. Art asked, "Is our topic really 'Ways to encourage groups to use our services' or should it be 'Ways to encourage groups to join in the Unity of the Fellowship?' "In the light of Unity, Art wondered if there was some way "to bring the feeling of the whole Fellowship to every A.A. group." He continued, "Would our sense of unity — participation — kindle even more Twelfth Step effort?" He speculated about how participation might increase participation in service if every G.S.R., D.C.M., and area officer sought out each group known or rumored to be meeting, and shared with those groups, one at a time, about A.A. as a whole. In closing, Art said, "I don't believe we have to find ways to encourage groups to use our services. I don't believe the scope of our services is too much, or too little ... what I suggest is that we need to build upon something ... something we already have ... something that is at the core of this Fellowship ... unity through participation. Perhaps the time has come for the service structure to reach out, in different ways, to every group — registered and unregistered — and share with every group the wonderful unity of being a part of this amazing Fellowship. I wonder, if we did that, what would happen."

When the presentations concluded, a staff member applauded



the idea of having someone in the service structure visit each group and share about service and unity. A trustee also concurred with the importance of groups being visited. It takes time to visit groups, but it's worth it. An appointed committee member shared that when she moved to her district, the D.C.M. had never visited the groups or shared about Traditions. As a new D.C.M. herself, she visited groups. "It was hard work, time consuming and wonderful," she said. An A.A.W.S. director mentioned that unity and service were connected and that both offered groups a window into the wide world of A.A. Another appointed committee member told of being afraid of service work, but once committed, realized what he had been missing.

February 2002 — Grapevine director Ray Massey shared that in *The Language of the Heart*, there is a story "Through the A.A. Looking Glass" that talks about the Grapevine as being a mirror of the Fellowship. He noted that "through this 'looking glass,' A.A. members are afforded a marvelous chance to 'see' the problems and solutions in their own lives," and they can get a little closer to being part of the whole of A.A.

Robin Bromley, senior editor of the A.A. Grapevine, shared that it wasn't until she started working on the magazine and began dipping into back issues and looking up Bill W's Grapevine writings that she began to understand the role the magazine played—and continues to play—in the history and growth of Alcoholics Anonymous. When the first Grapevine rolled off the press, it offered the early groups a lifeline by sharing how other groups had weathered disputes. It also provided them with the principles of survival now known as the Twelve Traditions, introduced the Serenity Prayer and Slogans, and published a concise definition of what A.A. is and is not — the A.A. Preamble.

The final presenter, executive editor Des Towey, shared that "For the past 30 years, I have never left home without the Grapevine. I didn't always read it, but it was always in my briefcase as I traveled around the U.S. on business and pleasure. I figured that if it saved my life only once during the year, it was worth the \$5, \$10 or \$15 dollars a year I paid for it." Des also gave a PowerPoint presentation showing how the Grapevine chronicles A.A. history, and how it has proven to be a forum for frank discussion, thereby assuring unity, as well as being a mirror of A.A.'s diverse Fellowship.

When the presentations concluded, a visiting Conference delegate chair shared that he had subscribed to the Grapevine early in his sobriety so that he would have a monthly reminder not to drink. A G.S.O. staff member suggested that groups throughout the Fellowship needed to take a more proprietary responsibility for the Grapevine. If the 93 areas got 10 groups to subscribe to 5 issues of the Grapevine, much of the Grapevine's financial issues would be resolved. An appointed committee member emphasized the important role a Group

Grapevine Representative plays in getting the word out to members about the Grapevine and a regional trustee wrapped up the sharing session by congratulating the Grapevine staff on a job well done.

Bob Miller, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the Group Services coordinator is overseeing the production of service material. To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs. G.S.O. continues to work toward providing services in the three major languages of North America — English, French and Spanish. Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops. It is available in Spanish and French whenever possible.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R., and D.C.M. Kits, and material for Special Needs.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees on the 17th Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, September 2002.

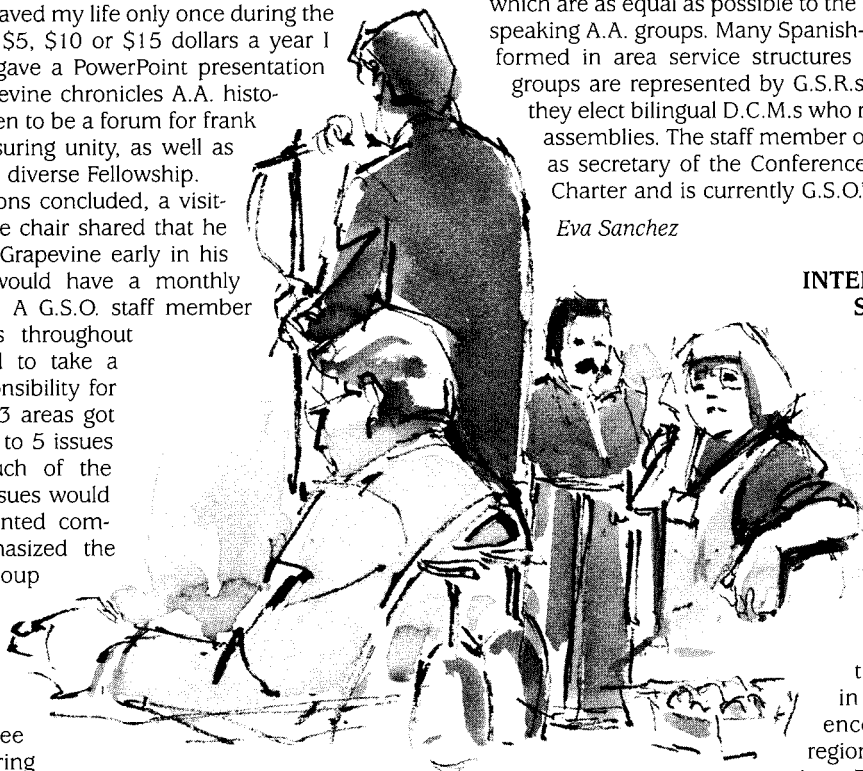
Currently all correspondence in Spanish from the U.S./Canada comes to the Group Services desk, with the exception of corrections correspondence. There are approximately 1,600 Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S. and Canada. The Group Services staff assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been formed in area service structures and continue to grow. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter and is currently G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site liaison.

Eva Sanchez

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee:

This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.



World Service Meeting — The 17th World Service Meeting will be held October 6-10 in Oviedo, Spain, with the theme of “The A.A. Message — A Message Without Borders.” We are anticipating over 40 delegates representing over 30 countries or zones. Charles Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., will be first-term delegate and Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada will be second-term delegate representing our General Service Board. Greg Muth will be presiding at the event and Bill Archer will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Adrienne Brown, Doug Richardson and Valerie O’Neill. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

Literature Assistance — The 2002 Literature Assistance budget of \$208,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. If no structure exists, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Since April 2001, our basic text, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been translated into Indonesian, Slovene and Simplified Chinese. In addition, the following material was produced: — “A.A.’s Legacy of Service” in Finnish and Greek, the pamphlets “44 Questions,” “This is A.A.,” and “A Newcomer Asks” in Burmese, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, “Young People and A.A.,” “Members of the Clergy Ask” in Croatian, “This is A.A.,” and “Is A.A. For You?,” “A Newcomer Asks” in Hebrew, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and “Information on A.A.” in Mongolian, “44 Questions,” “This is A.A.,” and “A Newcomer Asks” in Shan, “44 Questions,” “This is A.A.” and “Information on A.A.” in Simplified Chinese and “A.A. Tradition—How It Developed” and “Understanding Anonymity” in Turkish.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at three zonal service meetings, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In 2001, Greg Muth and Bill Archer attended, as observers, the Fourth Asia-Oceania meeting in Seoul, Korea and the Eleventh European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany. Alex Palmer was our delegate to the Twelfth Meeting of the Americas (REDELA), in Cartagena, Colombia.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits or regional assemblies or events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Cuba, Australia, France, Finland, Latvia, India, Lithuania, Portugal, Austria, Hungary, Turkey, Japan, People’s Republic of China, Slovakia, Peru and Korea.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the International A.A. community and General Service boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Alex Palmer, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 52 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and, with the help of outside translators, it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. The International desk is also responsible for communication with all Spanish-speaking structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the International desk is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of our G.S.O. Spanish translators. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees’ International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new General Service or Information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.’s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 44 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting and the European Service Meeting. Our two trustees at-large are our delegates to the REDELA (meeting of the Americas).

Bill Archer

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees’ report:

International Convention — Three cities were selected by the 2001 Conference for site inspection: Detroit, Indianapolis and San Antonio. It was agreed by the Site-selection Committee that all three cities could have held the International Convention and would have provided, each in its own way, a unique and fun venue for the Fellowship’s celebration of sobriety. At its October 2001 meeting, the trustees’ International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee unanimously recommended that San Antonio, Texas be the site of the Alcoholics Anonymous 2010 International Convention.

When the speakers at the Opening Dinner received a standing ovation, John Koster (Class B trustee) turned to fellow speaker Shirley Ohlson (Utah) and observed, “We have finally made it - a standing ovation on Broadway.”

Following a review of the report on the 2005 International Convention Planning Trip to Toronto, September 18, 2001, the committee discussed various challenges and solutions related to Canadian border crossing regulations faced by members who have criminal convictions and DUI/DWLs in their past. The Canadian Parliament recently passed legislation that would ease some restrictions for those whose sentences for felonies or DUIs occurred ten years or more prior to the Convention. More information will be available in June 2002 when the fully detailed version of the new law is completed and published by the Canadian government.

Regional Forums — Since the last Conference, the following regions have held Forums: Northeast, West Central, Southwest and East Central. All were well attended by enthusiastic members interested in service. A Special "Hispanic" Forum, described as "historic," was held in Austin, Texas. Many of our Spanish-speaking members were attending their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. Also, a Special "Inner City" Forum was held in Chicago, and was an outstanding success.

The committee discussed ways of improving Regional and Special Forums and asked the Regional Forums coordinator to continue gathering presentation topics, workshop suggestions and ideas that reflect the interests and concerns of A.A. members in a specific region. Following a review of the timeline (log) and letters for Regional Forum mailings, it was suggested that copies of correspondence with Regional Forum Host Contacts be forwarded to regional trustees and area delegates. An Evaluation Form was developed for distribution to all attendees at Forums. The committee reviewed a Summary Evaluation of the questionnaires distributed to participants at the Special "Hispanic" Forum and suggested that the questionnaire continue to be distributed through the full, two-year cycle of Regional Forums. The committee is aware that there is a need to redouble efforts to communicate to the Spanish-speaking community the importance of its participation in general service.

The members of the committee expressed a strong desire to schedule more Special Forums adding, if necessary, additional G.S.O. staff to help organize these events, and keeping in mind the suggestion that there be 30 days between each Forum. The following Regional and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2003 General Service Conference:

2002		
May 25-26	Special	Chicoutimi, Quebec
June 7-9	Western Canada	Regina, Saskatchewan
July 12-14	Pacific	Phoenix, AZ
September 27-29	Eastern Canada	Fredericton, New Brunswick
November 15-17	Southeast	Huntsville AL
2003		
March 21-12	Special Hispanic	Bakersfield, CA

Leonard Blumenthal, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention — Preliminary plans are underway for the International Convention, celebrating A.A.'s 70th Birthday, to be held in Toronto, Canada in 2005. Preparations and logistics are being studied to plan for three stadium meetings in the Skydome Stadium, celebratory dances and block parties, accommodating 250 workshops, panels, regional alkathons,

topic meetings and marathons which will require nearly 1000 speakers and moderators. Special attention will be paid to housing registration and transportation. One major convenience in Toronto is having the enormous convention center directly across the plaza from the stadium. Toronto A.A. members are already excited about the unique opportunity they will have to extend the hand of A.A. to those who are able to attend the International Convention 2005.

It is hoped that the International Convention in Toronto for 2005 will provide the same mountain-top experience that A.A. members found in Minneapolis — a landmark A.A. event filled with sober gratitude and the language of the heart.

Doug Richardson

A.A. Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and a Final Report of the Forum to all who attend. A new addition to the format of Regional Forums has been a Full Forum Workshop, which has proven to be an exciting and thought-provoking activity.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs. A Special "Hispanic" Forum was held in Austin, Texas, December 7-8, 2001 and over 270 A.A.s enjoyed a wonderful weekend of bilingual sharing.

The staff member on A.A. Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and, currently co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committee.

Adrienne Brown

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2001 General Service Conference.

Report on Projects For the Past Year:

Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* — The Publications Department delivered the attractive and well-received Fourth Edition in mid-November 2001. A single complimentary first printing of the Fourth Edition was sent to all U.S./Canada groups on G.S.O.'s mailing list in mid-November. All G.S.R.s or group contacts received a letter mailed October 1st which explained that this complimentary copy was for the group and not for the G.S.R. The book was sent in gratitude for the widespread participation by the groups in the Conference process which resulted in the creation and completion of this edition.

Although the April 2001 trustees' report indicated that sixteen stories would be carried forward from the Third Edition of the Big Book, the Publications Department, with prior consultation with both the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, added a seventeenth story so that the page count of the Fourth Edition would be the same as the page count of the Third Edition. There was a single title change of a story carried forward from the Third Edition at the request of the 1998/1999 Fourth Edition subcommittee which asked the G.S.O. Publications Department to recommend a new title for this story to better reflect the spiritual content contained within the text.

The October/November 2001 special issue of Box 4-5-9 contained an extensive history of the Big Book and information about the development and committee work involved in the story selection and publication of the Fourth Edition. This issue was widely distributed throughout the Fellowship in the United States and Canada and, hopefully, communicated historical and current information that was helpful and interesting to many A.A. members. The February/March 2002 issue of Box 4-5-9 contained a follow-up article to answer questions resulting from the November 2001 distribution of the Fourth Edition. The general consensus of reactions received at the General Service Office is one of gratitude for this completed project and for the exemplary professionalism of G.S.O.'s Publications and Order Entry Departments. The committee acknowledged the death of Vinnie McCarthy, G.S.O.'s Publications Director for eighteen years, with gratitude for her many contributions to past and current Literature committees and for her unflinching support and vast experience which she shared willingly with all committee members.

Revised Concepts Checklist — A subcommittee was created July, 2000 to revise the Concepts Checklist and has met five times since July 2000. The purpose of the revised Concepts Checklist is defined in the introductory paragraph: "Some of these discussion points were originally developed by an A.A. group and further developed by the trustees' Literature Committee to be distributed by the General Service Office. While this checklist is intended as a starting point for discussion by groups, districts or areas, individual A.A. members may find it useful along with our co-founder Bill W.'s writings, a service sponsor if you have one and reflection on your own service experience. Additional information about the Concepts can be found in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* and "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet ..."

These revisions are to get away from academic, exam, quiz, "right or wrong"-type questions. The subcommittee forwarded the final revised Concepts Checklist to the trustees' Literature Committee for their review and approval at their October 27, 2001 meeting. The subcommittee's goal in this project was to create an open-ended, friendly and welcoming inventory tool. This service piece became available January 2002 and was forwarded to the 2002 Conference Literature Committee for their information.

Dropped Big Book Stories Anthology — In response to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee report which reads "In keeping with the 1997 Conference Action which requested the development of a publication of stories from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the committee asked that the trustees' Literature Committee bring a draft manuscript of these stories to the 2002 Conference Literature Committee," the committee forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee a sample binder of the draft manuscripts of the last printed version of the 55 stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book. The committee has also suggested that the Conference Literature Committee define the responsibilities of G.S.O.'s Publications Department as they relate to this project.

Subcommittee on Adding or Clarifying Spiritual Experience in Some Current Recovery Pamphlets — A subcommittee was formed in response to the following additional committee consideration from the 2001 Conference Literature Committee: "The committee discussed the trustees' Literature Committee's proposal for a new pamphlet that included a variety of spiritual experience and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding to or clarifying existing pamphlets such as 'This is A.A.' and 'A Newcomer Asks' to address a variety of individual interpretations and individual experience of spirituality in *Alcoholics Anonymous*."

The subcommittee has met four times since July 2001 and completed an extensive review of all references to spirituality and religion in recovery pamphlets. The subcommittee agreed that, as a result of their review of the existing literature, they were grateful for the variety and excellently written references to spirituality/religion in many recovery pamphlets. The Conference Literature Committee received background material which documents references to spirituality/religion in 18 recovery pamphlets. The subcommittee concluded that the distinction between spirituality/religion is included in most recovery pamphlets.

The subcommittee also discussed and rejected creating a simple uniform statement that might be added to some or all of these pamphlets as this might appear to be an "Official A.A. Statement." Based on the subcommittee's recommendation, the committee forwarded requests for changes in the text of two pamphlets to the 2002 Conference Literature Committee.

The subcommittee has suggested that the committee consider adding a reference that A.A. is a spiritual not a religious program to "A.A. in the Armed Services" if this pamphlet is revised. The subcommittee hopes that there will be ongoing discussion on the subject of spirituality/religion in A.A. at all levels of service throughout the Fellowship.

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for Discussion:

- Draft manuscripts of the 55 stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, for approval for publication.
- Suggested outline of responsibilities of G.S.O.'s Publications Department as they relate to anthology of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book.
- Revised service piece, "Concepts Checklist" for review.
- Suggested change to text of "This is A.A." pamphlet.
- Suggested change to text in "A.A. for the Woman" pamphlet.
- Summary of responses to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book received by the General Service Office as of January 15, 2002.

George Vaillant, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely

with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the editor, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on distribution of complimentary copies of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, on responding to the many questions regarding story selection, the committee process and on acknowledging reactions to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book which were, for the most part, extremely positive.

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, many deadlines and detailed reporting. The Literature coordinator served as secretary to the Concepts Checklist subcommittee which completed a revised checklist which became available as a service piece in January 2002. The literature coordinator also served as secretary to the subcommittee which undertook an extensive review of references to spirituality/religion in recovery pamphlets and served as secretary to the A.A.W.S. Board Publishing Committee. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate all literature assignment responsibilities.

Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups asking many literature questions: How can I order literature? Who does translations? Who can help me with my literature order problems? Where can I send my suggestion for a new literature format? and Who can give me specific text and/or historical information from our literature? Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 73 area literature chairpersons, 211 district literature chairpersons and 156 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The Literature staff member also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following distribution: 55,768 copies in English, 4,100 copies in French and 1,623 copies in Spanish. *Box 4-5-9* (French) is translated and printed by Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc. in Montreal, in cooperation with this office. The staff member works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. This year we introduced heavier paper stock and colored illustrations and titles which were received enthusiastically. The editorial committee welcomes and needs ideas and suggestions from the Fellowship.

As literature is essential in helping carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and exciting assignment.

Valerie O'Neill

LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a vital means of sharing for about 320 Loners in 80 countries, plus 105 Internationalists, and 204 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy

periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by G.S.O. that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tape and e-mail and by reading A.A. literature.

In addition to those members, we have 584 Loner Sponsors, who aren't "Sponsors" nor "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. Port Contacts are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory*, a complimentary subscription to Box 4-5-9 and the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication comprised of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office). This publication is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

Since January 2001, we received sharing from around the world, each one an example of how A.A. continues to be the basis of sobriety and the A.A. way of life. A single issue of LIM may offer sharing from Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Germany, Finland, England, India, Ireland, Israel, Guam, Slovenia, Taiwan, one or more countries in West Africa, Zambia, as well as Canada and the U.S. Most letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing.

It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter and walk humbly through difficult circumstances each day. The courage of these Loners, Homers and Internationalists is an inspiration that I hope to pass on.

Joanie Moncrief

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 2001 General Service Conference, the trustees' Nominating Committee has met three times. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by the principles of love, responsibility, and mutual respect. Following is a list of the work of the committee:

- Made minor changes to the procedures in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure.
- Forwarded a request to the A.A. World Services Board that the list of all upcoming vacancies for trustees and directors be published annually in Box 4-5-9.
- Discussed the distribution of resumes as background for board slates and took no action.
- Forwarded the suggestion to the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Corporate Boards that their respective Nominating Committees exchange information regarding their application lists for director positions in order that each is made aware of any duplicate applicants.
- Made a search for a Class A trustee and three well-qualified "friends of A.A." were interviewed. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Vincent E. Keefe be invited to serve as a Class A trustee, replacing Arthur L. Knight, Jr., following the 2002 General Service Conference. Vince's background is in Finance.
- Approved the selection of Ray Reese, of Burbank, California, as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee, his service to commence with the July 2002 General Service Board weekend.
- Approved a request for an appointed committee member to serve on the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the

Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Corporate Board* — Dorothy J. May, East Central regional trustee, replacing Beth Rabren; and *Grapevine Corporate Board* — Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher, Southeast regional trustee, replacing Tony Taschner.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2002 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 2002 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.	Vincent E. Keefe
Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.	Robert O. Miller, D.D.
Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D.	George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Linda L. Chezem, J.D.	

Class B

Charles F. Bartell	Dorothy May
R.J.M. (Ric) Downey	Alex D.J. Palmer
David V. Every	Robert Pelot
Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher	Beth Rabren
Ronald J. Gauthier	Ted Stoa
Phyllis Halliday	Tony Taschner
John C. Koster	Gregory Tobin

Officers of General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
<i>First Vice-chairperson</i>	Linda L. Chezem, J.D.
<i>Second Vice-chairperson</i>	Robert O. Miller, D.D.
<i>Secretary</i>	Tony Taschner
<i>Treasurer</i>	Vincent E. Keefe
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Doug Richardson

Directors of A.A. World Services Corporate Board:

Paul Cleary	John C. Koster
R.J.M. (Ric) Downey	Dorothy J. May
Ronald J. Gauthier	Don Miller
Greg Muth	Jane Sheppard
Doug Richardson	

Directors of A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board:

Susan Campbell	Arnold L. Ross
David V. Every	Ted Stoa
Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher	Gregory Tobin
Raymond Massey	Desmond Towey
Robert O. Miller, D.D.	

Linda Chezem, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the pub-

lic; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through subcommittees and the Public Information staff coordinator at G.S.O. Following is a list of some of our work over the past year:

- We developed a policy for guidance in Public Information activity related to our co-founders, Bill W. and Dr. Bob. The policy, reviewed by the 2001 Conference P.I. Committee, was accepted by the General Service Board.
- Following the Advisory Action of the 2001 General Service Conference, the committee conducted the 2001 Membership Survey, and forwarded the results to the 2002 Conference P.I. Committee.
- In response to the recommendation from the 2001 Conference, the committee oversaw the production of a new television public service announcement (P.S.A.), which was presented to the Conference P.I. Committee. We also forwarded a long-range development plan for future television P.S.A.s, and a proposal for centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of television P.S.A.s. to the Conference P.I. Committee for its consideration.
- With the committees' guidance, four press releases were issued from the P.I. Desk in 2001. The press releases covered the following events: Selection of Dr. Elaine McDowell as the chair of the General Service Board; Publication of "Can A.A. Help Me Too? Black/African Americans Share Their Stories"; Publication of "A.A. For the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late"; and Publication of the Fourth Edition of Alcoholics Anonymous.
- We discussed the request from the 2001 Conference Literature Committee to consider adding language that clarifies A.A.'s non-affiliation with any religion to Public Information pamphlets and forwarded a report to the Conference P.I. Committee for their consideration.

Ric Downey, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, schools and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site on the Internet. A crucial part of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to act as a resource and central repository of the sharing from Public Information Committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do. The assignment provides accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous.

The staff member regularly communicates with over 500 P.I. Committee chairpeople at the area, district, intergroup/central office level. All new Public Information chairpeople are sent a "welcome" letter and receive the P.I. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines on Public Information, P.I. Discount Package Order Form, Box 4-5-9, as well as current P.I. information from the staff member. The results of the A.A. Membership Survey are also made available in display board and pamphlet formats to local P.I. committees.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of local health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature and participate in these events. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with local P.I. committees, so that there can

be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these local events.

The Public Information desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, film or on the Internet. If the local area is identified, this information is forwarded to area delegates. The delegate chooses whether to respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case basis. In the past twelve months, approximately 31 articles were forwarded to area delegates. In January, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information to local delegates.

The annual Anonymity Memo to Media, including a Rolodex card with an explanation of Alcoholics Anonymous highlighting our Web site address, and a return postcard for those who wish additional information about A.A., was mailed in February to more than 9,500 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services. The distribution included French and English outlets in Canada and the black and Hispanic media in the United States.

In addition to the Annual Anonymity Memo, four press releases were sent to media throughout the U.S. and Canada. We responded to numerous other requests from media professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism. We referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to an appropriate source. We also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. In this instance, Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention. Just as the strongest Twelfth Step with the alcoholic is often the quiet power of our own sobriety, in dealing with the media we try to present A.A. in a courteous and dignified manner. As our Eleventh Tradition reminds us: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction, rather than promotion"

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other A.A. service: are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message of recovery gets to the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Rick Walker

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Ten A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2001, the staff received 28,463 such requests by mail, fax and e-mail (a 20% increase over 2000), plus many phone calls. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects, away from the office to attend A.A.



events, or at times of illness or vacation. Last year, staff participated in more than 90 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums, where we provided information on services available through G.S.O. and gathered shared experiences to bring back to the office to be used to benefit other groups.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experiences of A.A. groups gathered over many years, resources that are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Ideas received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, where we focus on problems best addressed by a group conscience. Our weekly meetings also provide a forum for sharing ideas on ways to further improve services to A.A. groups and members.

Julio Espallat joined the staff in early July 2001 replacing retired staff member Danny Mooney, and plunged right into answering the heavy correspondence received on the Correctional Facilities assignment. Julio is bilingual and will eventually take on, as an addition to his assignment, services that G.S.O. provides to A.A.'s Spanish-speaking community in the U.S. and Canada. These services are currently being taken care of by Eva Sanchez on the Group Services assignment. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening in the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff.

Each G.S.O. staff member serves as secretary to a Conference Committee and is a voting member of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

During 2001, we welcomed 1,624 visitors to G.S.O. from around the world. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator serves as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the assistance of a very capable support staff.

Doug Richardson

Literature Distributed - 2001

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (3rd Ed.)	347,966
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed)	421,028
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover-3rd Ed.)	300,758
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover-4th Ed)	126,014
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-3rd Ed)	21,984
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-4th Ed)	19,555
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	118,711
Daily Reflections	134,208
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	171,005
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	15,418
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	149,910
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	12,119
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	51,061
A.A. Comes of Age	13,050
As Bill Sees It	45,758
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	27,322
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	13,590
"Pass It On"	13,370
Total	2,002,287

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/	
Twelve Concepts for World Service	31,500
Living Sober	146,322
Came to Believe	71,178
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	26,674
Total	275,674

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	10,724
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	27,013
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,916
A.A. for the Native North American	16,904
A.A. for the Woman	111,776
The A.A. Group	88,382
A.A. in Your Community	47,845
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	24,557
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	26,567
The A.A. Membership Survey	54,752
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	103,900
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	29,967
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	11,667
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	118,102
Circles of Love and Service	35,560
Bridging the Gap	27,068
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	22,521
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	16,870
Do You Think You're Different?	114,332
44 Questions	239,887
G.S.R.	45,809
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	4,789
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,461
How It Works	63,613
If You Are a Professional	39,317
Inside A.A.	39,690
Can A.A. Help Me Too?	29,167
Is A.A. for You?	341,408
Is A.A. for Me?	96,223
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	17,836
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	84,156

It Happened to Alice	58,296
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	64,462
The Jack Alexander Article	28,791
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	13,085
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	81,377
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	56,425
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	37,549
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	9,430
A Newcomer Asks	279,709
Problems Other Than Alcohol	120,679
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	249,568
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,015
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	23,944
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	70,551
Twelve Tradition Flyer	9,320
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	47,619
This Is A.A.	266,728
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	19,038
Time to Start Living	56,523
Time to Start Living (large print)	7,290
AA for the Older Alcoholic	11,218
Too Young?	89,719
Understanding Anonymity	63,517
What Happened to Joe	62,105
Young People and A.A.	117,748
Total	3,801,485

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	349,591
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	53,623
Wallet cards-Anonymity	31,170
Anonymity Display Card	2,371
Parchment-scrolls	3,266
Placards	583
C.P.C. Workbook	1,876
Archives Workbook	1,517
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,386
P.I. Workbook	1,812
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,799
Treatment Facility Kit	412
Big Book on computer disk	580
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	423
A.A. Guidelines	65,639
Group Handbook	2,226
Wire Racks	2,270
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1,846
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	4,782
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	334
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,235
TV Public Service Announcement	252
Radio Public Service Announcements	298
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,158
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,007
Fact File	2,571
Table Top Display 12 & 12	500
Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)	169
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	326
Total	538,022
Grand Total	6,617,468

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	21,395
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Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	6,643
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	9,053
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,602
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,554
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,991
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,335
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,017
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	14,108
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,065
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	23,623
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	7,048
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	6,835
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	8,238
Total	125,507

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	5,165
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	25,604
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	27,208
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	52,342
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	7,750
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	5,806
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,223
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	4,857
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	3,129
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,515
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	13,941
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	10,408
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	7,475
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,443
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	7,674
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	10,483
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	4,797
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,278
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,494
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	9,927
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,391
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	8,511
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	2,800
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	7,830
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	5,257
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,462

Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,884
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	3,575
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,933
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,868
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	7,499
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	4,526
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	2,023
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	8,512
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,191
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	3,095
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	10,911
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	4,144
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	6,875
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	5,192
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,678
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	3,203
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,580
Total	347,765
Miscellaneous	
Guías (Guidelines)	8,349
Parchments, Spanish	746
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	21,886
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	692
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	874
Total	32,547
GrandTotal	505,819

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	4,534
Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	2,260
Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	1,003
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,470
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	3,222
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	804
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	441
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	3,598
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,891
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	635
Total	21,858

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,127
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,064
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,550
Total	4,741

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	10,106
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	1,225
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	13,527
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,052
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	299
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	498
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,120
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	332
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	348
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	1,989
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	864
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	334
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	311
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	689
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	491
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	492
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	666
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	1,453
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	612
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,027
Les A.A. dans les centres de detention (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	274
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,055
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	2,314
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	401
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	593
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	599
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	223
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,937
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,712
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,287
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	559
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,218
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,522

Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	387
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	725
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	357
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	201
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	492
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	917
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	672
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,453
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	898
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,509
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	746
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	6,724
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	992
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	583
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,910
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	492
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	350
Total	70,537
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total 2,848

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	81
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	97
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,412
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	70
Cassettes	48
Notre Methode (How It Works)	10,329
Manuel de Groupe	52
Pochette de l'Information Publique	10
Pochette des Centres de Detention	4
Pochette de la CMP	4
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	13,257
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	4
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	483
Total	26,851
Grand Total	126,835



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., the corporate service arm of the General Service Board, publishes the Grapevine magazine, a "meeting in print," and carries the same message of recovery, unity and service through the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions in other appropriate media, such as books, CDs and the Internet, among other items. During the year four quarterly board meetings and four planning meetings were held.

Mission Statement — The mission of the Grapevine Corporate Board, composed of five trustees and four nontrustee directors, is:

- To oversee the corporation's publishing operations.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate priorities and policies.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts.

Additionally, the board elected during the year to adopt for itself the Responsibility Declaration that appears in each issue of the Grapevine magazine. That declaration has been adapted by the board to read: "We are responsible - when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, we want a copy of the Grapevine always to be within arm's reach. And for that: we are responsible."

Operations — On the heels of major changes in personnel, computer systems, and fulfillment services initiated prior to the General Service Conference last year, the board followed up with more change during the past year. While overseeing the integration on the new computer systems and outsourcing program, the board implemented the in-depth search process that lead to the selection of the corporation's new CEO and executive editor. This action has resulted in a restructuring of business functions and reporting relationships within the organization. In sum, the board has followed the process of instituting change, integrating that change which in turn leads to *kaizen*, the process of continually improving change. Specifically, the heads of each department—customer service and fulfillment; Internet; editorial (including La Viña); and finance—report directly to the executive editor. Each of these departments has been directed to support three "Aggressive Attraction Strategies" (AAS), namely focus, creativity and efficiency, in order to enable the corporation to reconnect with its spiritual mission of bringing a "meeting in print" into the hands of the recovering alcoholic. At the beginning of 2002 a quarterly tactical implementation program was developed and

approved by the board to achieve this goal in an organized manner. The results of this program will be evidenced only within the framework of "Fellowship Time." However, a number of the highlights include:

- 1 Production of a new four-color GV catalog.
- 2 Joint mailings with A.A.W.S. products.
- 3 Revised Grapevine Workbook available on the web and reprinted by year-end.
- 4 Weekly creative and financial meetings.
- 5 Monthly special offers on the GV Web site.
- 6 Production of five GV CDs.
- 7 "Companions in Recovery, Unity and Service" specially priced offering of *The Language of the Heart*/Big Book IV.
- 8 Development of a new visual presentation for Forums and assemblies.
- 9 Special "inner-city" group initiatives for Chicago, Dallas, Los Angeles and New York.
- 10 Meetings with GvRs prior to Regional Forums.
- 11 Closer working relationship with H&I and other committees.
- 12 Early renewal and returning subscriber incentives.
- 13 Faster delivery of the magazine and other products.
- 14 Pass through of escalating postage and handling costs.
- 15 Begin acceptance of "phone and web check" orders.
- 16 Offer softcover of *The Language of the Heart*.
- 17 Conduct *The Language of the Heart* meetings in Grapevine offices.
- 18 Begin process to archive all GV articles for ease of access to the Fellowship.
- 19 Link to local area, inter-group, district Web sites.
- 20 Prepare gift edition of *The Best of Bill*.



La Viña — The Spanish-language magazine project of the General Service Board had an average monthly circulation of 8,623 during 2001, 123 copies over budget. Total magazine income was \$70,226, which was \$7,999 over budget. Higher than budgeted printing costs brought the gross profit to \$8,193, or \$337 under budget. Editorial, circulation and general and administrative costs, including the hiring of a new editor of La Viña and more accurate allocation of personnel costs, were \$55,932 more than budgeted. Thus, La Viña's net loss for the year came to a total of \$119,385.

2001 Year-end Financial Results — Average monthly circulation of the Grapevine magazine was 115,084 for the year. This was 1,916 copies below the budgeted circulation level of 117,000. Therefore, subscription income of \$1,699,636 was \$32,492 below budget. Direct costs, primarily printing and postage, were \$42,444 above budget, resulting in a gross profit on the magazine of \$1,028,570, which was \$56,803 less than budget. Other publishing income from books, tapes, calendars and other products was \$431,248 — \$86,816 below budget. Overall, unit sales in this category were down, and there was no income from the budgeted new book that we decided not to produce. Combined income, then, was \$1,270,681, which along with interest income from cash flow and the Reserve Fund brought total revenue to \$1,357,871 — \$94,497 less than budgeted.

On the cost side, editorial expenses and circulation and business costs were lower than budget by \$56,490. General and administrative costs exceeded budget by \$59,032, due in part to the first phase of the Digital Archiving Project, which cost \$9,861, and the construction of *The Language of the Heart* conference room and other leaseholder improvements, which totaled \$16,702. It is important to note that total costs of \$1,453,693 were only \$2,452 higher than budget. The net loss from operations was \$95,822.

One-time conversion and restructuring charges totaled \$355,230. The total amount budgeted had been \$337,773; however, unanticipated legal fees and executive search expenses brought this total somewhat higher than expected.

2002 A.A. Grapevine Budget — The Grapevine Corporate Board approved a 2002 budget that shows a net profit of \$188, or a virtual break-even position for the Grapevine operation. This is based on a budgeted 115,500 average circulation for the magazine, which generates a gross income of \$1,754,780; other publishing gross income is budgeted at \$510,575, with special emphasis on reinvigorated sales of *The Language of the Heart* this year. Minus direct costs, and plus interest income, we are anticipating a total income of \$1,440,132. Costs and expenses are held below the 2001 level, at \$1,439,944, resulting in the break-even bottom line.

Web Site — The Web site activity continues to increase and show positive trends. This trend is evident in the increase in the number of visitors to the site and the greater number of orders for the magazine and other message-related items. Two factors have influenced this performance: 1) the enthusiastic response to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, and 2) special Web site offers.

The special project to protect and access the Grapevine's archives of published stories has been moving forward at a steady pace. A detailed description of the full scope of the project and all estimated costs was presented to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee at its last meeting. The project will now be presented to the General Service Board for future direction.

In the Future — In the coming months, our new issues will feature such key topics as:

- Service: Alcoholics in Action
- A.A. in the Workplace
- The Prison Issue and Special Report: "Inner City" Forum, Chicago
- Moments of Grace
- Combating Resentments
- Recovering on the Internet
- Hanging on Through the Holidays
- Anonymity
- How do you do H.O.W.?
- Love, Sex and Sobriety
- Report: Remote Communities

It is the hope of the Grapevine Board and staff that these topics will be helpful in sharing our "meeting in print."

Tony Täschner, chairperson

Staff report: There have been many new developments at the Grapevine this year. Interim managing editor Cynthia Keyworth steered the magazine through a year-long period of transition, enlivening its pages with moving stories of recovery and its covers with compelling designs. Then in September, the Board of Directors welcomed new CEO and executive editor Des Towey. Committed to revitalizing the use of the magazine and the Web site as powerful Twelfth Step tools, the executive editor has reorganized the corporation, taking on the responsibility of acting chief financial officer; establishing a director of Internet operations, Maggie Keogh; and hiring a new editor and art director for La Viña, Hérrnan Merea and Delia Planchart, each of whose native language is Spanish. The editorial staff has been revamped as well. It now includes a managing editor (Charlie McGovern) and associate editor (Marsha Levine). The posts of director of operations and circulation (Mary Pat Hester) and senior editor (Robin Bromley) remain unchanged.

Recent innovations at the Grapevine include more engaging magazine covers and stories that reflect the tenor of current A.A. meetings, an expanded Web site, and the release of the Grapevine's most popular audiotapes on four CDs. In addition, weekly *The Language of the Heart* meetings are now being held in the Grapevine's new conference room. To share these changes with the Fellowship, the executive editor attended the Southwestern and East Central Regional Forums and the Special Inner City Forum in Chicago. He also traveled to the Special Hispanic Forum in Austin, Texas, to introduce La Viña's new editor and plans for carrying the message of A.A. to members who speak Spanish.

The year 2001 also has been a year of transition for Grapevine operations. After extensive testing and planning, many of our data entry and fulfillment operations were transferred in July 2001 to an outside supplier, while the mailing services for subscription copies have remained the same. Customer service continues to be performed in New York by a customer service staff of five, including the director of operations and circulation. A GvR coordinator is available to assist Grapevine and La Viña representatives. GvRs also receive GrapeNet, our complimentary newsletter, which is mailed several times a year to approximately 6,500 GvRs throughout the world. The use of the Internet for the GvR network has greatly facilitated communication as well. Despite the challenges such major change engenders, circulation has remained stable, and, now that the outsourcing is complete, the staff looks forward to improving customer service and operations as a whole.

The Grapevine's Web site, www.aagrapevine.org, continues to grow. In 2000, the site had a 15 percent increase in visitors, and there was another 20 percent increase in visitors in 2001. There has been a similar increase in the number of subscriptions ordered from the on-line catalog, the majority of which are new subscribers to the Grapevine. Since the Internet is such a rich place for potential alcoholics to find information about the disease, the Grapevine is grateful to be able to extend this additional hand of A.A. to newcomers. The moderated bulletin board, i-Say, continues to draw a small group of A.A.s who post their experience, strength and hope on various topics, as well as sick and suffering alcoholics who may find some light and hope there for the first time.

Robin Bromley, senior editor

AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2001

ENGLISH

Books

AA Around the World	2,676
Best of Bill	9,380
Best of the Grapevine, I	1,977
Best of the Grapevine, II	1,657
Best of the Grapevine, III	2,173
The Language of the Heart	10,595
The Home Group	5,401
Best Grapevine Cartoons	1,534
Total	35,393

Cassette tapes

Maintaining Spirituality	1,085
Pathways to Spirituality	1,134
Other cassettes	6,061
Total	8,280

Miscellaneous

AA Preamble	2,131
Co-founders Memorial Issue	1,070
Facsimile of First Grapevine	785
Man on the Bed	1,256
Serenity Prayer	4,434
Slogans	1,348
Wall calendar	17,774
Pocket planner	19,354
Traditions checklist	376
Index	11
Grapevine Binder	707
Total	29,246

SPANISH

El Lenjueje del Corazon (Language of the Heart)	3,545
Preámbulo (Preamble)	357
Lemas (Slogans)	457
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	949
Sonidos de Sobriedad cassette (Sounds of Sobriety)	895
Total	6,203

FRENCH

Les Sons de las Sobriété cassette (Sounds of Sobriety)	72
Total	72
Grand total	9,194

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 2002	APRIL 2001	
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	1,088	1,022	66
Alaska	542	533	9
Arizona	1,766	1,748	18
Arkansas	665	644	21
California	12,382	12,249	133
Colorado	1,750	1,815	— 65
Connecticut	1,833	1,924	— 91
Delaware	426	435	— 9
District of Columbia	206	216	— 10
Florida	5,684	5,607	77
Georgia	2,915	2,727	188
Hawaii	616	558	58
Idaho	599	632	— 33
Illinois	4,367	4,346	21
Indiana	1,625	1,587	38
Iowa	1,307	1,345	— 38
Kansas	1,359	1,309	50
Kentucky	1,016	1,006	10
Louisiana	1,030	982	48
Maine	740	668	72
Maryland	1,514	1,603	— 89
Massachusetts	3,404	3,320	84
Michigan	3,751	3,671	80
Minnesota	2,965	2,950	15
Mississippi	662	636	26
Missouri	2,053	1,973	80
Montana	757	690	67
Nebraska	1,010	1,079	— 69
Nevada	808	806	2
New Hampshire	849	849	0
New Jersey	3,105	3,080	25
New Mexico	779	778	1
New York	6,622	6,512	110
No Carolina	2,661	2,525	136
No Dakota	512	412	100
Ohio	3,365	3,290	75
Oklahoma	1,080	1,150	— 70
Oregon	1,550	1,506	44
Pennsylvania	5,387	4,856	531
Rhode Island	489	447	42
So Carolina	1,174	1201	— 27
So Dakota	445	424	21
Tennessee	1,398	1,443	— 45
Texas	4,620	4,526	94
Utah	614	631	— 17
Vermont	436	387	49
Virginia	2,353	2,360	— 7
Washington	3,385	3,326	59
West Virginia	432	413	19
Wisconsin	2,692	2,659	33
Wyoming	374	336	38
Puerto Rico	48	50	— 2
U.S. Possessions	18	18	0
Subtotal U.S.	103,228	101,260	1,968
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	843	920	— 77
British Columbia/Ykn	1,079	1,047	32
Manitoba	378	390	— 12
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	279	319	— 40
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	467	473	— 6
Ontario	2,991	2,886	105
Quebec	189	219	— 30
Saskatchewan	394	423	— 29
Subtotal Canada	6,620	6,677	— 57
FOREIGN			
	1,553	1,747	— 194
Grand Total*	111,401	109,684	1,717

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Area Service Highlights — Panel 52 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights.)

Alaska: Area 02 has approximately 210 registered groups. The area, one-fifth the size of the lower 48 States, with a third of the population inaccessible by road, is divided into 13 districts, ten of which are consistently and presently active. One district meets via telephone, and several others include geographically remote groups in the same manner. All districts, on and off the road system, are eligible to host, and each gathering delivers an enthusiastic boost to local service participation. The area committee's efforts are supported by a standing committee system, which mirrors that of the Conference. Our area inventory items have addressed, in large part, the functioning and effectiveness of such a broad committee system at the area level. Panel 50 was the first in which standing committee chairs met via telecomm between assemblies, connecting to discuss committee activities, common problems, and proven solutions. We face some challenges in supporting our groups in carrying the message. Many groups are geographically remote, others culturally and linguistically. The cost of unity is high, but consistently met with Seven Tradition support. We continue our commitment to unity and service, striving to assist in keeping all groups active and informed as they carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Amy O'Mara*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 has seen a profound change in our quarterly area meetings. For convenience, we have always met in the city midway between our two largest population centers. All of our efforts were leaning toward the needs of G.S.O., with no room allocated on our intensive external agenda for internal group and district concerns. But the A.A. conscience always speaks. Those G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s just kept walking up to the floor mikes. Then one day we stumbled into an opened book, *The A.A. Service Manual*. To paraphrase, "The area committee—perhaps more than any other group of people in A.A.— is responsible for the health of the Conference structure and, by the same token, for growth and harmony in our beloved Fellowship. Thus, the area committee is in a fortunate middle position.... Through the members of the committee, it is close to district and local scenes. The groups and districts can turn to the whole area committee for help in restoring peace or generating more activity among the groups in the district. This middle position is indeed a vital one." We have since held two quarterlies in smaller towns, far from population centers of our area. The response has been phenomenal. Following our January quarterly in a smaller city, we have at least four district bids to host the next four D.C.M. meetings. — *Duane Talbot*

Arizona: Area 3 has 15 districts, comprised of 61 subdistricts with 535 registered G.S.R.s, and approximately 2,200 meetings weekly throughout the state. We have four assemblies a year. The Pre-Conference Assembly is held after PRAASA, where Conference topics are discussed among the seven panels, which are made up of G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, D.C.M.C.s, Intergroup Liaisons, Standing Committee Coordinators and Area Officers. They are asked to report a sense of their panel on the Conference at the General Assembly, which is always gratifying because we get to watch Tradition Two in action by allowing the groups to participate in A.A. as a whole. The Post-Conference Assembly is in May, where the delegate reports back to the area. August is usually reserved for area topics of concern and in November, the budget is passed. Our elections are held on the odd year in November.

José Mejías (Puerto Rico) brought the house down when he began his Area Highlights with, "Hi, ya'all."

We have recently added a new standing committee, Remote Communities, which has been busy gathering a list identifying remote meetings and encouraging groups to lend support to those meetings. Our Spanish districts are working to better carry the message within the Spanish-speaking community. We are looking forward to hosting the Pacific Regional Forum in July. Our second Corrections Conference was helpful in getting to know the staff of the facilities where we do our Corrections service and they got to know us better. The Arizona Area is a diverse lot that keeps general service work fun and exciting. — *Mike Glassmann*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 includes all of Orange, Riverside, and San Bernardino Counties, as well as the southern portion of Los Angeles County. We have approximately 62,000 members in about 1,800 groups. The area is divided into 23 districts, 5 of which are Spanish. We hold three area assemblies a year. We host three service events a year: a pre-Conference Workshop in April, a Foro, and a Servathon. The Foro is co-hosted by an English-speaking and Spanish-speaking district, and discusses matters affecting all areas of A.A. The Servathon presents and discusses different types of service experience. Our Archives Committee hosts: an Open House, a Founder's Day, and a Heritage Day. Most written communications are translated into Spanish. We also provide Spanish and ASL translators at most events. Area 9 has 14 standing committees: Low participation by G.S.R.s continues to be a major concern. Our area officers and standing committee chairs have made a commitment to travel in groups to each of the districts to enthusiastically spread the word of service work. We believe this show of commitment and unity will eventually increase participation. I firmly believe that when Area 9's Service Highlights are presented to the 54th General Service Conference you will hear of our progress. We believe in progress not perfection. — *Pete Barlett*

California (Northern Interior): In our approximately 700 groups, and with our sponsors, A.A. members in Area 7 study the Traditions. Most of us first learn about the Concepts at our district meetings. Many of our 28 districts, two of which are Spanish linguistic, study one Concept each month. With our Conference theme we hope that many will more fully understand the principles of all Three of our Legacies: Unity, Recovery and Service. Many districts hold service workshops and unity days. The P.I./C.P.C. committee held a workshop, which included a mock "Speaking at non-A.A. meetings." Last March, we hosted the 35th Pacific Region A.A. Service Assembly in Fresno. We have monthly area activities, either one of four rotating assemblies or eight committee meetings a year. With this continuity of communication we strive to have our assemblies guided by the G.S.R.s and our area committee by the D.C.M.s. We strive to emphasize, by example, the rights and responsibilities of being a "trusted servant" and the paramount importance of the open communication that leads to an "informed group conscience" in both our personal recovery and activity in general service. — *Kathy Cholewinski*

California (San Diego-Imperial): Area 8 has 768 active groups with 25,000 members and is served by nineteen English and three Spanish-speaking districts. We hold five area assemblies a year and have a committee system which mirrors that of the General Service Conference. Our area committee and standing committees meet monthly. The Contact Services (Bridging the Gap) committee is in its fifth year. Our Translation committee continues to be of the highest priority and the need for more bilingual volunteers is ever present. One of our goals for this year

is to translate all delegate's information into Spanish which will be distributed throughout the area. This past June 10th, all area service committees, intergroups, and Young Peoples Organizations joined together to hold an area Unity Day, Grapevine/La Viña, and A.A. Birthday celebration. Annually, the area Archives committee hosts a R.O.O.T.S. event, Remembering Our Old Timers Stories. Also each year we join with the Southern, Mid-Southern, and Central California Areas in a Four Area D.C.M. Sharing Session. We are continually challenged to increase the communication between all area groups and meetings. We will continue to try and communicate to all our trusted servants what their commitment entails, lovingly how to accomplish it, and spiritually why they are doing it. — *Jim Holt*

Delaware: Area 12 has 13 districts and three intergroups serving 269 registered groups with 3,790 members. We have four area assemblies. We have eight standing committees. The area's three intergroups carry the message at the local level by covering all correctional and treatment facility commitments. Districts 12 and 13 last year hosted their Annual oct-sober-fest. District 5 holds a yearly service workshop with greater attendance each year. Districts 2 and 3 held their first joint workshop in February, which focused on Sponsorship, The Home Group and the Twelve Steps. District 1 maintains a complete A.A. video library for use by any A.A. group or member. After being dark for over four years Districts 4 and 7 are again participating in the service structure due to two dedicated members volunteering to serve as D.C.M.s. Area 12's Panel 52 officers are an enthusiastic bunch with a strong and deeply rooted background in service. One of our goals is to bring the remaining dark districts back into the service structure. By continuing to employ the principle of attraction and emphasizing all three of A.A.'s Legacies, we have a good chance of achieving that goal. — *Dorothy Dayton*

Georgia: Area 16 has 48 districts, 703 groups and approximately 18,000 members. Assemblies are held the third weekend of January, May and September in Macon, which is centrally located. We have five active standing committees: P.I./C.P.C., T.F., C.F., Archives and Grapevine, that hold workshops at assemblies. We have a state office with one paid employee, augmented by volunteers, who distribute literature, maintain records, and publish a bimonthly newsletter and annual directory. We have a pre-paid state convention the third weekend of October that rotates around the state. We have seven cluster forums in seven geographical regions based on the Conference theme. We are trying to carry the message of A.A. to every part of Georgia. Some of our goals for 2002 are to improve participation at our assemblies, and increase financial contributions and Grapevine subscriptions, but most importantly to increase membership in Alcoholics Anonymous in Georgia. — *John Deloach*

Idaho: Area 18 is composed of 10 districts representing about 205 registered groups, stretching from the Grand Teton Mountains in the east to Hells Canyon in the west. We hold three area committee meetings per year in the south-central area of the state. We also hold two area assem-

blies each year. The area committee consists of area officers, D.C.M.s, archivist, Grapevine, a newsletter editor, H&I and C.P.C./P.I. While we have combined the committees of P.I. and C.P.C. and H&I, we are unique in that we have split them into "Area East" and "Area West" positions. Our assemblies are also our area conventions. The downside to this combined event is a subordination of area business to speakers and banquets. Although this leads to a distraction in conducting area business, we are very grateful to have over 50% of our G.S.R.s present at our assemblies. Area 18 covers approximately 138,600 square miles, much of it remote. Much of Idaho's population is centered in and around the Boise metropolitan area. Our boundaries cover distances of 330 miles north to south and 420 miles east to west. Most of our districts have a rich history of unity and involvement while others have struggled at the group, district and area level. Area 18, as a whole, continues to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic and I feel extremely proud to represent it at this Conference. — *Madeleine Parmley*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 represents almost half of the state of Illinois, except for Chicago. We have 1,060 reporting groups and 22,079 attending meetings, 25 districts, one being a Spanish linguistic district. There are four service committees structured around the Conference Committees. We also have an Archivist, Newsletter editor, Webmaster, Special Needs committee and a Group Record Keeper to strengthen the unity and communication. There are four committee meetings and four one-day assemblies a year, along with a pre- and a post-Conference workshop. We host a Big Book Conference and Spring Service Conference. We combine efforts with Chicago and Southern Illinois to host a State Conference. Having completed an area inventory, our hopes are to improve G.S.R. participation. We have been blessed with many past delegates, and past trustees' participation in our area. We are committed to reaching out and welcoming the new person with our love of the program of recovery and its spiritual principles. Also, we are aware of how vital it is to keep the more experienced A.A.s and encourage them to keep coming back. So through the amazing grace of God I'll keep coming back. — *Sonny McCard*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 is comprised of 27 districts with 789 groups and meetings. We select the members of our ten standing committees by lot from our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. We hold area assemblies on a rotating basis providing service opportunities to more districts. We have five area assemblies yearly with our pre-Conference assembly in early April. We also host a weekend service workshop assembly at one of our state parks in October that

is extremely popular and well attended. The Area Committee meets once a year in November to discuss the budget for the up-coming year. We are blessed with four active Intergroups in our area. We are also excited about hosting the East Central Regional Forum in 2003 in Columbus. The Spanish-speaking community is growing rapidly; we have nine Spanish meetings. Our delegate attended the Special Forum in Chicago this year. We made some major changes to our area structure recently so that our service outline now closely parallels *The A.A. Service Manual*.



No matter what the project—hosting our State Convention, cataloging archival material, managing displays at health fairs, speaking at schools, bridging the gap from treatment and jails—our uppermost thought is how we can better carry our message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Marco Garcia*

Kansas: Area 25 has 30 districts, including two special districts for our Spanish-speaking groups, and approximately 400 groups. We have two area assembly meetings annually and two area committee meetings, giving our 10 area committee chairs the opportunity to meet with their committees, which consist of D.C.M.s assigned by lot and district representatives. We hold an annual State Conference in September, hosted by different districts on a rotating basis. The make-up of Area 25 has changed over the past two years, with three districts in the central part of the state consolidating and our Spanish district splitting into two districts in order to better serve the groups involved. The area Chronicler is currently converting past minutes and group histories to electronic files to make them more available to the area. We recently approved new Service Structure Guidelines to more effectively define the scope and function of our service committees and the assembly. Area 25 is served by the Kansas Area Service office, which is centrally located and staffed by one part-time paid office worker. — *Tom Ledoux*

Kentucky: Area 26 has 33 districts, two of which are located in Southern Indiana. We have a total of 556 groups; two in Ohio and one in Metropolis Illinois. Every October we hold an area assembly with area committee meetings being held in January, April and July, all of which rotates to different locations throughout the area. Each and every one of our standing committees is active and continues to be one of the focal points during our meetings. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s are encouraged to participate in the Conference process through their home group and district, so that the groups' wishes are heard and considered at the area level; consequently, they are part of the delegate's thinking at the Conference. Normally, Area 26 is well represented at the Southeast Regional Forum held every other year. We have an area newsletter, published six times a year, along with an area registrar, who keeps our group records up to date. Recently the groups changed the way we conduct our elections for delegate and alternate delegate. We now use the Third Legacy Procedure. Area 26, like A.A., is in a constant state of evolution, learning about what has been left to us so that we may carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic, coupled with a better understanding and adherence to all three of our Legacies. — *Jim Schmitz*

Maine: Area 28 is truly an international area, with some 400 groups within the geographical boundaries of the State of Maine, and 24 groups in the Canadian province of New Brunswick. As an area we are geographically challenged, as it is 480 miles from border to border north and south as well as 200 miles east to west. There are also coastal islands where a trip to a meeting can be an all day affair. We currently have 21 districts with 18 active. The size of meetings varies greatly from some of the larger urban meetings with over 100 members to my home group with less than 10. Maine is pleased to announce our first Spanish-speaking meeting in District 1 (Portland); bilingual meetings are not new to Maine as we have had French-speaking groups for

some time. Our Central Service Office in Portland serves the area with needed services, and also rents the area the space to store our Area Archives. We have 21 active committees, most of which mirror the structure of the General Service Conference. The area committee meets seven times a year; two of these meetings serve as the pre- and post-Conference forums. We are honored to host the 2002 Northeast Regional Convention this fall in Portland, and are always seeking to improve upon our primary purpose in carrying the A.A. Message of Hope. It is great honor and privilege to serve as Area 28's delegate. It is through service that I may stay grateful, and through gratitude that I may stay sober. — *Miles M. Brookes*

Manitoba: Area 80 covers over 251,000 square miles with most of the population living in the southern half of the province. We have 14 districts and approximately 160 groups. We have four full assemblies a year and try to travel around the province so we have communication with as many groups and districts as possible. One of our visions in the next two years is to find a solution to the challenge of establishing a more effective way to have our "special chairs" carry the message throughout the province. We are also working on the appointing or election procedures for these positions, keeping in mind our area autonomy. We have an active central office in Winnipeg and, in cooperation with Winnipeg Intergroup, we are looking for more efficient ways to carry the message so that all may participate. These tasks are much harder to accomplish in the outlying rural and northern areas. To be unified with the Western region, we are planning to visit other assemblies in our respective areas. Traveling from area to area stretches our visions and adds to the service experience. In June 2001, we, hosted the Western Canada A.A. Service Assembly in Winnipeg. We are looking forward to the Regional Forum in Regina this June and know that many from our area are planning to attend. Thank you for this great opportunity to serve Alcoholics Anonymous. — *JoAnne Lowenberger*

Maryland: Area 29 consists of 47 districts, over 929 groups with approximately 14,989 members. Maryland varies in geography from coastal to mountain. Our members live in from lightly-populated rural to highly-populated metropolitan areas. Our members are of varied multi-cultural and ethnic backgrounds. Our committees parallel the General Service Conference. We have two conventions yearly, one in June, where the delegate reports on the Conference and one in October. Five area assemblies are held each year, where all members, G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, standing and ad hoc committees and area officers meet to discuss and conduct the area's business of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. In between each assembly there are four committee meetings where D.C.M.s, standing and ad hoc committee members, and area officers gather to provide leadership for the area assembly. Preceding the General Service Conference, districts are grouped together in six geographic regional clusters. Each cluster is given specific Conference agenda items to review and discuss with as many members throughout the state as possible. These clusters then report back the area conscience during a two-day gathering to help prepare the delegate for the Conference. — *Victor Long*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31 has approximately 250 registered groups served by 12 D.C.M.s. Estimated membership is 4,800. Our area committee meets monthly and is comprised of chairs and co-chairs of the five standing committees: Archives, C.P.C., Grapevine, P.I. and Round-Up. A representative from both our Western Massachusetts and Berkshire Intergroups as well as our Institutions committee also attend. All our committees and

After their wedding had been postponed twice, due to a family illness, Patty Tennant (South Carolina) and her groom Tom Tennant said their I dos before boarding the plane to the Conference.

districts meet monthly. We hold two weekend-long assemblies each year, one in the spring, which is combined with a mini-Conference, and one in the fall. Last spring our assembly voted to separate the alternate delegate and area chair positions to be effective this past January 1st. Previously the positions were combined. Both our Western Massachusetts and Berkshire Intergroup provide 24-hour phone coverage, meeting lists, and literature. In the spirit of unity our area plans the annual Massachusetts State Convention with Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts). We continue to strive to carry the message to those still sick and suffering through service. — *Bob Wilcox*

Michigan: Area 34 covers the western half of the Lower Peninsula and the eastern part of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have 16 districts with 11 active, and 460+ groups that are registered. We have two other areas in Michigan, Areas 32 and 33, with which we meet quarterly to keep unity in the state. Area 34 meets monthly, rotating from district to district. The average attendance at our assembly meetings for the past year has been around 30 people. We meet on the 3rd Sunday of the month starting at 10:30 a.m., in the morning, with committee meetings until we break for a potluck lunch. We start with our business meeting at 1:00 p.m., followed by the delegate's report, then the district reports. We have recently started an ad-hoc committee to see if Area 34 should start a Web site. We are currently putting together a new area directory of meetings. At our yearly workshop we try to explain the duties of the service positions and at the same time create new interest in service to the Fellowship. I feel very fortunate to have nine past delegates, two that were trustees, to help guide me through the next two years. — *Warren Jefsen*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 is starting a new rotation with many experienced service workers. The 500+ groups that comprise the 18 districts carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic, using a committee system structured around the Conference committees. In addition, a newsletter editor, archivist and group records secretary strengthen the unity and communication throughout Northern Minnesota. We have an annual workshop (Jan.), plus two assemblies that are held in the spring and fall; all are rotated through a four-zone system that insures that assemblies/workshops are in close proximity to every group on a regular basis. Our action committees also use this same system to hold workshops throughout the area during each rotation. We also have started having forums in these zones, which are modeled after the Forums that the General Service Office puts on. General Service Conference agendas and background material is distributed to the appropriate action committees as soon as it is available. They then discuss the information, and it is also discussed at an area committee meeting and the Spring Assembly, prior to the Conference, to insure an informed delegate. Our area actively participates in the West Central Regional Conference and Forum. We will be hosting the 2003 West Central Regional Conference in Bemidji, Minnesota. I would like to thank all of you for letting me be a small part of a great whole. — *Tim Calhoun*

Mississippi: Area 37 consists of 24 districts with approximately 300 groups. Our area assemblies are held quarterly; all assemblies are held in the city of Jackson, which is located in the center of our state. We have active standing committees: Archives, C.P.C., Correctional and Treatment Facilities, Finance, Grapevine, Literature, Newsletter, P.I. and Web site. Our area Web site (<http://AA-Mississippi.org>) makes information for meetings throughout the area more readily available to those seeking a

meeting. The South Mississippi Intergroup Central Office is located on the Gulf Coast in Gulfport. This office celebrated 13 years of operation in February 2002. Additional intergroups are active throughout the area. Our 56th Annual Mississippi State Convention will be held in Columbus in 2002. I am honored to be a part of this active Fellowship. — *Charles Hollins*

Nebraska: Our 2002 Reunion is being held June 7-9 this year in Grand Island. Each year districts bid to see who gets to host this event. Area 41 is made up of some 735 groups and 30 districts. All districts contribute financially to the well-being of Area 41. Only one of our districts has not been regularly sending a D.C.M. to our quarterly area assemblies. The first of this year's four Four-Corner workshops were held in that district. Our goal was to stimulate more interest and participation in service work. We have 12 standing committees. Our Linguistic Ad Hoc committee dissolved in January; their two years of sharing, reaching and discussing resulted in an area vote whether to "Establish a Remote Communities committee as part of the Area 41 committee structure." Two of our newer committees are Registrar and the Web page. Some of the more stimulating discussions we've had during the past year include moving our assemblies around to different parts of the state, changing the dates of them, and even changing its format. At our November assembly, we took a sense of the meeting and found that Area 41 is unanimous in support of the submission from Area 35, which states: "It is proposed that all literature being considered as 'Conference-approved Literature' be reviewed by all General Service Conference members prior to debate on the Conference floor." — *Curt Melton*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81 has 13 districts, nine in N.B. and four in P.E.I. We have one group in the Province of Nova Scotia, and one in the Province of Quebec, giving us 209 groups registered. We have approximately 26 French-speaking groups. Our First Nations Indian population is becoming more active, at district, and area level. We have two assemblies/roundups per year and two area business meetings and two sharing sessions. This year, due to the uncertainty of the weather, we combined our Jan. sharing session and our Mar. business meeting. Last winter we had a couple of postponements and finally a cancellation due to storms. This caused some concern, as some members of our assembly felt the area elected officers did not have the right or authority to cancel these events. We have combined some of our area committees, i.e., C.P.C. & P.I., Corrections & Treatment, Literature & Grapevine. Most all of our Provincial Correctional Institutions have closed, so we are now working mainly with Federal Penitentiaries. Our area Literature chairperson plans to have three literature displays: one with one of her committee members on P.E.I., one in the northern part of N.B. and one in central/southern part of N.B. This should better serve and be a cost saving to our area. One of the things I would like to happen during my term as Area 81's trusted servant would be for more members becoming familiar with *The A.A. Service Manual*, and more continuity between the operation of our districts and area. — *Walter Norrad*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has 15 districts and over 550 groups in 10 countries. We have nine committees: Archives, Corrections, Literature/Grapevine, P.I./C.P.C., Treatment, Finance, and Functions. We have the *Pipeline*, a monthly publication and our area service office. We have an outstanding Web site that continually updates meeting lists and other general A.A. information. Our service office, which has three paid part-time staff members, acts as a focal point for activities and informa-

tion, sells literature, interacts with our Web site, and maintains a computerized database of meetings, G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, districts and area committees. The area assembly meets four times a year, the area committee meets monthly. We had an area inventory in the fall to see if we could boost attendance and enliven participation at assemblies, but the turnout was disappointing. We held our first pre-Conference assembly last March, and the response was very favorable. We are having another pre-Conference assembly this year, followed by a post-Conference assembly. There are many A.A. activities held throughout the year, from our annual state convention to area, district, and group-sponsored events. Area 43 is working hard to carry the message to alcoholics, as well as to educate and develop our members as current and future trusted servants. — *Tom Kerner*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 consists of 527 registered groups, 31 districts, four sections and three intergroups. We meet in assembly four times a year, hold a mini-Conference in early April, and an annual area convention every March. We are honored to be hosting the 2003 Northeast Regional Convention in Cherry Hill. With publication of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book we are endeavoring to place a Fourth Edition in every public library in Area 45. The funds for this project came from excess generated by an unexpectedly successful 2001 area convention. We have purchased 800 Big Books and our P.I. committee is distributing them. Our Correctional and Treatment Facilities committee hosts an annual interarea C.F. and T.F. Conference. Since many treatment facilities are short term we have instituted a bridging the gap phone line. The toll free number is printed on business cards which are distributed at treatment centers. Patients of these facilities can leave a message and an A.A. contact will call them. During Panel 50 we entered the twenty-first century in both the literal and figurative sense as we launched our web site (www.snjaa.org), which to date has had 2,386 hits. "Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code" is the theme of Area 45 for the next two years, to remind us to be mindful and respectful of the diversity of experience, people and opinions within and without our Fellowship as we share the Steps, Traditions and Concepts. — *Joe O'Neill*

New Mexico: Area 46 is composed of higher desert and Rocky Mountains — over 120,000 sq. mi. Our area is divided into 17 districts, including our newest Spanish-linguistic district. We have approx. 331 active groups. Our assemblies convene in March, September and December for area business; our June meeting is our State Convention. Because of the needs of our remote communities our assemblies and convention are awarded on a bid basis, one year in advance. We try and encourage participation at this level from all our districts. Our assemblies meet all day Saturday and half a day on Sunday. All motions are made during the business session on Saturday. We vote on them on Sunday morning. We have ten standing committees that mirror the General Service Conference Committees. We are grateful that our area committees continue to evolve and grow as they carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. One of our area's strengths is the way that we use our literature, specifically the Big Book, in our meetings and as we help newcomers to understand and take our Twelve Steps of recovery. The experience, strength and hope of our founders remain with us as together we trudge the Road of Happy Destiny. — *Ray Romero*

New York (Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire): Area 48 encompasses all or part of 19 counties in New York State. There are currently 777 registered meetings. Our Corrections committee is responsible for 19 county facilities and 32 state prisons. We have 85

meetings in treatment centers. Bridging the Gap processed over 4,000 requests last year and we expect more in 2002. Spanish-speaking groups are being formed in various parts of the area. Area committee meetings are held each month with the location rotated among the 18 districts. In March we have our Day of Sharing where the delegate receives input on Conference issues; the delegate reports on Conference Actions at the May assembly. HMB will be hosting the New York State Convention in 2002. Planning is underway to host the North East Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2003. Our fourth annual Area Inventory Day was held in January. This event has increased interest and participation in area events. The cost of carrying A.A.'s message of hope has been the topic of many discussions recently. It is hoped by many in area and district service that this year's Conference theme of Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts will broaden our members' appreciation of the responsibilities we have to actively support all three sides of the A.A. triangle. I am extremely fortunate to be a member of the A.A. Fellowship and deeply honored to serve as delegate for Area 48, Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire, New York. — *Dave Steiner*

New York (Western): Area 50 has over 300 groups and 23 districts. My area has gone through some bad times, by which we have learned that it is up to the area officers and assembly to work together. Today we are back to handling our area the way *The A.A. Service Manual* says. We have new energetic officers. Our first meeting of the year we accomplished more than the assembly has done in two years. We are getting more people involved, and the good part is they want to get involved. We have many workshops coming up to keep all A.A. members informed. I am looking forward to serving my area. Also I am looking forward to learning more about my job. It is a privilege for me to represent my area. — *Janet Neri-Kafel*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southwest): Area 55 has approximately 450 groups and meetings served by 17 districts. We have one central office. All of our standing committees are active in carrying the A.A. message to all who suffer from alcoholism as well as to our professional friends in the court, clergy, corrections, and medical fields, who make many alcoholics aware of our Fellowship. We have eight assembly meetings per year and our D.C.M.s meet quarterly. We have a D.C.M. meeting prior to the area assembly so they can share their successes and challenges together. We try to better communicate with our groups to better facilitate the two-way flow of information. We host a Mini-Conference every March on the Conference with actual agenda items to better inform the area of what is happening in A.A. as a whole. One of our greatest assets is the many people who have served the Fellowship for many years and remain active today. Our past delegates are still active in service work and readily available to help us. This year we will host the East Central Regional Conference and the Ohio State Convention. I am honored to serve as delegate for an area that stays so focused on Recovery, Unity and Service in a changing Fellowship. May God continue to bless you, this Conference and the program that saved my life — Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Bob Carpenter*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 is comprised of 29 districts, with over 500 registered groups in the 16 counties we serve. We meet every month—even months being an assembly meeting to take care of voting issues and odd months being a committee meeting where the different committees share their experience, strength, hope, and ideas on how their committees are passing on the A.A. message. We have an early-spring mini-Conference patterned after the General Service Conference. This year we

have four new officers and five new standing committee chairpersons. We rotated our Archive Committee chair to our immediate past delegate. All are enthusiastic in carrying out the third legacy. This year we are planning our annual Unity Day Workshop — a meeting of sharing sessions of all the committees, at the district, intergroup, and area level. We provide G.S.R. school for all new G.S.R.s. At our meetings, we have a presentation on a Tradition and a Concept — starting with Tradition 1 and Concept 1 in January and so on. Our area encompasses two area intergroups, Dayton and Cincinnati. We hope to put in place this year a more active district committee participation by trying to reach out to the groups in crowded urban areas as well as an outreach into the rural sections of our area. — *Mary Pat Yater*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has matured and stabilized a great deal over the past ten to twelve years, thanks in no small part, to the wisdom and guidance of our past delegates and old service hands. Until 2001, we had been served by a duplicate subcommittee structure composed of, for example, two P.I. chairpeople, one for the southwest portion of our area, and one for the northeast. This was necessary in order to meet the challenge of our geographic diversity. This year, however, we have restructured our subcommittees, and reduced our subcommittee positions to one chair each on, P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections, and Grapevine. In addition, we have created the positions of Special Needs/Remote Communities, Registrar, Archives, and Newsletter chairpersons. It is our hope that restructuring will allow us room for future growth and better allow the area to help the districts and groups carry the A.A. message. Our greatest challenge as an area now will be making contact with what I call the “Missing-in-action” groups. Only 40% of our groups contribute to G.S.O.; only 30% take part in assemblies, and only 15% support the area financially. We need to reach out to those groups, demonstrate to them the benefits of being “a part of,” and so attract them into, or back into, the service structure. — *Paul Haynes*

Oregon: Area 58 has 33 districts, of which one is a Hispanic district that includes the entire state, and approximately 720 registered groups. We have four area assemblies a year which are hosted by districts at various locations. At each assembly there are Spanish interpreters, and hearing-impaired interpreters are available as needed. We have an ad-hoc committee researching the possible formation of an area Web site. Our area handbook was recently revised, and is a valuable tool for conducting area business, and introducing G.S.R.s to service. We are blessed to have several past delegates, who are able to attend our area assemblies. They serve A.A. well as elder statesmen, serve on Ask-It-Basket, Concepts, Traditions panels, and are service sponsors. Throughout the year, many of our districts host G.S.R. schools, which are chaired by our alternate delegate. The focus is to better acquaint the new G.S.R.s with general service, and to help make them aware of the vital role the G.S.R. is to the home group, and A.A. as a whole. Our P.I. committee has a Special Needs committee, as do some of our districts. Our standing committees are active in conducting workshops at the district level throughout the year. We would like to thank our out-going Pacific Regional trustee Jim Clough for the tremendous, excellent service he has provided to the Pacific Region, and A.A. as a whole. I feel very honored to be able to serve our beloved Oregon Area, and this very spiritual Fellowship. — *Darlene Bushnell*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 is divided into nine districts, 120 groups and around 1,350 A.A. members. Our central office, serviced by two nonvoluntary A.A. members, receives requests for help

(Twelfth Step) from the general public as well as requests for information about the program from schools, churches and companies. Requests are forwarded to the appropriate P.I. committee or to the nearest A.A. group. A monthly journal, *Despertar (Awake)* brings information about the program, the area, group activities and group meetings. We have a monthly area meeting. Most groups have at least two meetings a week. Also, we have five English groups, plus one group that celebrates an English meeting in the east district. In the springtime (February) we have an Annual Area Convention with seminars and workshops to share experience and for discussion of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts. We have two assemblies during the year. During December, we celebrate our Christmas party for the whole area. — *José Antonio Mejías*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90 includes 25 districts serving 425 groups, (24 of which are in detention centers) and holds 560 weekly meetings. We maintain six service committees—Twelfth Step, area bulletin, detention centers, treatment centers and P.I., La Vigne and Publications. We also have four working committees (archive, remote communities, information session and structure), plus two supporting committees (finances and secretary). Each elected area servant acts as a sponsor for a working committee, as well as the two support committees. Our detention centers committee holds an annual convention sponsored by the area. Three times a year, the elected members of all four Quebec areas (87, 88, 89 and 90) meet in an Interregional Meeting in Quebec Center (Drummonville, Quebec). This results in a positive exchange for all four areas. During this gathering, we plan the annual Interprovincial Rally, where we exchange our different points of view on area services. Our newly formed District 27 is an English-speaking district, exclusively formed of native members (Inuit and Crees). The working committee on remote communities has formed a team of members to translate the minutes of the area committee, in order to facilitate the integration of these English-speaking groups to our areas. We have come a long way since 1994 with the project on remote communities, which has now become a reality. — *Marc-Andre Grenier*

Quebec (Southwest): Area 87 has the smallest geographical territory among Quebec A.A. areas, but we host the largest number of groups and members in a 50-mile radius. Our area is officially bilingual (French-English) and also hosts some Spanish-speaking groups and other groups where different languages are spoken. We also have a group for deaf-mute members. We have approximately 16,000 members and around 575 registered groups dispersed in 28 districts: 21 French-speaking; six English-speaking districts, and one Spanish-speaking district. The districts' limits have been reviewed, at the request of D.C.M.s, and were reduced from 30 districts to 28 following a regrouping of French districts. The urban concentration allows us to provide a gamut of centralized services manned by 12 committees. Our Service Training Seminar has fostering more commitment from members. The Conference theme “Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts” is on the agenda of the Service Training Seminars. The benefits of a recent inventory performed at La Vigne is reflected in an efficient well-structured operation. The three annual interregional area meetings in Quebec permit us to be more unified and better attain our primary purpose: helping the suffering alcoholic. — *Denis Vézina*

Rhode Island: Area 61 has eight districts, seven geographic districts and a statewide linguistic Latino district. There are approximately 250 groups with over 500 meetings weekly. Our area

committee meets monthly and we hold four state assemblies per year, including a pre-Conference Workshop Assembly in April. Our Archives committee has been conducting an oral history project of taping longtimers. Our Corrections committee brings more than 50 meeting a month behind the walls of our four correctional facilities. Our Treatment committee brings approximately 35 meetings a month to hospitals and treatment center. The C.P.C./P.I./Special Needs Committee has been very active with presentations in facilities and schools, nursing homes and to medical students and teachers. They have also distributed A.A. information sheets with local phone numbers to all area hospital emergency rooms and are presenting copies of the Big Book to middle and high school libraries. The Special Needs Committee has also been providing the Big Book in Braille to libraries and to the Perkins Institute. We host an all-day Roundup in September, and a weekend Newport Convention that attracts A.A.s from all over. Our Latino community also hosts an all day convention. The highlight of our year was in November when we celebrated 60 years of A.A. in Rhode Island with a day-long celebration which included a presentation by G.S.O. archivist Judit Santon. It was a moving and joyous day! — *Sally McAuley*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 has an environment of extremes, both geological and climate wise. We have 21 districts, approximately 325 groups, and 3,700 members. We have a D.C.M. meeting in January, and hold a spring and fall assembly each year, hosted by a district who had their bid accepted at a previous assembly. We have about a 35% representation of the area at our assemblies. The area pays the expenses incurred by D.C.M.s attending area assemblies and D.C.M. meetings, to encourage participation. It is equally important to encourage those who are participating. The D.C.M.s (the workhorses of A.A.) have a special place in my heart. One cold night I was at a meeting in a shed heated by an oil burner thing with coffee brewing on top of it. Another time I was at a meeting in a swanky hotel, but it didn't matter where or the surroundings, the A.A. message was the same. — *Glen Hope*

South Carolina: Area 62 took our area inventory in February 2001 and at our June 2001 assembly voted (by overwhelming unanimity) to do away with our regional system of electing area officers. We voted to change our structures and procedures to follow Third Legacy Procedures as outlined in *The A.A. Service Manual*. We all prayed for Unity as we approached the election. Elections were held at our October 2001 assembly. The presence of our Higher Power could be felt in the room. Much healing was accomplished. We have 24 districts with approximately 300 groups and an active membership of over 6,500. We recently hosted the 57th Southeastern Regional/54th S.C. State A.A. Convention in Columbia, S.C. The workshops were based on our 52nd Conference theme. Recovery, Unity, and Service are the goals our area has set as we look toward the future. We are seeking ways that our committees can complement each other and carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous through P.I./C.P.C., Corrections, Treatment, Grapevine, and Literature. Cole Z., a past area 62 delegate who recently passed away, often said "If we are all thinking alike, we ain't none of us thinking at all." The officers of Area 62 are combined in hearing the voice of our assembly and following the directives of a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. — *Patty Tennant*

South Dakota: Area 63 consists of 155 groups in 15 districts. We have four area functions per year, two area conferences (spring and fall), and two workshops (mid-winter and mid-summer). Workshops are held in a geographically central location (Pierre).

Items are discussed and voted upon to place them on the agenda and voted on at the area conferences. Our committees are active, with two (Literature/Grapevine and Archives) having displays that are brought to area functions. We are in a transitional period, but as people become familiar with the committee system, we anticipate that it will work well. Of further significance, we have begun an Area Web site. Included are items of interest such as area functions and a list of registered groups. (Web address is www.southdakotaaa.org). We have attained a prudent reserve of nine to twelve months operating expenses. With group contributions up we are less dependent on income generated by area conferences, and closer to being self-supporting through our group contributions. All in all, A.A. in Area 63 is enthusiastic and involved in carrying the message to newcomers. — *John Evans*

Tennessee: Area 64 has approximately 500 groups in 38 districts. The area assembly meets quarterly at different locations giving various regions and cities the opportunity to host the meeting. The average attendance at assembly is 350, with 150 to 175 being voting members. The area funds the delegate and alternate delegate to all assemblies, Southeast Regional Forum and Southeastern Conference as well as the Delegate Get Together annually in Atlanta. The area officers are funded to attend all assemblies and the Southeastern Forum. Standing committee chairs for the area are also funded to the assemblies. There is a state convention annually, which is hosted by different districts across the state. The standing committees are very active with the Treatment and Corrections Facilities committees continuing to be active in Bridging the Gap. The Corrections committee also sponsors two workshops annually apart from the assembly. The C.P.C. Committee has regional coordinators who participate/sponsor workshops and staff exhibits at professional gatherings. The Archives Committee took part in the 6th National Archives Workshop held in Louisville last September by giving a presentation on the development of our archives. The major focus of our area over the last two quarters has been funding, the budget, and how to get more groups to participate in the area. — *Betty Barnette*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66 consist of 14 districts serving about 235 groups with approximately 6,500 members. In the past ten years we have grown, thanks in part to the new challenges that have arisen such as: Bilingual districts; participation in Regional and Special Forums; getting new members involved; etc. Our area assemblies meet every three months on a rotational basis and are currently talking about centralizing the assemblies. At our assemblies, we break down in committees to discuss General Service Conference material. The Institutional committee continues to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic and our P.I. committee provides information throughout our area. The Literature committee has provided us with workshops and keeps the area well informed about all Conference-approved literature. Our Archive committee has a centralized location and is chaired by a past delegate. The Newsletter committee keeps the area informed about upcoming events as well as ideas and comments on current issues. The other committees have had some difficulties due to the lack of participation. Thank God that overall in our area there is room for improvement. — *Joe Lopez*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has 33 districts, including six with Spanish-speaking groups. We encourage Spanish-speaking members to participate by providing translation equipment for area assemblies and district service workshops, and we hosted

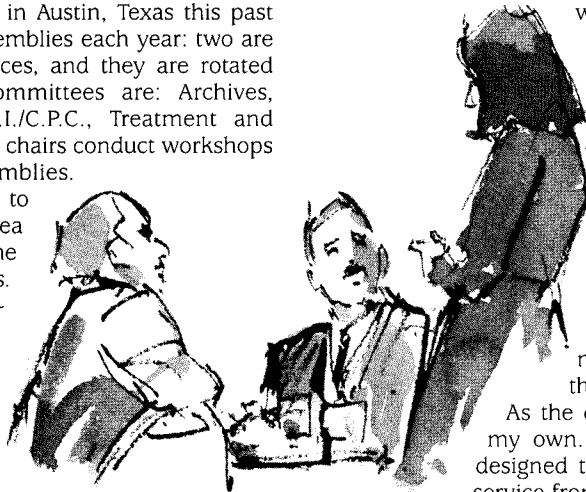
the first ever Spanish Special Forum in Austin, Texas this past December. We host four two-day assemblies each year: two are workshops, two are voting conferences, and they are rotated throughout the area. The area committees are: Archives, Grapevine, Bilingual, Newsletter, P.I./C.P.C., Treatment and Correctional Facilities. The committee chairs conduct workshops at the summer and winter assemblies.

Districts and groups are encouraged to conduct mini-workshops and the area offsets expenses to these events for the area officers and committee chairs. The alternate delegate serves as literature chairperson. Our past delegates are active and continue to bless us with their experience. Service to the districts and groups is the focus of our efforts and every attempt is made to encourage participation of the groups. We look forward to hosting the 2010 International Convention in San Antonio, Texas and to sharing the wonderful Texas hospitality with A.A. worldwide.
— Rita Lambert

Vermont: Area 70 is comprised of about 240 groups in 11 districts. We have assemblies four times a year at sites hosted by the various districts; the committee meets seven times at a set central location and we hold a pre-Conference event to discuss some agenda items for the upcoming Conference. We recently installed a Finance committee with our other 9 standing committees of Archives, State Convention, Corrections, Grapevine, Literature, Meeting Lists, P.I./C.P.C. (with a subcommittee of Web site), Service Structure and Treatment Facilities. We have very active committees with terrific support from our past delegates; however, there does not seem to be the enthusiasm for service that we hope for. As such we would like to bid to be the host for the 2005 Northeast Regional Forum. Attending functions such as this has attracted and energized me and I have always walked away with a renewed commitment. It is hoped this would be one of the many positive results of having a Forum in Vermont. I feel privileged and I am grateful for this opportunity to serve my fellow alcoholics. — Duncan McAuley

Washington State East: Area 92 consists of 400 groups with 21 active districts, covering the State of Washington, parts of Idaho, Oregon, Montana and British Columbia. Two districts are Spanish-speaking. The area created another standing chair, that of translations, which will help us to be more inclusive. This will allow our Spanish-speaking districts to receive information in a timely manner so they can participate at all area functions. There was also the creation of an Area Web site to enhance communication. We had the honor of hosting a PRAASA (Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly) in 2001 at Spokane; approximately 900 attended. We also hosted a Special Forum this past year — a two-day event with one day in Yakima and one day in Spokane. This has strengthened communication within our area and with the General Service Office. Our last assembly was held in British Columbia for the first time. Our standing committees are now having one combined area quarterly with all committees participating. This has allowed more of our members to see what each committee's work is about and interest and enthusiasm has increased. — Gene Davis

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Penninsula of Michigan: Area 74 has approximately 600 groups within 24 districts. We have two conferences, two assemblies and one Preassembly/Delegates



workshop yearly. Business at the conference is limited to elections and the delegate's report. Through the continued development of our committee system we are trying to streamline the business done at assemblies. This year we will adopt the General Service Conference "guidelines" for procedures at the assemblies. Our hope is that using time during committee meetings to thoroughly discuss agenda items and proposals will ultimately provide a better informed committee with a platform to present a well thought-out motion on the assembly floor.

As the delegate I do have a service agenda of my own. The message that I hope to bring is designed to erase the mental wall that separates service from Twelfth Step work. I believe that if, as an area, we ask of the individual A.A. and group, "what do you need to carry the message?" we will begin to refocus on our primary purpose. When I came to A.A. I felt at home because I was among people who understood me and the disease. I felt at home because you provided an answer for me and direction for living. The same holds true as I learn to "Carry the Message." I need to rely on the entire Fellowship for the "best" direction. I believe that this is another area where "good is an enemy of the best." While we understand how to Bridge the Gap into corrections and treatment it is time to "Bridge the Gap" between service and the individual A.A. in his/her home group. It is my prayer that each of us carries the same message. Above all else we need to assure that the hand of A.A. is there. — Ted Lapine

Wyoming: Area 76 has 103 groups in 10 districts spread over 97,105 square miles. We hold two assemblies and two conventions per year. The assemblies are rotated between smaller towns, with the Conventions held in the larger cities. The size of the area often creates travel time of 7-8 hours to reach the assembly and convention locations. Our Corrections Committee has been active in improving our communications with the Wyoming Corrections Department and increasing participation in A.A. meetings inside the facilities. We are working on increasing communication between the area officers, standing committees, D.C.M.s and the groups in an effort to get more people involved in service. I have been fortunate in having examples of A.A. service, in that our area, although spread out, has very active participation from the past delegates at our assemblies and our monthly district meetings. We have recently elected an area archivist to catalog, store, and display a large and varied group of items that we have had for some time, and never taken care of in the proper manner. It is hoped that by this effort we will be able to display our archives for all to see and enjoy. Area 76 is trying to find any and all new ideas to carry the A.A. messages to the entire state. — Bill Graham

With Us in Spirit. . .

Loren Buettner (Montana) need never worry about his area being behind him. During Conference week A.A.s in Montana bombarded him with mail (one day alone he got 11 postcards). He also received a 10 page, multicolored, accordion-pleated missive with messages from various A.A.s (one sober just four days). A wonderful example of how all A.A.s participate in the Conference.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee suggested the wording on page 4 of the Conference Evaluation Form, which reads "no signature needed," be changed to "signature optional" with an additional check-off box for individuals wishing to be contacted.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee discussed the suggested changes received from an area and took no action. The committee requested the trustees' Archives Committee to consider those suggestions in future reprints of the Workbook. All areas are encouraged to continue reviewing the Archives Workbook and submit suggestions for future revisions.
- The committee reviewed "The A.A. Archives" service piece that was newly developed by the trustees' Archives Committee. The service piece will be available for wider distribution immediately after the General Service Conference.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee was in agreement with the trustees' Committee report to keep the "singleness of purpose" statement in existing C.P.C. pamphlets as is. The committee suggested the following:

Continue to publish articles in *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9* on A.A.'s singleness of purpose, emphasizing Tradition Three, "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking";

Encourage C.P.C. committees to communicate the importance of A.A.'s singleness of purpose to professionals;

Continue to review the C.P.C. Workbook and Kit to be sure there is sufficient information in each on our singleness of purpose.

- The committee considered the idea of a service piece on "Singleness of Purpose is A.A.'s Strength," similar to the Summer 2001 issue of *About A.A.*, and did not feel there was a need at this time for a service piece.

(Note: The "Singleness of Purpose" statement reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership only if they have a drinking problem.")

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees'

Committee report regarding addressing in C.P.C. literature that A.A. is not allied with any religion and suggested that the Fellowship:

Consider different modes of communicating what is meant by "spirituality" in A.A. during workshops, sharing sessions, Regional and Special Forums; and, in communications with professionals, utilize C.P.C. pamphlets as well as *About A.A.*

Continue looking for ways to improve cooperation with staff in treatment centers, who may have misgivings about A.A. as a resource for their clients.

- The committee considered a request that the soft-cover C.P.C. Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature and agreed with the 1997 Conference Advisory Action that the C.P.C. Workbook continue to be designated as service material.
- A request for the development of a Conference-approved pamphlet similar to the flyer "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea" was discussed at length by the Conference C.P.C. Committee. The committee expressed appreciation for the idea and forwarded the request to the trustees Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee for further review.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

On page 7, add "at" to the sentence to read "Let's take a look at some of our A.A. Traditions and their relationship to cooperation with the professional community."

On page 18, put a comma after nursing and delete the word "and" to read, "Most of the information that follows concerns working with medical students, but the same ideas may be used with students in such other areas as social work, law, nursing, dentistry, pharmacy, education, law enforcement and theology."

On page 5 of the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" change "Should P" to "Should I?"

In the Service Piece, "Working With Students Attending Professional Schools," change the section "Working with Medical Students" to "Working With Medical and Other Professional Schools Students."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider publishing the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook in a three-ring binder format and that a progress report be sent as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.
- The committee requested that a statement of purpose be developed by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities for use as an introduction to the Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit, and sent as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.

¹ Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee develop a statement on A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose to be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook after review by the 2003 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

(Note: A "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently in several pamphlets reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical

dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership only if they have a drinking problem." The committee suggested that references to "a drinking problem" be changed to "a desire to stop drinking," as reflected in our Third Tradition.)

- The committee suggested that the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" be included with welcome letters and other material sent to incoming Area Correctional Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging The Gap committee chairpersons.

- The committee suggested that the Publications Department consider reformatting the cover of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" at the next printing so that the title is fully visible when the pamphlet is folded and placed in literature racks.

- The committee suggested that the Corrections Correspondence Service pamphlet (F-26) be listed in catalogs of our A.A. Conference-approved Literature and Other Service Material. The committee remarked on the importance of sharing about this service in assemblies, Forums and other A.A. events. It was noted that sharing of personal experience with this service would encourage more members to participate.

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider distributing the newsletter *Sharing From Behind The Walls* to A.A. groups in Correctional Facilities. Additionally, the committee suggested that the Publications Department consider reformatting the newsletter *Sharing From Behind The Walls* in an easy-to-read type, and forward the results as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.

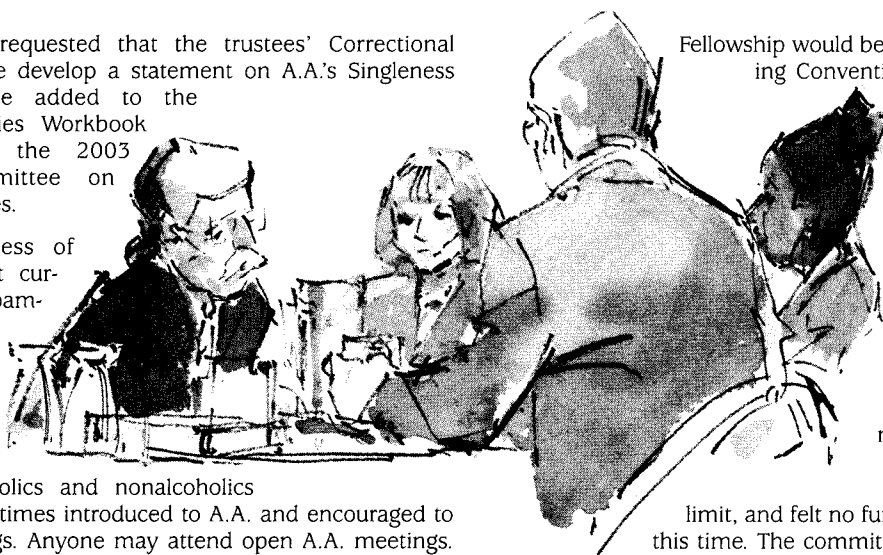
- The committee discussed various ways that A.A. information is presented to staff in Correctional Facilities.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed input from the Fellowship on local Convention reporting matters.

After a broad discussion, the committee felt that reporting matters are not a policy level issue but a matter of Professional accounting.

The committee felt that by reporting International Convention activities in a separate column on the financial statements the



Fellowship would be better informed about ongoing Convention activities, and urges that such reporting be implemented as soon as practicable.

- The committee discussed information received as a result of the 2001 Conference Finance Committee's request for additional sharing on the philosophy of using literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund balance to its upper

limit, and felt no further action was necessary at this time. The committee realized that the Floating Cap Plan allows for orderly management of the Reserve Fund, which does not preclude literature price reductions.

- The committee encourages preparation and periodic distribution of a simplified description of the purposes and necessity of G.S.O.'s Reserve Fund (for example in *Box 4-5-9*).

The committee also encourages frequent explanation and communication of services G.S.O. provides to and on behalf of the Fellowship.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board the following items for development: 1) Declaration of Responsibility signs in English and (when feasible) in Spanish and in French, with a facsimile of the art that appears in the Grapevine; 2) *Best of Grapevine* CDs; and 3) a Spanish-language CD.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested that host committee contacts and delegates of host areas increase their efforts to provide information about Forums; utilize G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site for on-line registration, generate enthusiasm by visiting groups and emphasize the need for volunteers to participate in host committees.

The committee expressed interest in the possibility of having more frequent and accessible Regional/Special Forums.

- The committee discussed and reviewed the 2015 International Convention Site-selection Procedures.

LITERATURE

- The committee noted the following information that was reported at the April 21, 2002 joint meeting with the trustees' Literature Committee:

Addition of one story "The Fearful One" to Anthology for a total of 56 stories.

Title suggestions from the trustees' Literature Committee and the G.S.O. editor for the anthology project.



A report from the G.S.O. editor on the editing deletion of the ninth paragraph of the story "Freedom from Bondage" which was included in the Third Edition of the Big Book and which was deleted from the Fourth Edition to create a page count in the Fourth Edition similar to the page count of the Third Edition.

Taking into consideration previous Conference Advisory Actions addressing the historical context of Bill Wilson's writings, the committee requested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding a statement to the Foreword of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* explaining the historical context of Bill's writings and report back to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee.

- The committee reviewed the complimentary service material "Concepts Checklist" (F-91) which was revised January 2002 and thanked the subcommittee of the trustees' Literature Committee for their service in completing this revision.
- The committee considered at length the request for a new edition of the Spanish Big Book and took no action as a widely expressed need was not exhibited at this time.
- The committee considered the request to add a quote from Concept Nine to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and took no action. The committee agreed that this addition was not necessary.
- After careful consideration of the request to restore "The Doctor's Opinion" to page 1 as published in the First Edition of the Big Book from 1939 to 1955 in future printings of the Big Book, the committee agreed to take no action.
- The committee reviewed the January 15, 2002 summary of responses received by the General Service Office to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book and was grateful for all sharing received in response to the publication of the Fourth Edition.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee strongly suggested that when an area submits an "Application for Additional Delegate Area," a special meeting at the Conference of the Policy/Admissions Committee be held so that any delegate submitting an application can respond to questions of the committee for clarification.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the report given by the General Service Board's Ad Hoc Committee on the General Service Structure and agreed to distribute the Ad Hoc

Committee's Progress Report and the summary of responses to the 2001 Ad Hoc Committee's Questionnaire to all Conference members.

- The committee suggested that Final Agenda Items and background material be distributed to Conference members requesting them in time to be received by February 15th.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee suggested that television public service announcement inventory items #TV-14 ("Male" and "Information") and #TV-28 ("BG's Advice" and "High/Low Bottom") be removed from inventory. Inventory items #TV-14 and #TV-28 have the lowest circulation of all current P.S.A.s.
- The committee reviewed the need for producing a radio or print public service announcement specific to the holiday season, and agreed that it is not necessary to produce a Conference-approved radio or print public service announcement specific to the holiday season.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook. They considered a request that the soft-cover Public Information Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature and agreed that the Workbook serves its purpose as service material, noting that the Public Information Kit and Workbook are reviewed by the Conference P.I. Committee each year.
- The committee agreed to add a third "suggested newspaper announcement" with the language, "If you want to drink that's your business. If you want to stop, we can help." on page 40 of the Public Information Workbook at its next printing.
- The committee requested that any changes to be implemented to the Public Information Kit or Workbook be communicated in the activity updates from the P.I. staff member. (Note: Activity updates are sent to all Public Information committee chairs two to three times per year and are copied to all area delegates.)
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee on religion and spirituality in P.I. literature. They agreed that, where appropriate, P.I. literature adequately addresses A.A.'s not being a religious organization, noting the change made to the service piece, "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," and agreed that no further action was necessary.

- Committee members reviewed the 2001 report on G.S.O.'s Web site activity and discussed Web sites as a Public Information tool.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the diagram "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group" as it appeared in the 1998-1999 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* on page S49 in Chapter II "The General Service Representative and The Group" and took no action.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider revising the chart "Service Structure Inside The A.A. Group" on page 24 in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet to better reflect the current structure of a typical A.A. Group.
- The committee suggested that the Publications Department complete the revision of the "Regional Map of U.S. & Canada" to replace the existing regional map on page S62 in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee agreed that the updated charts "General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous and A.A. World Services, Inc." and the "Grapevine Corporate Board" replace the existing charts on page S72 and S80 in *The A.A. Service Manual* to accurately reflect the current structure of G.S.O. and A.A.W.S., Inc., and the Grapevine Corporate Board.
- The committee agreed that the proofs of updates to Chapter Eleven "The General Service Office," and to Chapter Twelve "The A.A. Grapevine" in *The A.A. Service Manual* will be mailed to the committee for review following the 52nd General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed the *Final Conference Report* and appreciated the anecdotal inserts and sketches included in the *Final Conference Report*.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee consider adding the average cost of services per member to the annual "Contributions from Groups by Delegate Area" report in the *Final Conference Report*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee considered a request that the soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature, and unanimously agreed that the Treatment Facilities Workbook continue to be designated as service material.
- The committee unanimously agreed to the request that the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook be combined in a 3-ring binder format; and, requests that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities examine all options to accomplish that purpose, and provide a progress report as background to the 2003 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for consideration.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustees.
- It was the consensus of the committee that the A.A. Fellowship be asked to look for and encourage qualified and willing nonal-

coholic "friends of A.A." to serve as Class A trustees. It was also noted that the identification of potential applicants should be an ongoing process, rather than occurring only when there is a scheduled vacancy.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The Correctional Facilities Workbook be changed to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- An electronic voting system be given a two-year experimental trial at the Fifty-third and Fifty-fourth General Service Conferences at a cost of approximately \$5,000 a year, keeping in mind the spiritual, practical and financial considerations outlined in the 2002 report by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, and that an evaluation on the overall effectiveness of this system be submitted by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to the 2004 Conference Policy Admissions Committee by February 15, 2004.
- All literature being considered as "General Service Conference-approved literature" be made available for review by all General Service Conference members prior to debate on the Conference floor.

FLOOR ACTION WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- If and when a new Spanish-language Big Book is produced by A.A.W.S., an appeal be made to the Fellowship for stories originally written in Spanish by Spanish-speaking members of Alcoholics Anonymous for possible inclusion.
- It is recommended that an ad-hoc committee be formed to evaluate options for the review of material proposed for General Service Conference approval by Conference members, and report its findings to the 2003 General Service Conference Policy/Admissions Committee. The ad hoc committee shall be comprised of the general manager, trustees, G.S.O. staff and delegates appointed by the General Service Board chair.
- The Twelve Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous be produced in a window shade display format similar to the M-14 "Twelve Steps" window shade display and a parchment format similar to the M-3 Twelve Steps parchment, for sale and distribution to our Fellowship.
- Reconsider the request to restore "The Doctor's Opinion" to Page 1 as published in the First Edition of the Big Book from 1939-1955 in future printings of the Big Book.
- Request that A.A.W.S. consider printing an 8 ½" by 11" poster of the Twelve Concepts.
- A statement be added to the letter sent convention bureau contacts, before they submit their bids, from the chairperson of the trustees' International Conventions Committee, expressing the thought: that in keeping with our Tradition of Self-Support, Alcoholics Anonymous does not accept cash subsidies.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2001 (with comparative totals for 2000)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2001	Consolidated 2000
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
ASSETS							
Cash	\$ 1,050,381	\$ 862,521		\$ 1,083,544	\$ 399,929	\$ 3,396,375	\$ 4,563,814
Accounts and interest receivable		143,494		352,784	61,459	557,737	448,470
Intercompany balances	(1,089,368)	(1,566,453)		1,103,177	1,552,644	-	-
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.				1,682,934	80,107	1,763,041	1,565,970
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.				168,139	28,960	197,099	174,065
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 2002/2011							
(Cost: 2001 - \$10,497,533;							
2000 - \$8,499,142)		10,897,817				10,897,817	8,722,109
Property and Equipment							
Leasehold improvements,							
computer hardware and software,							
(net of accumulated depreciation -							
2001 - \$2,948,836;							
2000 - \$2,711,098)			\$520,403			520,403	758,141
Deferred charges and deposits	158,070			80,312	88,890	327,272	274,012
Prepaid pension cost (Note 3)		1,596,107				1,596,107	1,343,421
Total Assets	119,083	11,933,486	520,403	4,470,890	2,211,989	19,255,851	17,850,002
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	\$ 59,880			\$ 1,340,349	\$ 251,268	\$ 1,651,497	\$ 838,840
Accrued royalties				68,354		68,354	39,761
Deferred income							
Orders and subscriptions, etc				72,184	1,529,739	1,601,923	1,548,506
Other	2,190					2,190	-
Accrued postretirement health benefit obligation (Note 5)		\$ 2,892,956				2,892,956	2,957,841
Total Liabilities	62,070	2,892,956	\$ -	1,480,887	1,781,007	6,216,920	5,384,948
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	9,040,530	520,403	2,990,003	430,982	13,038,931	12,465,054
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	119,083	11,933,486	520,403	4,470,890	2,211,989	19,255,851	17,850,002

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2001 (with comparative totals for 2000)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2001	Consolidated 2000
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 11,582,000	\$ 2,223,516	\$ 70,226	\$13,875,742	\$12,125,409
Less: Discounts				290,413	38,499		328,912	327,773
Net Sales				11,291,587	2,185,017	70,226	13,546,830	11,797,636
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(4,113,774)	(399,184)	(38,421)	(4,551,379)	(3,539,457)
Royalties on books				(197,294)	-	-	(197,294)	(167,917)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(1,080,789)	(515,627)	(23,612)	(1,620,028)	(1,465,101)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,899,730	1,270,206	8,193	7,178,129	6,625,161
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 4,688,831						4,688,831	4,511,206
2000 International Convention (Net of direct expenses of \$3,110,804)							-	997,584
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	8,464	\$ 682,981		11,687	87,186	-	790,318	874,168
Total Income	4,697,295	682,981		5,911,417	1,357,392	8,193	12,657,278	13,008,119
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	4,327,666			1,779,749	928,950	127,578	7,163,943	6,296,565
Supporting services	2,764,859	(317,571)	\$ 237,738	1,354,459	879,973	-	4,919,458	4,425,067
Total Expenses	7,092,525	(317,571)	237,738	3,134,208	1,808,923	127,578	12,083,401	10,721,632
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,395,230)	1,000,552	(237,738)	2,777,209	(451,531)	(119,385)	573,877	2,286,487
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(119,385)					119,385	-	-
Other Transfer	2,514,615	1,150,000	-	(4,014,620)	350,005	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	2,150,552	(237,738)	(1,237,411)	(101,526)	-	573,877	2,286,487
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	6,889,978	758,141	4,227,414	532,508	-	12,465,054	10,178,567
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	9,040,530	520,403	2,990,003	430,982	-	13,038,931	12,465,054

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2001 (with comparative totals for 2000)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2001 Total	2000 Total
Salaries	\$ 644,063	\$ 781,225	\$ 134,421		\$ 98,861	\$ 945,962	\$ 401,101	\$ 94,770	\$1,911,262	\$ 5,011,665	\$ 4,795,248
Payroll taxes	45,779	57,486	9,029		7,101	68,181	25,474	4,232	139,313	356,595	352,923
Health and group insurance	117,621	116,004	14,519		11,819	130,500	86,664	7,266	428,469	912,862	859,474
Retirement expense - funding	21,877	27,237	4,261		3,482	32,456	6,122		63,654	159,089	259,299
Other program printing	238,998	77,333	59,909		12,338				3,388	391,966	329,514
Mailing labor	133,553	10,228	834		8,425					153,040	138,768
Postage and express	272,352	81,867	36,014		26,207	9,929	13,468	835	34,244	474,916	435,926
Writers fees	8,666	31,249	10,965		1,760	57,666				110,306	58,199
Foreign literature assistance		237,469							-	237,469	132,134
Selling expenses						120,384	134,947	6,214		261,545	232,853
Professional fees			844						318,927	319,771	337,848
Contracted services	8,288	152,966	5,754		12,116	9,978	122,329	8,111	82,048	401,590	187,607
Occupancy	65,513	94,463	6,978		5,566	112,855	74,694		252,042	612,111	604,482
Telephone	18,968	16,402	2,760		1,664	19,159	15,956		56,254	131,163	161,954
Equipment maintenance						2,480			67,635	70,115	65,238
Furniture and equipment	8,980	35,707			2,664	4,932		2,144	45,175	99,602	79,887
Stationery and office supplies	68,854	9,009	13,656		1,483	1,643	24,098	2,003	100,085	220,831	186,406
Office service and expense	8,421	16,232	14,788		9,160	10,569	24,097	2,003	357,792	443,062	319,683
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,255	56,974	405,324		52,137	11,650			409,756	937,096	1,001,001
Bad debts									28,186	28,186	32,190
Mailing 4th edition to Groups						241,405				241,405	-
Delegate fees			(112,212)							(112,212)	(215,390)
Total Operating Expenses	1,663,188	1,801,851	607,844	-	254,783	1,779,749	928,950	127,578	4,298,230	11,462,173	10,355,244
Postretirement health benefits									(64,885)	(64,885)	504,322
Retirement expense adjustment									(252,686)	(252,686)	(418,447)
Early retirement severance benefits									345,831	345,831	-
Depreciation									237,738	237,738	280,513
Conversion and restructuring Charges									355,230	355,230	-
Total Expenses	1,663,188	1,801,851	607,844	-	254,783	1,779,749	928,950	127,578	4,919,458	12,083,401	10,721,632
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>1,031,896</u>	<u>1,117,928</u>	<u>377,126</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>158,076</u>	<u>1,354,459</u>	<u>879,973</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(4,919,458)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	2,695,084	2,919,779	984,970	\$ -	412,859	3,134,208	1,808,923	127,578	-	12,083,401	10,721,632
Services	\$2,695,084	\$2,919,779	\$984,970	\$ -	\$412,859					\$ 7,012,692	\$ 6,509,687
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 3,134,208				3,134,208	2,646,017
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,808,923	\$127,578		1,936,501	1,565,928
										<u>12,083,401</u>	<u>10,721,632</u>
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2000	<u>\$2,586,269</u>	<u>\$2,521,322</u>	<u>\$923,544</u>	<u>\$102,156</u>	<u>\$376,396</u>	<u>\$2,646,017</u>	<u>\$1,503,791</u>	<u>\$ 62,137</u>		<u>\$10,721,632</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 2001
(with comparative totals for 2000)

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2001</u>	<u>2000</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 573,877	\$ 2,286,487
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(178,176)	(263,197)
Amortization of bond premiums	16,672	10,173
Depreciation		237,738
280,513		
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(109,267)	(82,258)
Inventories	(220,105)	139,915
Deferred charges and other assets	(53,260)	656,105
Accounts and accruals payable	841,250	230,201
Deferred income	55,607	(2,043,406)
Prepaid pension cost	(252,686)	(418,447)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	(64,885)	504,322
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>846,765</u>	<u>1,300,408</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Computer networking project	-	(306,856)
Proceeds from sales of investments	2,500,000	2,000,000
Purchases of investments	(4,514,204)	(2,263,695)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(2,014,204)</u>	<u>(570,551)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	(1,167,439)	729,857
Cash, beginning of year	4,563,814	3,833,957
Cash, end of year	<u>3,396,375</u>	<u>4,563,814</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

February 26, 2002

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2001 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2000 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 2, 2001, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2001 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2001

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for

the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND - This fund accounts for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The GENERAL FUND - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements. Amounts reported by A.A. World Services include Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc., "S.M.A.A.", a controlled non-profit Canadian corporation.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or

market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2001 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	<u>Life</u>	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Current Year</u>	<u>Accumulated Depreciation</u>
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$176,367	\$1,769,581
Furniture	8 Years	689,598		689,598
Computer - hardware	5 Years	402,099	61,371	217,986
- software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,469,239</u>	<u>237,738</u>	<u>2,948,836</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2001 and 2000 is comprised of the following:

	<u>2001</u>	<u>2000</u>
Interest	\$616,801	\$615,545
Realized gains on redemptions	859	1,573
Change in unrealized appreciation	177,317	261,624
Investment expenses	(4,659)	(4,574)
	<u>790,318</u>	<u>874,168</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives, loners and overseas services and the international convention staff assignment.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2001:

A Perplexing Problem

While waiting for his Sunday Night Dinner date Jon Shirley (Alabama/NW Florida) was in a dilemma as to how a Southern gentleman opens a revolving door for a lady. Andy Arvison (Western Washington) and his guide dog, Venus, solved the problem for Jon. "Hire the Handicapped, they are fun to watch," Andy told Jon.

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 12,614,974
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>11,872,086</u>
Funded status	<u>742,888</u>

Prepaid pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	\$ <u>1,596,107</u>
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The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized prepaid pension cost asset is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	7.5%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%

Benefit cost	\$ (132,520)
Employers' contributions	\$ 120,166
Benefits paid	\$ 594,538

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 120,166
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(252,686)
	<u>(132,520)</u>

Plan assets at December 31, 2000 were comprised as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 226,117
Common stocks	7,499,350
Government bonds	2,812,878
Corporate and other bonds	2,076,629
	<u>12,614,974</u>

Employees of S.M.A.A. in Canada participate in a separate retirement plan under which 5% of their annual salaries are contributed by that Organization.

Effective September 4, 2001 the General Service Board approved an early retirement "window" for A.A.W.S. and General Service Board employees. Employees age 55 or older with combined age and service of 70 or more are eligible. Participating employees receive a higher pension benefit by adding five years of age up to age 65, and a temporary Social Security supplement up to age 62. Severance pay is also provided based on years of service, and is borne by the General Service Board.

The program is voluntary. The expiration date of the window is March 29, 2002.

Severance benefits under this program of \$345,831 were incurred in 2001.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2001, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$ 471,128
yearly office rental
lease at 475 Riverside
Drive effective January 1,

1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

In addition to the above lease commitments, S.M.A.A. was subject to a lease for office space in Montreal, Canada. The lease is effective through December 31, 2004. The current rent for 2001 is \$23,997, with annual escalations of 3%.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2001 is \$4,060,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

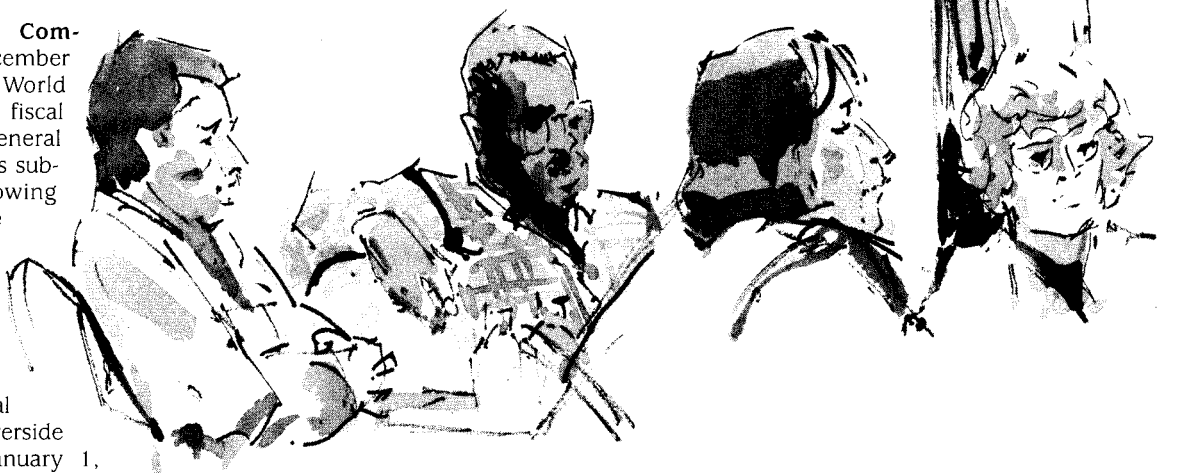
The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 7.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2001:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$2,892,956
Benefit cost	\$ 92,237
Benefits paid	\$ 157,122

The excess of payments for benefits over the cost of benefits of \$64,885 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense recovery since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Note 7 Conversion and Restructuring Charges: During 2001, the A.A. Grapevine incurred one-time charges of \$355,230 in connection with the restructuring of the Grapevine office and the outsourcing of certain fulfillment functions. Inasmuch as these costs are not expected to recur, this expense has been shown as a nonoperating item on the consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C).



Budget Highlights

2002 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2002 sales budget of \$9,706,300 is approximately \$1,876,000 less than the 2001 actual results as a direct result of the expected falloff of sales of the 4th edition Big Book. Other unit sales are approximately even. Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$9,456,000, approximately even with the year 2001 budget.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately \$600,000 less than 2001, again due to the expected reduction in 4th edition sales from the first year introduction. Royalties are budgeted at \$135,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted about even with 2001. Anticipated increases in postage and freight rates, and some higher warehousing costs, will offset the extra costs incurred in 2001 for the 4th edition.

Gross profit from literature is budgeted at \$4,740,900, approximately \$1,160,000 less than 2001, again a result of the expected decline in sales of the 4th edition. It is important to remember that the introductory price of the 4th edition was set at \$5.00 vs. \$6.00, thereby allowing reduced revenue on this new product.

Contributions for 2002 have been budgeted at \$4,794,000, approximately a 2% increase over 2001. The year 2001 saw the fourth year in a row that contributions received have exceeded the prior year.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$9,536,900, about 10% less than 2001.

Total Operating Expenses for 2002 have been budgeted at \$10,287,300, approximately \$60,000 or ½% higher than 2001. This offsets last year's larger than usual increase, that includes expenditures to help carry the message worldwide as well as at home. For example, we are now mailing new GSR kits first class in an effort to deliver the kits in a more timely manner. For 2002, there is also a significant increase (\$90,000) in the funds allocated to "Writers' Fees" to allow for such items as translation of 4th edition stories into French and Spanish, as well as Archives and PI video projects, in addition to various recordings on CD Rom. "Other literature assistance," efforts to help translate and provide recovery material to other countries and languages than can't do it alone continues strong. Absent from the 2002 budget, and unanticipated at budget time for the 2001 budget were the costs incurred for the mailing of the 4th edition to all groups on our system and the early retirement window.

An excess of expenses over revenue of \$750,450 is budgeted. This compares with a \$381,979 net income for 2001, a \$983,211 net income for 2000, \$877,700 in 1999, \$139,600 in 1998, a \$245,000 loss for 1997, \$1,264,000 loss for 1996, a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. The three years of losses, followed by succeeding profits, have resulted in a Reserve Fund balance of 11.6 months at 12/31/2001. After a 2002 transfer, the balance will be approximately 11 months of combined operating expenses. The operating losses allow the Reserve Fund to move slowly downward a bit.

2002 Grapevine Budget

The 2002 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for 2002 of 115,500, approximately 500 copies higher than the 115,034 achieved in 2001, 115,734 in 2000, 116,000 in 1999 and 117,300 in 1998.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,754,800 is expected, just \$1,000 more than 2001. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$511,000, approximately \$79,000 higher than 2001. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates significantly higher sales of *The Language of the Heart* and the wall calendars and pocket planners.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,356,300 is budgeted, compared to \$1,270,200 achieved for 2001 and the 2001 budget of \$1,356,900.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2002 are budgeted at \$1,440,000, approximately \$14,000 less than the 2001 actual of \$1,453,693.

Net Income: For 2002 the Grapevine just about breaks with an anticipated profit of \$188. This compares with a 2001 budgeted profit of \$283 and an actual loss of \$96,300 from operations.

2002 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 the Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the Spanish magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but funded by the General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2002 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$11,587, compared with a \$8,193 gross profit for 2001. Circulation for 2002 is estimated at 9,000, slightly higher than the 2001 average of 8,623. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$126,364 for 2002, compared with \$127,578 in 2001 and \$62,137 in 2000. The 2002 budget projects a net loss of \$114,777 compared with a \$119,385 loss for 2001 and a 2001 budgeted loss of \$63,116.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$564,300 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000 and \$119,385 in 2001.

The General Service Office 2002 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2001 Budget	2001 Actual	2002 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$9,671,302	\$11,582,000	\$9,706,295
Discounts allowed	262,330	290,413	250,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,408,972	11,291,587	9,456,295
 Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,140,378	4,113,774	3,506,125
Royalties	167,725	197,294	135,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	6,100,869	6,980,519	5,815,170
 DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	997,627	1,080,789	1,074,296
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	5,103,242	5,899,730	4,740,874
Contributions Received	4,595,000	4,688,831	4,794,000
Interest Income	3,500	20,151	2,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	9,701,742	10,608,712	9,536,874
 OPERATING EXPENSES			
4th edition mailing		240,642	0
Salaries	4,337,000	4,261,402	4,515,000
Payroll taxes	310,000	310,721	315,700
Insurance	760,600	753,158	871,600
Retirement expense	226,300	148,800	177,800
Other program printing	390,350	391,966	423,750
Mailing, labor, etc	142,360	171,159	153,700
Postage & express	474,900	442,497	478,499
Writers' fees	127,000	110,306	199,000
Other literature assistance	212,500	237,468	208,000
Selling expenses	95,600	121,146	117,800
Professional fees	225,000	283,991	216,000
Contracted services	199,600	271,150	292,550
Occupancy	531,250	511,241	531,200
Telephone	139,350	109,779	115,500
Equipment maintenance	76,100	70,114	93,600
Furniture & equipment	74,300	71,668	54,000
Stationery & office expense	187,635	184,940	190,550
Office service & expense	300,025	407,172	349,275
Travel, meals, & accommodations	745,000	774,047	848,800
Bad debts	10,000	7,535	10,000
Early retirement and severance	—0—	345,830	125,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	9,564,870	10,226,733	10,287,324
Income for period	136,872	381,979	(750,450)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2002 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2001 Budget	2001 Actual	2002 Budget	2001 Budget	2001 Actual	2002 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>117,000</u>	<u>115,804</u>	<u>115,500</u>	<u>8,500</u>	<u>8,623</u>	<u>9,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,732,128	\$1,699,636	\$1,704,780	\$62,227	\$62,906	\$65,977
Single copies and back issues	36,000	54,133	50,000	0	7,320	9,000
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,768,128</u>	<u>1,753,769</u>	<u>1,754,780</u>	<u>62,227</u>	<u>70,226</u>	<u>74,977</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>682,755</u>	<u>725,199</u>	<u>745,004</u>	<u>53,697</u>	<u>62,033</u>	<u>63,390</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,085,373</u>	<u>1,028,570</u>	<u>1,009,776</u>	<u>8,530</u>	<u>8,193</u>	<u>11,587</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	518,064	431,248	510,575			
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>246,549</u>	<u>189,612</u>	<u>164,019</u>			
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>271,515</u>	<u>241,636</u>	<u>346,556</u>			
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,356,888</u>	<u>1,270,206</u>	<u>1,356,332</u>			
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	174,051	165,097	250,562	35,000	65,031	49,000
Payroll taxes and benefits	58,745	38,456	65,030	13,678	2,986	10,013
Occupancy costs	64,944	61,360	63,300	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	16,597	21,122	21,284	0	3,329	2,000
Product development	9,000	14,539	12,000	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>323,337</u>	<u>300,574</u>	<u>412,176</u>	<u>48,678</u>	<u>71,346</u>	<u>61,013</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	474,539	490,395	375,738	7,361	29,739	31,065
Payroll taxes and benefits	178,756	165,913	135,495	2,259	8,512	9,326
Kable fulfillment	89,113	91,346	120,439	4,988	8,111	17,400
Occupancy costs	64,944	60,894	63,600	0	0	0
Office supplies and expense	33,607	33,656	36,364	0	0	0
Subscriber services	14,500	11,700	11,700	0	0	0
Selling expense — regular	122,930	95,014	120,000	6,000	6,214	6,000
— GvR program	27,957	28,233	27,957	0	0	0
Postage	18,000	13,468	16,320	0	835	0
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>1,024,346</u>	<u>990,619</u>	<u>907,613</u>	<u>20,608</u>	<u>53,411</u>	<u>63,791</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
One-time charges	337,773	355,230	0	0	0	0
Indexing Project	0	9,861	0			
Leasehold Improvements	0	16,702	0			
Insurance	5,042	4,988	5,149	360	174	360
Professional fees	24,100	35,780	27,300	600	0	600
Meetings and conferences	49,106	50,836	49,106	0	0	0
Furniture and equipment	3,500	9,089	10,000	0	2,144	0
Canadian exchange and other	6,000	9,397	10,000	0	0	0
Bank service charges	720	5,195	3,600	0	0	0
Bad debts	15,000	20,652	15,000	1,400	503	600
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>441,241</u>	<u>517,730</u>	<u>120,155</u>	<u>2,360</u>	<u>2,821</u>	<u>1,560</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,788,924</u>	<u>1,808,923</u>	<u>1,439,944</u>	<u>71,646</u>	<u>127,578</u>	<u>126,364</u>
Interest earned	93,980	87,186	83,800			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>(338,056)</u>	<u>(451,531)</u>	<u>188</u>	<u>(63,116)</u>	<u>(119,385)</u>	<u>(114,777)</u>

() denotes red figures

2001 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area (in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIBUTIONS	% OF GPS. CONTRIBUTIONS	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	402	214	53.2%	36,189.86	8,044	\$4.49	229.30		1663.90		\$38,083.06	\$4.73
2.	Alaska	201	82	40.8	9,473.90	3,503	2.70	624.65		34.09		\$10,132.64	\$2.89
3.	Arizona	781	376	48.0	81,302.14	18,236	4.46	6984.89	140.00	3179.59	374.50	\$91,981.12	\$5.04
4.	Arkansas	231	120	51.8	13,594.68	4,236	3.20	1145.55	100.00	996.23	16.00	\$15,852.46	\$3.74
	California												
5.	Southern	1,136*	394	34.6	94,414.97	39,112	2.40	4902.24	1570.00	5257.84	2097.75	\$108,242.80	\$2.77
6.	N. Coastal	1,744	1,063	60.9	238,447.88	51,012	4.67	15829.67	1125.00	7137.12	1125.84	\$263,665.51	\$5.17
7.	N. Interior	721	386	53.4	65,202.52	20,267	3.22	3855.41	50.00	3911.18	666.16	\$73,685.27	\$3.64
8.	San Diego/Imp.	768	347	45.1	68,640.39	23,531	2.92	5556.34	70.00	1535.88	80.00	\$75,882.61	\$3.22
9.	Mid-South.	1,890	755	39.9	133,346.10	60,933	2.19	5942.53	0.00	430.66	331.27	\$140,050.56	\$2.30
10.	Colorado	605	352	58.2	71,150.50	14,441	4.92	5672.05	1050.00	25022.18	297.00	\$103,191.73	\$7.15
11.	Connecticut	1,452	560	38.5	77,838.74	34,818	2.24	2183.35	2248.00	16182.48	1213.75	\$99,666.32	\$2.86
12.	Delaware	202	127	62.8	29,298.02	3,272	8.95	216.90				\$29,514.92	\$9.02
13.	D.C.	473	227	47.9	44,129.83	15,438	2.86	2425.65	60.00	1599.00		\$48,214.48	\$3.12
	Florida												
14.	North	676	374	55.2	75,539.85	14,953	5.04	7912.91	610.00	31505.73	35.00	\$115,603.49	\$7.73
15.	South/	1,573	827	52.6	156,069.09	34,999	4.46	13360.82	270.00	33090.40	1302.27	\$204,092.58	\$5.83
16.	Georgia	698	436	62.5	82,358.19	15,858	5.19	2704.00	1065.00	1272.95		\$87,400.14	\$5.51
17.	Hawaii	302	156	51.6	30,028.08	5,541	5.41	730.08		898.56	40.00	\$31,696.72	\$5.72
18.	Idaho	199	89	44.7	13,153.87	3,470	3.78	256.55		101.24	122.22	\$13,633.88	\$3.93
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,172	285	24.3	53,436.50	28,725	1.85	3250.73	120.00	3531.51	421.88	\$60,760.62	\$2.12
20.	North	1,084	386	35.6	49,177.39	22,016	2.22	3397.69	525.00	10644.48	332.00	\$64,076.56	\$2.91
21.	South	437	177	40.4	24,813.65	7,302	3.39	1278.90		240.00		\$26,332.55	\$3.61
	Indiana												
22.	North	640	271	42.3	36,758.61	9,292	3.96	809.35	2095.00	2330.16	71.00	\$42,064.12	\$4.53
23.	South	560	260	46.4	34,168.30	10,656	3.21	233.64	150.00	1482.54	320.00	\$36,354.48	\$3.41
24.	Iowa	635	321	50.6	38,648.71	12,992	2.96	417.86	30.00	1946.70	0.00	\$41,043.27	\$3.16
25.	Kansas	377	169	44.8	26,355.99	9,251	2.84	248.00	150.00	5532.76		\$32,286.75	\$3.49
26.	Kentucky	659	301	45.6	65,302.60	10,399	6.28	4950.37		652.62	15.00	\$70,920.59	\$6.82
27.	Louisiana	531	181	34.0	29,641.66	11,034	2.68	405.00	20.00	1584.58		\$31,651.24	\$2.87
28.	Maine	449	153	34.0	15,558.17	7,547	2.05	959.00		1143.00	25.00	\$17,685.17	\$2.34
29.	Maryland	930	368	39.5	70,897.55	14,945	4.73	4078.74	30.00	2225.31		\$77,231.60	\$5.17
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,485	535	35.9	102,732.58	50,638	2.02	3614.74	40.00	315.00		\$106,702.32	\$2.11
31.	West	249	159	63.8	22,952.87	4,728	4.84	664.55			27.00	\$23,644.42	\$5.00
	Michigan												
32.	Central	568	245	43.0	39,360.27	13,427	2.93	3346.50	1265.00	1845.12		\$45,816.89	\$3.41
33.	Southeast	728	303	41.5	68,253.40	17,544	3.89	1581.37			50.00	\$69,884.77	\$3.98
34.	West	466	195	41.7	35,166.19	10,000	3.51	1082.00		275.00		\$36,523.19	\$3.65
	Minnesota												
35.	North	548	238	43.4	23,966.91	8,296	2.88	1965.20	50.00	1575.00	65.74	\$27,622.85	\$3.33
36.	South	969	411	42.4	61,147.48	22,451	2.72	907.35		1197.71	99.87	\$63,352.41	\$2.82
37.	Mississippi	250	104	41.6	13,726.37	4,585	2.99	735.65		266.56		\$14,728.58	\$3.21
	Missouri												
38.	East	525	256	48.7	48,136.61	8,809	5.46	3027.80		7776.34		\$58,940.75	\$6.69
39.	West	198	105	52.9	13,316.91	6,446	2.07	2292.00	1000.00			\$16,608.91	\$2.58
40.	Montana	271	116	42.7	18,637.92	4,409	4.23	313.35		55.73	15.00	\$19,022.00	\$4.31
41.	Nebraska	646	326	50.4	44,751.25	14,399	3.10	1269.28		1202.49	30.00	\$47,253.02	\$3.28
42.	Nevada	469	181	38.6	26,932.11	11,030	2.43	1038.05	25.00	2386.53	66.50	\$30,448.19	\$2.76
43.	New Hampshire	570	216	37.9	29,102.46	9,638	3.02	543.37	100.00	1735.00	40.00	\$31,520.83	\$3.27
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,292	502	38.9	80,327.51	32,312	2.48	5031.25	3165.00	2853.33	186.00	\$91,563.09	\$2.83
45.	South	521	256	49.1	49,854.20	9,351	5.33	1035.65	2180.00	2598.20		\$55,668.05	\$5.95
46.	New Mexico	305	164	53.7	26,052.22	5,557	4.68	627.65	25.00	3213.29	304.40	\$30,222.56	\$5.44
	New York												
47.	Central	683	256	37.4	37,770.33	11,037	3.41	2458.80	1025.00	6716.00	43.00	\$48,013.13	\$4.35
48.	H./M./B.	747	279	37.3	27,943.82	11,750	2.38	723.63		1900.00	111.50	\$30,678.95	\$2.61
49.	Southeast	1,781	718	40.2	179,039.29	57,722	3.10	7739.75	1160.00	1544.00	575.00	\$190,058.04	\$3.29
50.	West	321	94	29.2	13,543.29	5,919	2.28	468.17		417.32	39.00	\$14,467.78	\$2.44
51.	N. Carolina	926	466	50.2	85,423.43	15,038	5.67	1892.56	400.00	1871.81	190.00	\$89,777.80	\$5.97
52.	North Dakota	146	64	43.7	8,246.43	2,692	3.05	114.00		1017.19		\$9,377.62	\$3.48
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	677	205	30.3	26,506.12	9,775	2.71	566.49		534.82		\$27,607.43	\$2.82
54.	Northeast	1,345	283	21.0	35,689.61	22,488	1.58	410.75	100.00	729.10		\$36,929.46	\$1.64
55.	N.W. Ohio/	274	94	34.2	12,902.75	4,019	3.20	78.00		206.76		\$13,187.51	\$3.28
	S.E. Mich.												
56.	S.W. Ohio	550	231	41.9	36,948.60	11,231	3.28	2494.50		265.00		\$39,708.10	\$3.54
57.	Oklahoma	381	204	53.4	30,916.46	6,465	4.77	1565.94	121.00	2870.00	253.25	\$35,726.65	\$5.53
58.	Oregon	820	380	46.3	60,482.01	16,031	3.76	1583.88	220.00	2518.50	150.44	\$64,954.83	\$4.05

59.	Pennsylvania												
60.	East	1,356	717	52.9	137,464.01	31,893	4.30	3644.71	3585.00	5399.14	630.00	\$150,722.86	\$4.73
61.	West	780	412	52.8	50,419.11	11,076	4.54	3627.83		2443.96	10.00	\$56,500.90	\$5.10
62.	Rhode Island	240	119	49.5	23,745.11	5,148	4.60	134.00	25.00	862.77		\$24,766.88	\$4.81
63.	South Carolina	313	180	57.4	35,601.66	7,261	4.89	387.39		1423.26		\$37,412.31	\$5.15
64.	South Dakota	151	55	36.4	5,981.12	3,711	1.60	174.67		828.97		\$6,984.76	\$1.88
	Tennessee	477	238	49.8	42,225.23	11,152	3.79	1459.61		269.90	10.00	\$43,964.74	\$3.94
	Texas												
65.	Northeast	413	190	45.9	58,840.59	17,928	3.28	4324.50	127.00	5662.14		\$68,954.23	\$3.85
66.	Northwest	230	86	37.3	16,602.65	5,154	3.21	297.00	500.00	50.00		\$17,449.65	\$3.39
67.	Southeast	502	230	45.8	44,782.87	14,407	3.10	920.00		765.45	5.00	\$46,473.32	\$3.23
68.	Southwest	501	201	40.0	39,365.44	11,528	3.40	2912.80		478.00		\$42,756.24	\$3.71
69.	Utah	258	140	54.2	26,965.94	5,144	5.24	834.07		981.80	25.00	\$28,806.81	\$5.60
70.	Vermont	238	101	42.3	15,377.73	4,393	3.50	2397.13		639.61		\$18,414.47	\$4.19
71.	Virginia	1,063	617	57.9	107,131.54	20,654	5.18	3618.05	800.00	4516.17	335.79	\$116,401.55	\$5.64
72.	Western Washington	1,111	538	48.4	100,451.47	24,330	4.12	5033.23	14.00	7589.93	266.65	\$113,355.28	\$4.66
73.	West Virginia	297	134	45.1	12,587.53	3,335	3.77	143.30	114.00	442.34		\$13,287.17	\$3.98
	Wisconsin												
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	649	255	39.3	26,617.73	10,676	2.48	1949.00	25.00	1020.99	25.00	\$29,637.72	\$2.78
	South												
75.	Wyoming	927	430	46.4	45,866.78	17,881	2.57	303.00		252.79	58.00	\$46,480.57	\$2.60
76.	Puerto Rico	101	59	58.4	8,284.60	1,770	4.67	136.60		1790.09		\$10,211.29	\$5.77
77.	Alberta/N.W.T.	131	73	55.7	6,326.37	1,556	4.07	151.79		72.31		\$6,550.47	\$4.21
78.	B.C./Yukon	494	242	49.0	36,656.61	8,062	4.55	209.37	13.91	1854.81	285.07	\$39,019.77	\$4.84
79.	Manitoba	709	362	51.1	50,638.80	13,605	3.71	2586.24	328.65	4315.98	310.68	\$58,180.35	\$4.28
80.	N.B./P.E.I.	146	60	41.1	5,212.69	3,777	1.38			139.22		\$5,351.91	\$1.42
81.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	199	81	40.6	6,725.84	3,478	1.93	47.97		230.69		\$7,004.50	\$2.01
82.	Ontario	255	109	42.7	7,672.35	3,462	2.22	100.27	323.55	220.75	12.80	\$8,329.72	\$2.41
	East												
83.	Northeast	604	245	40.5	39,195.57	15,232	2.56	362.84	638.86	7035.02	406.12	\$47,638.41	\$3.13
84.	Northwest	171	48	28.0	7,569.07	2,234	3.39	755.42	31.20	1349.79	16.65	\$9,722.13	\$4.35
85.	Northwest	82	12	14.6	1,591.05	1,334	1.18	25.00		385.72		\$2,001.77	\$1.50
86.	West	517	213	41.2	31,018.29	9,869	3.14	368.63		8852.06		\$40,238.98	\$4.08
	Quebec ⁽¹⁾												
87.	Southwest	554	430	77.5	8,119.60	15,007	0.53	642.09	22.41	9,303.62		\$18,087.72	\$1.21
88.	Southeast	195	166	85.1	276.13	3,233	0.08	166.67	15.86	3,321.74		\$3,780.40	\$1.17
89.	Northeast	356	317	88.9	2,439.34	6,888	0.34	199.57		7,512.36		\$10,151.27	\$1.47
90.	Northwest	390	328	84.0	1,396.99	7,328	0.18	69.87		24,329.45		\$25,796.31	\$3.52
91.	Saskatchewan	293	99	33.8	8,167.10	3,615	2.26	108.45	1,319.40	794.66		\$10,389.61	\$2.87
92.	Washington East	464	167	36.0	16,218.63	6,602	2.45					\$16,218.63	\$2.46
93.	Central Calif	804	364	45.3	58,217.60	21,442	2.71	2,636.04		2,517.09	75.50	\$63,446.23	\$2.96
	Total U.S./Canada	56,210	25,361	45.1	\$4,110,520.28	1,257,775	3.27	\$190,461.51	\$30,237.84	\$320,671.07	\$13,605.60	\$4,665,496.30	\$3.71
	Canada												
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					234,304.95								
Specials					320,671.07								
Total for U.S. & Canada					4,665,496.30								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
On Line Meetings					1,429.97							1,429.97	
Correctional & Hospital facility groups					192.00							192.00	
Foreign					19,615.17							\$19,615.17	
Internationalists					200.00							\$200.00	
Loners					1,538.16							\$1,538.16	
Birds of a Feather					300.00							\$300.00	
International Doctors in A.A.					50.00							\$50.00	
International Lawyers in A.A.					9.50							\$9.50	
Grand Total					\$4,688,831.10							\$4,688,831.10	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2001-2000 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GROUPS REPORTED	#GROUPS CONTRIBUTIONS	% OF GROUPS CONTRIBUTIONS	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC.
U.S. & Canada							
2001	56,210	25,361	45.1%	\$4,110,520.28	1,257,775	\$3.27	\$3.71
U.S. & Canada							
2000	56,389	24,842	44.1%	\$3,929,906.25	1,260,928	\$3.12	\$3.55
Increase (Decrease)	(179)	519	1.0%	\$180,614.03	(3,153)	\$0.15	\$0.16

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas).

2002 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

¹Andy Arvidson
²Ron Atkinson
 Wanda Halverson
 Joe Lopez
 Amy O'Mara
 Walter Norrad
 Buck Rose
 David Steiner

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Lainie Bertrand
 Miles Brookes
 Tim Calhoun
²Elvis Fortner
 Mike Glassman
 Bill Thomson
 Allan Ward

¹Patty Tennant

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Correctional Facilities

²Christine Carvell
 Gene Davis
 John DeLoach
 Tom Guest
 Tina Hobson
 Tom Kerner
¹Richard Levesque
 Guy Raymond

Secretary: Julio Espailat

Finance

John Evans
 Marco Garcia
 Rita Lambert
²Sherry Leech
 Suzanne Moore
 Leo Mutchler
¹Gayle Solheim Riese
 Jim Schmitz

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Pete Bartlett
²Mike Bennett
 Martin Gerwig
 Réal Laforest
 Sally McAuley
 Sonny McCord
¹Ed Martin
 Jose Antonio Mejias
 Bridget Vest

Secretary: Robin Bromley

Literature

²Loren Buettner
 John Burke
¹Joe Downey
 Beth Davidson
 Charles Hollins
 Glen Hope
 Tom LeDoux
 Janet Neri-Kafel
 Madeleine Parmley

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Policy/Admissions

Don Anderson
 Betty Barnette
 Herbie Humphreys
 Duncan McAuley
 Curt Melton
¹Brian Rogers
 Ray Romero
 Duante Talbot

²Mary Templeton

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Public Information

Darlene Bushnell
¹Bob Conway
 Bill Graham
 Marc-Andre Grenier
²Mark Kramar
 Joan Murdock
 Marvin Wicher
 Bob Wilcox
 Mary Pat Yater

Secretary: Rick Walker

Report and Charter

¹Donna Byrd
 Kathy Cholewinski
 Paul Haynes
 Victor Long
 Shirley Ohlson
 Wayne Robinson
²Marty Sullivan
 Dolores York

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Treatment Facilities

Richard Bruha
²Jeanette Foster
 Jim Holt
 Larry Johnson
 Ted Lapine
 Jo-Anne Lowenberger
¹Marilyn McKeehan
 Joe O'Neil

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Trustees

Bob Allen
 Chuck Barta
 Bob Carpenter
 Dorothy Dayton
¹Steve Hagen
 Vaughn Horton
 Warren Jefsen
²Jon Shirley
 Denis Vézina

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

³Archives

John Burke
 Darlene Bushnell
 John Evans
 Steve Hagen
 Glen Hope
¹Larry Johnson
 Réal Laforest
²Leo Mutchler
 Patty Tennant

Secretary: Judit Santon

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Joe Downey
²Elvis Fortner
 Warren Jefsen
 Jo-Anne Lowenberger
 Curt Melton
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Ray Romero
¹Mary Templeton

Co-Secretaries:
 Adrienne Brown
 Doug Richardson

2003 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	David Steiner, New York, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire	Walter Norrad, New Brunswick/P.E.I.
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Mike Glassman, Arizona	Miles Brookes, Maine
Correctional Facilities	Tom Kerner, New Hampshire	Gene Davis, Washington State East
Finance	John Evans, South Dakota	Rita Lambert, SW Texas
Grapevine	Sally McAuley, Rhode Island	Pete Bartlett, California, Mid-Southern
Literature	Madeleine Parmley, Idaho	Tom LeDoux, Kansas
Policy/Admissions	Ray Romero, New Mexico	Betty Barnette, Tennessee
Public Information	Bob Wilcox, W. Massachusetts	Bill Graham, Wyoming
Report and Charter	Victor Long, Maryland	Kathy Cholewinski, California, Northern Interior
Treatment Facilities	Jo-Anne Lowenberger, Manitoba	Ted Lapine, N. Wis./Upper Peninsula Michigan
Trustees	Dorothy Dayton, Delaware	Warren Jefsen, W. Michigan
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Curt Melton, Nebraska	Warren Jefsen, W. Michigan
³ Archives	Darlene Bushnell, Oregon	Patty Tennant, South Carolina

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2002 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 52nd General Service Conference.

2002 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Gregory Tobin, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal, L.L.D.
Ric Downey
John Koster
Jan Polek
Arnold Ross
Judith Santon, *secretary*

Conference

Ted Stoa, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
Ric Downey
David Every
Dick Gallagher
Marne Hill
Robert Miller, D.D.
Arnold Ross
Jane Sheppard
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities

Marne Hill, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
*Calvin James
John Koster
Dorothy May
*Irene Meisel
George Vaillant, M.D.
Susan Ulseth, *secretary* — C.P.C.
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*
— Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Jim Clough, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Linda Chezem, J.D.
*William Herold
*Jane Starke Lobdell
Raymond Massey
Dorothy May
Gregory Tobin
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Art Knight, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
Linda Chezem
David Every
Ron Gauthier
Jackie Johnston
Jan Polek
Beth Rabren
Tony Taschner
Vincent Keefe, *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Robert Slotterback,
Kevin Sunkel, C.P.A.,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Alex Palmer, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Charles Bartell
Susan Campbell
Ron Gauthier
Raymond Massey
Dorothy May
Ted Stoa
George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Bill Archer, *secretary*

International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums

Leonard Blumenthal, L.L.D.
chairperson
Charles Bartell
Jackie Johnston
Jim Clough
Ron Gauthier
Art Knight
Ray Massey
Alex Palmer
Gregory Tobin
Doug Richardson, *secretary*
— International Convention
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*
— Regional Forums

Literature

George E. Vaillant, M.D., *chairperson*
Charles Bartell
Leonard Blumenthal, L.L.D.
Jim Clough
David Every
Dick Gallagher
Jan Polek
*David Sahatdjian
Jane Sheppard
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Nominating

Linda Chezem, *chairperson*
Marne Hill
Art Knight
Alex Palmer
Beth Rabren
Ted Stoa
Tony Taschner
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Public Information

Ric Downey, *chairperson*,
*Martin Clancy
*Burke Dykes
Dick Gallagher
John Koster
*Don McGouirk
Robert Miller, D.D.
Arnold Ross
Jane Sheppard
Rick Walker, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Robert Miller, D.D. *chairperson*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
First vice-chairperson
Linda Chezem, J.D.
Second vice-chairperson
Robert Miller, D.D.
Secretary
Marne Hill
Treasurer
Art Knight
Assistant secretary
Doug Richardson
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 42.

* Denotes appointed committee members

** Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2002 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected chair of the board in April 2001. She has served as a member of the board since 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services.

Allen L. Ault (10909 Chatham Ridge Way, Spotsylvania, VA 22553) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen currently serves as Chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. Prior to this appointment, he served as a director of corrections for five governors, most recently serving in that capacity in Georgia. Now in an adjunct professor position, he was chairman and full professor in the Criminal Justice Department at Georgia State University. During his career, Allen has been a Rehabilitation Counselor, Director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, Warden of a maximum security prison and President of a national criminal justice consulting firm. He received a Doctorate in Counseling Psychology from the University of Georgia. Allen serves on the International, Correctional Facilities and Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities Committees.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. (Rolly View, Alberta T0C 2K0, Canada), was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person. Leonard chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee, and also serves on the Archives and Literature Committees.

Linda L. Chezem, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda is a professor at Purdue University, with a part-time appointment at Indiana University School of Medicine. She chairs the Nominating Committee, and also serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Correctional Facilities and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (560 Stockbridge Court, Lake Forest, IL 60045-2680) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. While Art is no longer involved in day-to-day business operations, he serves on a variety of business, professional and civic boards. He is treasurer of the General Service Board, chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and also serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (2104 Vestavia Lake Dr., Birmingham, AL 35216) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth

Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal Church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob chairs the General Sharing Session and serves on the Conference and Public Information Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

George E. Vaillant, M.D. (Brigham and Women's Hospital, 75 Francis St., Boston, MA 02115) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and director, The Study of Adult Development of Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Charles Bartell (3935 Lennox Boulevard, New Orleans, LA 70131) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2001. A Panel 45 delegate he continues to participate in treatment and correctional service in his area. Charles, whose background is in psychology, is a retired university professor. He serves on the International, Literature and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Jim Clough (1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 42 delegate, Jim has been active in his area and has served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee. A retired naval architect and marine engineer he is currently a retired co-owner of a company involved in the publishing, wholesaling, and retailing of art. Jim chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Literature and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey (PH4-9541 Erickson Dr., Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2000. A Panel 47 delegate, where he chaired the Policy Admissions Committee, Ric has remained active in his area. He recently retired after 35 years with the same firm. Ric chairs the Public Information Committee, serves on the Archives and Conference Committees and is a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

David V. Every (150 Hauoli Street, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. A Panel 41 delegate, David served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He is the publisher of a local magazine and a partner in an advertising and public relations firm. David serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Conference, and Literature Committees and on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Richard Gallagher (410 Spring Valley Lane, Altamonte Springs, FL 32714) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2001. A Panel 47 delegate, Dick remains active in his home group and in area activities. A.C.P.A. in private practice he is also involved with various professional organizations. Dick serves on the Literature, Public Information and Conference Committees.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 2001 Conference meeting.

Marne Hill (270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 3T3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 41 delegate she has held many service positions at the local and area level, including Area 85 archivist. Marne, whose background is in banking, is currently a financial planner. She chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Nominating and Conference Committees.

Jacqueline Johnston (78213 Sunrise Mountain View, Palm Desert, CA 92211) was elected general service trustee in April 1998, after serving as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Jackie has been active for many years in area and district service work and was Panel 41 delegate from Southern California. Now retired, she worked as a C.P.A. for a national accounting firm in both New York and California, and as a teacher in Los Angeles. Jackie serves on the A.A.W.S. Board and on the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

John Koster (19 East 65th Street, New York, NY 10021-6587) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. John has been an A.A.W.S. director since 1997. He is an attorney in New York specializing in the area of maritime and international commercial law. John serves as an editor or contributing author to a number of professional publications. John serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Public Information Committees and is a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Dorothy May (9046 Pine Cone Way, Indianapolis, IN 46268) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2001. Dorothy was a Panel 40 delegate. Her professional background is in education, as teacher, administrator and writer. Now retired, she is in charge of the educational program at a recovery house. Dorothy serves on the International, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Alex D. J. Palmer (33439 Huggins Ave., Abbotsford, BC, V2S 2R8, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada, April 1999. A Panel 45 delegate from BC/Yukon, Alex has held many service positions in his area. He has been a CGA (certified general accountant) and controller for different organizations and small businesses, and is currently business director of an alcohol and drug program for youth. Alex chairs the International Committee and serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Beth Rabren (224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 1999. As a Panel 39 delegate she chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Beth continues to be active in her home group, area and region. Her professional background is in education, as teacher and administrator, and in treatment as a licensed counselor and administrator. Beth chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Ted Stoa (402 S. Kline St., Aberdeen, SD 57401) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2000. Ted was a Panel 42 delegate. His background is in restaurant management and he has owned and operated several restaurants, as well as the family farm. Ted chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nomination Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Tony Taschner (16 Cindy Lane, Berlin, CT 06037) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 1999. Tony served as a Panel

45 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, and has held many service positions in his district and area. He is a retired assistant vice president in Data Management of a large financial service company. Tony chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board, and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Gregory Tobin (64 Duffield Dr., South Orange, NJ 07079) was elected general service trustee in April 1999, after serving for three years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He has been active in various service committees in his home area and district. Gregory has had a long career in the book-publishing industry, was the editor-in-chief of a large publishing house, and is currently a full-time writer. Gregory chairs the Archives Committee, serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Correctional Facilities Committees and is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2002 Conference

Ronald Gauthier (81 Lake Drive, South Hamilton, MA 01982) was elected general service trustee in April 2002. A Panel 41 delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, he has served as an A.A.W.S. director for the past four years. Ron's background is in banking and finance; for the past 20 years he has worked as a commercial lender at various banks in the Boston area.

Phyllis Halliday (3805 Cortez Loop SW, Olympia, WA 98512) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2002. As a Panel 47 delegate, Phyllis chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Her professional background is in human resource management and she is an agency Human Resource director for the state of Washington.

Vincent E. Keefe (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and presently serves as a director of seven companies.

Robert Pelot (1020, Louis Ritchie, Bellefeuille, Québec, Canada J0R 1A0) was elected Eastern Canada trustee in April 2002. Robert, a former Panel 46 delegate, is active in his area with remote communities and in correctional service. Now retired, Robert worked for 25 years for a large corporation in various supervisory positions.



A.A. World Services Directors

Beth Rabren, *chairperson, regional trustee*

Ric Downey, *regional trustee*

Ron Gauthier, *director*

Jacqueline Johnston, *member*

general service trustee

John Koster, *general service trustee*

Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*

Jan Polek, *director*

Jane Sheppard, *director*

Doug Richardson, *G.S.O. staff*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Tony Taschner, *chairperson, regional trustee*

Susan Campbell, *director*

David Every, *general service trustee*

Raymond Massey, *director*

trustee

Robert Miller, D.D., *Class A trustee*

Arnold Ross, *director*

Desmond Towey, *executive editor*

Gregory Tobin, *general service*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*

Tom Jasper,

senior adviser to general manager

Bill Archer

Adrienne Brown

Julio Espallat

Joanie Moncrief

Valerie O'Neill

Doug Richardson

Eva Sanchez

Warren Stafford

Susan Ulseth

Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Desmond Towey, *executive editor*

Charles McGovern, *managing editor*

Mary Pat Hester, *circulation director*

Robin Bromley, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Daniel Brown, *designer/typesetter*

Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*

Angel Calvillo, *translator*

Hope Cartelli, *staff assistant*

Sheila Copin-Thomas, *staff assistant*

Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*

John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*

Elisa Henrickson, *staff assistant*

Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*

Mary Pat Hester, *GV circulation director*

Maggie Keogh, *GV website manager/special projects*

John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*

Marsha Levine, *GV editorial staff assistant*

Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*

Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*

Donald Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*

Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*

Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*

Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*

Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*

Judit Santon, *archivist*

Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*

Frank Segui, *financial secretary*

Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*

Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*

Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*

Yee Tully, *staff assistant*

Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*

Mardia Vidal-Harrell, *staff assistant*

Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*

Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander

W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.

Gary Glynn

Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 52nd Conference includes Panel 51 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 52 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	51	Jon Shirley 107 Julia Way Gulf Breeze, FL 32561
Alaska	2	52	Amy O'Mara Box 33338 Juneau, AK 99803
Arizona	3	52	Mike Glassmann 2926 N. 54th Lane Phoenix, AZ 85031
Arkansas	4	51	Richard Levesque 105 Sonnet Hot Springs, AR 71913
California Southern	5	51	Mary Templeton 13904 Fiji Way, Apt. 231 Marina del Rey, CA 90292
Central	93	51	Steve Hagen 514 E. Elmwood Ave, #F Burbank, CA 91501-2589
Northern Coastal	6	51	Suzanne Moore 1624 Proctor Dr. Santa Rosa, CA 95404-3612
Northern Interior	7	52	Kathy Cholewinski 1339 Molly Ave. Woodland, CA 95776
San Diego/Imperial	8	52	Jim Holt 3451 Celinda Dr. Carlsbad, CA 92008
Mid-Southern	9	52	Pete Bartlett PMB 459, 23010 Lake Forest Suite D, Laguna Hills, CA 92653
Colorado	10	51	Brian Rogers 623 Plymouth Dr. Durango, CO 81301
Connecticut	11	51	John Burke 34 Morris St. West Haven, CT 06516
Delaware	12	52	Dorothy Dayton 358 Locust Lane Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	51	*Jonathan (Buck) Rose 9906 Grayson Ave. Silver Spring, MD 20901
Florida North	14	51	Thomas (Tom) Guest 721 Garden Lane Ormond Beach, FL 32174
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	51	Beth Davidson 11240 N.W. 41 Court Coral Spring, FL 33065
Georgia	16	52	John DeLoach 125 Alfred St. Savannah, GA 31408
Hawaii	17	51	Jeanette Foster 73-1062 Ahikawa St. Kailua-Kona, HI 96740
Idaho	18	52	Madeleine Parmley 9242 N. Sunset Dr. Pocatello, ID 83201

* Alternate delegate was seated.

Dorothy Patch, delegate, was unable to attend.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	51	Loren Buettner 1615 S. Black, #102 Bozeman, MT 59715
<i>Chicago</i>	19	51	Dolores York Box 25618 Chicago, IL 60625	Nebraska	41	52	Curt Melton 7426 Ernst St. Omaha, NE 68122-1771
<i>Northern</i>	20	52	Hugh (Sonny) McCord 1115 N. Raynor Ave. Joliet, IL 60435-4548	Nevada	42	51	Joan Murdock 705 Mill St. Susanville, CA 96130-4354
<i>Southern</i>	21	51	Richard Bruha 608 Deppe Ln. Fairview Heights, IL 62208-2449	New Hampshire	43	52	Tom Kerner 10 Appletree Village Lane Merrimack, NH 03054-3689
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	51	Bridget Vest 1004 D Indian Mound Blvd. Anderson, IN 46013	<i>Northern</i>	44	51	Robert (Bob) Conway 1 Lauri Lane Middlesex, NJ 08846
<i>Southern</i>	23	52	Marco Garcia 17749 Captiva Way Noblesville, IN 46060	<i>Southern</i>	45	52	Joseph (Joe) O'Neill 6 Mercer Place Ocean City, NJ 08226
Iowa	24	51	Charles (Chuck) Barta 1320 43rd St. SE Cedar Rapids, IA 52403	New Mexico	46	52	Ray Romero 2908 El Tesoro Escondido NW Albuquerque, NM 87120
Kansas	25	52	Thomas (Tom) LeDoux 5806 Reeder Rd. Shawnee, KS 66203	New York			
Kentucky	26	52	James (Jim) Schmitz 5703 Renada Dr. Crestwood, KY 40014	<i>Central</i>	47	51	Gayle Solheim Riese 14 Broadway Cortland, NY 13045
Louisiana	27	51	Mark Kramar Box 208 Leesville, LA 71496-0208	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	52	Dave Steiner 9140 Meadowbrook Dr. Lee Center, NY 13363
Maine	28	52	Miles Brookes Box 935 Jefferson, ME 04348	<i>Southeast</i>	49	51	Allan Ward 452 Jefferson St. Westbury, NY 11590
Maryland	29	52	Victor Long 5011 Campground Rd. Eden, MD 21822	<i>Western</i>	50	52	Janet Neri-Kafel 6022 Baer Rd. Sanborn, NY 14132
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	51	Donna Byrd 3912 Sunningdale Way Durham, NC 27707
<i>Eastern</i>	30	51	Marilyn McKeehan 1 Pleasant St. Westminster, MA 01473-1537	North Dakota	52	51	Michael (Mike) Bennett Box 137 Kenmare, ND 58746-0137
<i>Western</i>	31	52	Bob Wilcox 66 East Glen Dr. Westfield, MA 01085	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central Southeast</i>	53	51	Herbie Humphreys 3405 Wicklow Rd. Columbus, OH 43204
<i>Central</i>	32	51	Ron Atkinson 2413 W. Taft Dr. St. Johns, MI 48879	<i>Northeast</i>	54	51	Tina Hobson 7830 Harvard Ave. Cleveland, OH 44105-3939
<i>Southeast</i>	33	51	William (Bill) Thomson 20533 Woodside Harper Woods, MI 48225-2261	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	52	Robert (Bob) Carpenter 30630 Drouillard, Rd., Lot 6 Walbridge, OH 43465
<i>Western</i>	34	52	Warren Jefsen 1266 W. US #2 St. Ignace, MI 49781	<i>Southwest</i>	56	52	Mary Pat Yater 425 Home Ave. Hamilton, OH 45013
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	51	Sherry Leech 2416 Chimney Hill Court Edmond, OK 73034
<i>Northern</i>	35	52	Timothy (Tim) Calhoun 18696 Grouse Rd. Little Falls, MN 56345	Oregon	58	52	Darlene Bushnell 581 Lancaster Dr. SE PMB #219 Salem, OR 97301
<i>Southern</i>	36	51	Christine Carvell 3481 Pilgrim Lane North Plymouth, MN 55441	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	52	Charles Hollins 113 N. Island View Long Beach, MS 39560	<i>Eastern</i>	59	51	Martin (Marty) Sullivan 1 Mistletoe Lane Levittown, PA 19054
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	51	Vaughn Horton 2919 Grove St. McKeesport, PA 15132-5358
<i>Eastern</i>	38	51	Ed Martin 4063 Utah St. Louis, MO 63116				
<i>Western</i>	39	51	Charles (Wayne) Robinson 1924 E. Greenview Springfield, MO 65803				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	52	Sally McAuley 52 Rounds Ave. Providence, RI 02907
South Carolina	62	52	Patty Tennant 5919 Murray Ave. Hanahan, SC 29406
South Dakota	63	52	John Evans Box 533 Black Hawk, SD 57718
Tennessee	64	52	Betty Barnette 32 Edenwood Dr. Jackson, TN 38301
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	51	Larry Johnson 13104 Nile Dr. Dallas, TX 75253
<i>Northwest</i>	66	52	Joe Lopez 4948 Meade El Paso, TX 79904
<i>Southeast</i>	67	51	Marvin Wicher 4063 Pirates Beach Galveston, TX 77554
<i>Southwest</i>	68	52	Rita Lambert 2713 Jorwoods Dr. Austin, TX 78745-5925
Utah	69	51	Shirley Ohlson 3997 S. Starwood St. West Valley, UT 84120
Vermont	70	52	Duncan MacAuley 435 Dorset St., #40 S. Burlington, VT 05403
Virginia	71	51	Elvis Fortner 8654 Poplar Springs Dr. Gloucester, VA 23061
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	52	Clarence Eugene (Gene) Davis 1319 Elm St. Clarkston, WA 99403
<i>Western</i>	72	51	Andrew (Andy) Arvidson Box 966 La Connor, WA 98257-0966
West Virginia	73	51	Martin Gerwig 50 Pine Dr. Cottageville, WV 25239
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Penn. MI</i>	74	52	Ted Lapine 800 Brookwood Dr. Oneida, WI 54155
<i>Southern</i>	75	51	Leo Mutchler 635-C McNally Ln. Brookfield, WI 53045
Wyoming	76	52	William (Bill) Graham 2405 Pennsylvania Blvd. Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	52	José Antonio Mejías Calle Brazil 194 Urb Bunker Caguas, PR 00725

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	52	Duane Talbot 57 Martinridge Crest NE Calgary AB T3J 3M4
B.C./Yukon	79	51	Robert (Bob) Allen 3614 21st Ave. Vernon, BC V1T 1H6
Manitoba	80	52	Jo-Anne Lowenberger 303 Regal Ave. Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	52	Walter Norrad 84 Murray Ave. Fredericton, NB E3A 3Y8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Lab.	82	51	*Wanda Halverson 381 Truro Rd., R.R. #3 Westville, NS BOK 2A0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	51	Joe Downey 43 Lennox St. Kingston, ON K7M 4S3
<i>Northeast</i>	84	51	Helaine (Lainie) Bertrand 1770 Paris St., Apt. 202 Sudbury, ON P3E 3C3
<i>Northwest</i>	85	51	Donald (Don) Anderson 11-6th Ave. South Sioux Lookout, ON P8T 1E5
<i>Western</i>	86	52	William John Paul (Paul) Haynes 2-3 Burns Dr. Guelph, ON N1H 7C3
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	52	Denis Vézina 8245, boul. St-Laurent, #902 Brossard, PQ J4X 2A6
<i>Southeast</i>	88	51	Guy Raymond 443, LaFrance Asbestos, PQ J1T 2L4
<i>Northeast</i>	89	51	Réal Laforest 20, rue Plourde Métabetchouan-Lac-A- La Croix, PQ G8G 1C 6
<i>Northwest</i>	90	52	Marc-Andre Grenier 420, RG St. Joseph Charette, PQ GOX 1E0
Saskatchewan	91	52	Glen Hope Box 1117 Gravelbourg, SK S0H 1X0



* Alternate delegate was seated.
Walter Henwood, delegate, was unable to attend.